



01

Archaeological Evidence

Stone Age/Iron Age

1. Which of the following is the correct order of prehistoric periods?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mesolithic, Paleolithic, Neolithic, Metal Age
- (b) Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Metal Age
- (c) Paleolithic, Neolithic, Mesolithic, Metal Age
- (d) Neolithic, Mesolithic, Paleolithic, Metal Age

Exp.- The standard chronological sequence of the prehistoric period is **Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic**, followed by the **Metallic Age**.

□ This sequence is based on human tools, lifestyle, and **technological progress**, in which stone tools became finer over time and were eventually replaced by metals. **Ans. (b)**

2. Which type of weapons were commonly used by Mesolithic people for hunting?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Swords
- (b) Barbed spears
- (c) Cannons
- (d) Catapults

Exp.- During the **Mesolithic period**, humans developed tiny stone tools called microliths, which were fixed onto handles of wood or bone to make **barbed spears** and bows and arrows. These tools, **1-5 cm** long, were made of chert, jasper, or agate, and with the development of **projectile technology**, hunting became more accurate and effective. **Ans. (b)**

02

Harappan Civilization

1. Which of the following is considered the oldest known civilization of the Indian subcontinent?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Gupta Empire
- (b) Maurya Civilization
- (c) Indus Valley Civilization
- (d) Vedic Civilization

Exp.- The **Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)** is considered the oldest known urban civilization of the Indian subcontinent, which was at its peak primarily between **2500 BC and 1900 BC**. It was discovered by Dayaram Sahni in **1921**.

□ This urban civilization holds a unique place in world history for its advanced town planning, drainage system, and the use of bronze. **Ans. (c)**

2. What name did the ancient Greeks use to refer to the region around the Indus River?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Sindhu
- (b) Indoi or Indike
- (c) Hind
- (d) Bharat

Exp.- The ancient Greeks called the area situated to the east of the '**Sindhu**' river as '**Indoi**'. For them, the entire landmass beyond the boundary of the '**Indus**' river was known as India/Indike.

□ The famous Greek ambassador **Megasthenes** wrote his renowned book '**Indica**' based on this name. **Ans. (b)**

3. 'Daimabad', a Harappan site, is located in which state?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Haryana
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Maharashtra

Exp.- Daimabad is located on the banks of the Pravara River (a tributary of the Godavari) in the **Ahmednagar district of Maharashtra**. It is considered the **southernmost site** of the Indus Valley Civilization.

□ In Haryana, the major Harappan sites are **Rakhigarhi and Banawali**, and in Punjab, **Ropar** is located, whereas in Gujarat, major sites like **Lothal, Dholavira, Surkotada, and Rangpur** are situated. **Ans. (d)**

4. In which Indian state is the Indus Valley Civilization city of Rakhigarhi located?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Uttar Pradesh
- (d) Haryana

Exp.- **Rakhigarhi** is located in the Ghaggar-Hakra river valley in the Hisar district of **Haryana**. Harappan-era drainage systems, granaries, and terracotta figurines have been found here.

□ It is the **largest Indian site** of the Indus Valley Civilization, which is considered to be even larger than Mohenjodaro in size. **Ans. (d)**

5. Which of the following is NOT a name used to refer to the Indus-Sarasvati Civilization?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Harappan Civilization
- (b) Mesopotamian Civilization
- (c) Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilization
- (d) Indus Civilization



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Exp.- Mesopotamia was a **distinct contemporary civilization** that developed in **Iraq** along the banks of the **Tigris and Euphrates** rivers.

- The name Indus-Saraswati Civilization is used because of its expansion in the region of the Indus River and the now-extinct Saraswati River. **Ans. (b)**

6. On the banks of which river was the Harappan site of 'Harappa' discovered in 1920-1922?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ravi (b) Ganga
(c) Luni (d) Yamuna

Exp.- The Harappan site was discovered during the years 1920-22 on the banks of the **Ravi river**, and this site was discovered in **1921** by Dayaram Sahni.

- This was the **first city** discovered in the Indus Valley Civilization, which is why the entire civilization is also known as the 'Harappan Civilization'. **Ans. (a)**

7. In ancient India, Chanhudaro was primarily a centre for:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Agriculture
(b) Metalworking
(c) Bead-making
(d) Textile weaving

Exp.- Chanhudaro was a major industrial center of the Indus Valley Civilization, where factories for **bead-making**, shell-cutting, and **seal-making** have been found. Evidence of micro-drills for piercing beads and semi-precious stones like carnelian and jasper has been obtained from here. **Ans. (c)**

8. Which of the following is NOT a feature of Indus Valley cities?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Roads intersecting at right angles
(b) Extensive use of iron tools
(c) Burnt brick construction
(d) Advanced drainage system

Exp.- The Indus Valley Civilization was a **Bronze Age** civilization. The people here knew how to make bronze by mixing copper and tin, but they were unfamiliar with **iron**.

- **Main features of Indus Valley Civilization-** Grid pattern town planning, construction with baked bricks (standardized burnt bricks were used), and a sophisticated **drainage system** which was one of the most advanced water drainage systems in the world. **Ans. (b)**

9. The Indus Valley people used standardized _____ as a building material.

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) burnt mud-bricks
(b) rocks
(c) fly ash
(d) black soil

Exp.- The people of the Indus Valley used **standardized burnt bricks** as construction material. In their town planning, the size and ratio of bricks (**4 : 2 : 1**) were completely uniform. This is a symbol of their advanced engineering and urban civilization. **Ans. (a)**

10. Harappan cities had a grid pattern of layout with roads that cut each other at right angles.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) circular (b) rectangular
(c) hexagonal (d) triangular

Exp.- The grid pattern of Harappan cities was based on a **rectangular layout**, in which streets intersected each other at **right angles (90°)**.

- The main streets ran from **North to South** and **East to West**, making the entire city look like a **network or a grid**. **Ans. (b)**

11. What were the cities of the Indus Valley generally enclosed with?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Wooden fences
(b) Fortified walls with gateways
(c) Stone barricades
(d) Moats and drawbridges

Exp.- Most cities of the Indus Valley (such as Harappa and Mohenjodaro) were surrounded by high and massive security walls to protect against external attacks and floods.

- The city was divided into two parts: the '**Citadel**' (upper part) and the '**Lower Town**'. Both parts were often **fortified with walls of baked bricks**. **Ans. (b)**

12. The Indus Valley Civilization flourished under which economy?

SSC PHASE XIII 02/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Barter system
(b) Currency-based economy
(c) Feudal economy
(d) Industrial economy

Exp.- The **Indus Valley Civilization** flourished mainly under the **Barter System**. Many evidences of trade have been found in the excavations of the Indus Valley, but metal coins have not been found anywhere. This clarifies that trade was based on the exchange of goods (exchanging one commodity for another). **Ans. (a)**

13. Which of the following features is not characteristic of the Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Well-planned urban centers with grid patterns.
(b) Use of iron tools for agriculture.
(c) Advanced drainage and water management systems.
(d) Presence of a Great Bath and granaries.

Exp.- The Indus Valley Civilization was a **Bronze Age** civilization. The people here knew how to make '**Bronze**' by mixing copper and tin, but they had no knowledge of **Iron**. The widespread use of iron in India began around the **Later Vedic Period** (circa 1000 BCE). **Ans. (b)**

14. Which of the following is correct regarding the Harappan drainage system?

- I. It was only for royal use
II. It was highly advanced and well planned

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- The drainage system of Harappa was **not only for royal use, but for the entire city**.

- It was one of the most developed systems of the ancient world. Drains were built in straight lines and intersected each other at right angles (**90°**); thus, this system was highly advanced and well-planned. **Ans. (b)**

15. Where was 'carnelian', a stone used by the Harappans for making beads, mostly found?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Assam (b) Gujarat
(c) Punjab (d) Bihar

Exp.- The Harappans mainly obtained **carnelian** stone, used for bead-making, from **Gujarat (Bharuch and Lothal)**.

- **Lothal** in Gujarat and **Chanhudaro** in Sindh were the most famous centers for bead-making.
- The main Harappan archaeological site in Punjab is **Ropar (modern Rupnagar)**. **Ans. (b)**

16. Which among the following is NOT true about the Harappan culture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) They worshipped a male deity called Pashupati
(b) Women wore ornaments made of gold, silver, copper, and bronze
(c) There is clear evidence for the practice of Sati
(d) Wheat and barley were the main crops grown

Exp.- Evidence of religious beliefs and ornaments is found in the Harappan culture, but there is **no clear archaeological evidence for the existence of the practice of Sati**. Scholars associate the joint burials found at Lothal with other social reasons rather than Sati. **Ans. (c)**

17. The drainage system at Mohenjodaro was notable because each house was connected to:

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) An underground water tank
(b) A central pillar for support
(c) A covered street drain
(d) A rooftop reservoir



Exp.- The drainage system of Mohenjodaro was unique, where the small drain of **each house was precisely connected to the covered main drain of the street**, through which waste water flowed out without interruption.

- ❑ **Baked bricks** and gypsum were used in the construction of drains, and the drains were spread across the city like a **'grid system'**. Ans. (c)

18. Read the following statements carefully:

Statement 1: The seals of the Harappan culture were made using locally found steatite.

Statement 2: These seals often feature animal motifs and undeciphered script symbols.

Which of the following is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only S1
(b) Only S2
(c) Both S1 and S2 are correct
(d) Neither S1 nor S2 is correct

Exp.- Harappan seals were primarily made of a soft stone called **steatite**, which was locally available and could be easily carved.

- ❑ These square/rectangular seals feature figures of animals (such as the bull, rhinoceros, elephant), religious symbols like the Pashupati seal, and signs of the Indus script, which remains undeciphered to this day. Ans. (c)

19. What significant agricultural evidence was discovered at the Harappan site of Kalibangan?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Water reservoirs with step-wells
(b) Remains of terraced rice fields
(c) Criss-cross plough marks in fields
(d) Stone granaries used for seed storage

Exp.- It was discovered in 1953 by **Amlanand Ghosh**. The literal meaning of **Kalibangan** is **'black bangles'**. Excavations at Kalibangan (Rajasthan) have yielded evidence of a **ploughed field**.

- ❑ The field has two sets of **furrows** at right angles to each other (**cross-grid pattern**), suggesting that two different crops (such as **gram and mustard**) were grown together at the same time. Ans. (c)

20. In the following questions, a statement of Assertion (A) is followed by a statement of Reason (R).

Select the correct option from the following:

Assertion (A): Rows of circular brick platforms at Harappa were used for religious ceremonies.

Reason (R): These platforms were found to contain wheat and barley grains.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both A and R are false.
(b) Both A and R are true, and R explains A.
(c) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- The massive platforms found in Harappa were not **used for religious ceremonies**; rather, evidence suggests that these platforms were used for threshing or cleaning grain. Thus, assertion (A) is false.

- ❑ Archaeologists have found charred grains of **wheat and barley** near these circular platforms and in their crevices. Therefore, reason (R) is true. Ans. (d)

21. The Harappans were the first in Eurasia to grow which crop?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Tobacco (b) Chilly
(c) Potato (d) Cotton

Exp.- Harappans were the **first people** to grow **cotton in the world** (Eurasia). The Greeks called it 'Sindon', which is derived from the word 'Sindhu'.

- ❑ The oldest cotton seeds have been found in Mehrgarh and remains of cotton cloth have been obtained from Mohenjodaro.
❑ Tobacco, chillies and potatoes were brought to India much later by the **Portuguese** (from the American continent). Ans. (d)

03

Vedic Period

Vedas and Upanishads

1. How is the Rig Veda best described in the context of ancient Indian literature?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Compilation of the Upanishads
(b) Collection of classical music
(c) Collection of royal history
(d) Collection of hymns from different eras

Exp.- The **Rigveda** is considered the cornerstone of ancient Indian literature and is said to be a **collection of hymns from different eras**, as it was composed by various sages over several centuries. It contains **1,028 hymns**, which praise various forms of nature and deities. Ans. (d)

2. The Mimamsa school of philosophy is primarily concerned with which aspect of the Vedas?

SSC PHASE XIII 24/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rituals and Dharma
(b) Meditation and Yoga
(c) Logic and Debate
(d) Atomic theory

Exp.- Mimamsa philosophy (also called 'Purva Mimamsa') is one of the six orthodox schools (**Shad-darshana**) of Indian philosophy. Mimamsa philosophy lays special emphasis on the ritualistic part of the Vedas and explains Yajnas. (sacrifices), **rituals, and religious duties**. Its objective is to establish **Dharma** through the observance of Vedic actions. Ans. (a)

3. The term 'Jambudvipa' used in Mahabharata is associated with which tree?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Banyan (b) Ashoka
(c) Neem (d) Jamun

Exp.- 'Jambu' means Jamun (Indian blackberry) and 'Dwipa' means region. According to the Mahabharata and the Puranas, there was an abundance of **Jamun trees** here, which is why it was called Jambudwipa. Ans. (d)

4. Which Vedic text category explains mantras and sacrificial rituals in prose form?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Samhitas (b) Aranyakas
(c) Brahmanas (d) Upanishads

Exp.- Brahmana texts explain Vedic hymns and sacrificial rituals in prose. They describe the performance of sacrifices, their procedures, and the spiritual meanings behind them in detail. The **'Aitareya Brahmana'** of the Rigveda and the **'Shatapatha Brahmana'** of the Shukla Yajurveda are the most famous.

- ❑ **Upanishads** are the philosophical part of Vedic literature. They contain descriptions of profound ideas related to the soul (**atman**), **brahma**, knowledge, and salvation (**moksha**). Ans. (c)

5. Rig Veda is a collection of approximately how many hymns?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 508 (b) 838
(c) 1028 (d) 1508

Exp.- Translation (NCERT Style) Explanation: The Rigveda contains approximately 1028 hymns (**Suktas**), comprising 1017 main hymns and 11 **'Balakhilya'** (supplementary) hymns.

- ❑ There are about 10,600 verses (**Richas**) in the Rigveda, which consist of prayers in praise of various deities. The Rigveda is divided into a total of **10 Mandalas**. Ans. (c)



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6. Who are traditionally believed to have composed the Vedic hymns in early Indian tradition?
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Kings
 (b) Scholars from Nalanda
 (c) Village elders
 (d) Rishis and Rishikas

Exp.- Traditionally, in the early Indian tradition, Vedic hymns are believed to have been composed by **rishis** (sages) and **rishikas** (female sages).

- The Rigveda mentions learned women (**rishikas**) such as Lopamudra, Ghosha, and Apala, who composed several hymns. **Ans. (d)**

7. The philosophical concept that everything in the universe is one divine essence is called _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Samiti (b) Yajna
 (c) Purandar (d) Brahm

Exp.- The philosophical concept that everything in the universe is a single divine element (Ultimate Truth) is called **Brahm**.

- 'Yagya' is a religious ritual, 'Purandara' is a name for Lord **Indra**, and 'Samiti' was a popular assembly of the Vedic period. **Ans. (d)**

8. In which Indian text does the name 'Bharata' first appear?
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Ramayan
 (b) Rig Veda
 (c) Meghdutam
 (d) Mahabharata

Exp.- The earliest mention of the name 'Bharat' (**Bharata**) is found in the **Rigveda**. The seventh mandala of the Rigveda describes the '**Battle of Ten Kings**' (Dashraja Yuddha), in which King **Sudas** of the Bharata tribe emerged victorious. Later, this region was named 'Bharat' after this tribe.

- Later, detailed descriptions under the name 'Bharatvarsha' are found in the Vishnu Purana and the **Mahabharata**. **Ans. (b)**

9. The term 'atman' in the Upanishads refers to _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Ritual fire
 (b) Sacred chant
 (c) Supreme god
 (d) The inner self or soul

Exp.- According to the Upanishads, 'Atman' is the **internal self**, **soul** of a person which is **immortal and indestructible**.

- The main philosophy of the Upanishads is that '**Atman**' (individual soul) and '**Brahman**' (universal ultimate reality) are ultimately one and the same. **Ans. (d)**

10. Which Veda contains hymns mostly taken from the Rigveda, arranged for singing?
 I. Samaveda
 II. Yajurveda
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Only I (b) Only II
 (c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Samaveda is called the '**father of Indian music**'. It contains a total of 1875 verses (richas), most of which have been taken from the **Rigveda**. In this, the hymns have been specifically arranged for **chanting/singing**.

- **Yajurveda** is a collection of rituals and rules to be followed during sacrifices (yagya). **Ans. (a)**

11. The summaries of conferences held in ancient India were called _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 12/11/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Ganas (b) Vedas
 (c) Puranas (d) Samhitas

Exp.- The literal meaning of **Samhita** is a collection or compilation, which represents the systematic summary of ancient assemblies or discussions.

- The word Gana means '**group**', the Vedas are **ancient texts** of knowledge and spiritual teachings, whereas the Puranas are an **extensive collection of historical, religious, and mythological narratives**. **Ans. (d)**

12. How many mandalas are there in the Rig Veda?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/10/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) 10 (b) 12
 (c) 9 (d) 11

Exp.- The **Rigveda**, which is the oldest religious text in the world, is divided into a total of **10 Mandalas** (books/chapters) containing **1,028 Suktas** (hymns) and approximately **10,580 Richas** (verses).

- Among these, the **second to seventh Mandalas** are considered the oldest (known as **Vansha Mandalas**), while the **first and tenth Mandalas** were added later. **Ans. (a)**

13. How is the Rigveda best described in the context of ancient Indian literature?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) A compilation of Upanishads
 (b) A collection of classical music
 (c) A collection of royal chronicles
 (d) A collection of hymns across ages

Exp.- The **Rigveda** is considered the foundation of ancient Indian literature and is regarded as a collection of hymns from different periods, as it was composed over several centuries by various sages.

- It contains **1,028 hymns (suktas)**, which praise the diverse forms of nature and various deities. **Ans. (d)**

14. In the Rigveda, what term is used for a collection of hymns?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Gayatris (b) Puranas
 (c) Suktas (d) Sūtras

Exp.- The collection of hymns in the Rigveda is called '**sukta**', which means '**well-said**'. There are **1,028 suktas** in the entire Rigveda, which is a collection of mantras composed by sages in praise of deities like **Agni, Indra, Varuna**, etc. **Ans. (c)**

15. Fill in the blank:

Each Mandala of the Rigveda is further subdivided into _____.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Suktas (b) Kandas
 (c) Puranas (d) Samhitas

Exp.- The **Rigveda** is the oldest religious text in the world, which includes **10 Mandalas, 1,028 Suktas**, and approximately **10,580 Richas (mantras)**. **Ans. (a)**

16. Which among the following is NOT a Vedanga, or the limbs of the Veda?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Kalpa (b) Vaisheshika
 (c) Vyakarana (d) Jyotisha

Exp.- Vaisheshika is one of the Shad-darshana (six schools of Indian philosophy) propounded by Maharishi Kanada, not a Vedanga.

- For the correct pronunciation and interpretation of the Vedas, there are six **Vedangas**— Shiksha (phonetics), Kalpa (rituals), Vyakarana (grammar), Nirukta (etymology), Chhanda (metrics), and Jyotisha (astronomy). **Ans. (b)**

17. The Rigveda is divided into how many Mandalas?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 8 (b) 10
 (c) 12 (d) 15

Exp.- The **Rigveda** is divided into **10 Mandalas** (books), containing **1,028 Suktas** (hymns) and **10,580 Richas** (verses). Its ancient Mandalas are **2-7**, while Mandalas **1 and 10** are the most recent. The **Gayatri Mantra**, composed by **Sage Vishvamitra**, is found in the third Mandala. The tenth Mandala contains the Purusha Sukta, which provides the first mention of the **four Varnas**, and the ninth Mandala is entirely dedicated to **Soma** (the god of plants/drink). **Ans. (b)**

18. In the context of the Rigveda, what does the term 'Rik' signify?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ritual sacrifice
 (b) Divine law
 (c) Sacred hymn
 (d) Ancient melody

Exp.- In Rigveda, 'Rik' means a sacred praise or hymn, which was composed in a metrical form in praise of deities. It contains **1,028 sukta (hymns)**, which were recited by the Hotri priests during yajnas. **Ans. (c)**

19. Which Veda primarily contains ritual formulas and detailed procedures for performing sacrifices?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Samaveda (b) Yajurveda
(c) Atharvaveda (d) Rigveda

Exp.- Yajurveda is primarily a collection of sacrifice, sacrificial and ritual formulae, describing detailed ritualistic procedures.

❑ **Samaveda** focuses on chant-based hymns, **Rigveda** on devotional hymns, and **Atharvaveda** focuses on magic-charms and medicine.

Ans. (b)

Rigvedic Society

20. Which of the following statements is true about the Rigvedic society?

SSC CPO TIER-1, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rigvedic society was matriarchal.
(b) The head of the family was called Vishyapati.
(c) Apala, Vishavara, Ghosha, and Lopamudra were prominent women poets of the Rigvedic period.
(d) Child marriage and the practice of Sati were prevalent.

Exp.- Apala, Visvavara, Ghosha, and Lopamudra were prominent female poets of the Rigvedic period. These women themselves composed hymns of the Rigveda, demonstrating the education and literary talent of women during that period.

Ans. (c)

21. The Rigveda points to an organized society. What kind of marriage existed there?

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- (a) Only monogamy was practiced
(b) Only polygamy was practiced
(c) Both monogamy and polygamy was practiced equally
(d) Monogamy was general rule but some princes practiced polygamy

Exp.- The Rigvedic society was **patriarchal** and organized, where marriage was a sacred institution. **Monogamy** was mainly practiced, though **polygamy was observed among the aristocracy**. Women enjoyed respect, the freedom to choose life partners, and opportunities for education; social evils like child marriage and **Sati pratha** did not exist.

Ans. (d)

22. The term "Jana" in the Rig Vedic period primarily referred to a:

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Large kingdom or empire.
(b) Tribe or a group of related families.
(c) Village unit.
(d) Professional guild.

Exp.- In the Rigvedic period, the word "**Jana**" was used for a group of people, clan, or tribe. The word "**Jana**" is mentioned **about 275 times** in the Rigveda, which shows its political and social importance. It was the largest socio-political unit of that time, led by the '**Rajan**'.

Ans. (b)

23. Which Mandal of the Rigveda is devoted to soma drink?

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Seventh
(b) Ninth
(c) Eleventh
(d) Thirteenth

Exp.- The **ninth mandala** of the Rigveda is entirely dedicated to **Soma** (a sacred drink and a deity). This mandala is also called the 'Soma Mandala' and contains a total of 114 hymns (suktas), which describe the purification of Soma and its religious significance.

Ans. (b)

24. Which of the following varnas in Vedic society was considered responsible for trade and business?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Vaishya
(b) Brahmin
(c) Shudra
(d) Kshatriya

Exp.- In Vedic society, the tasks of trade and commerce were assigned to the **Vaishya** varna. This varna occupied the third position in the hierarchy and was the mainstay of the society's economy.

❑ **Brahmans** were responsible for education and rituals, **Kshatriyas** for protection and administration, and **Shudras** for service-oriented tasks. The origin of the four varnas was mentioned for the first time in the '**Purusha Sukta**' of the 10th Mandala of the **Rigveda**.

Ans. (a)

25. Which of the following statement is correct?

- I. During the Vedic period the society was organised into four varnas.
II. Early Hindu philosophy prescribed the four stages of life.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I
(b) Only II
(c) Both I and II
(d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- During the Vedic period (especially the Later Vedic period), society was divided into **four varnas** named Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, and Shudra. This is mentioned in the '**Purusha Sukta**' of the **10th Mandala** of the Rigveda.

❑ In Hindu philosophy, the four stages of life are called the '**Ashrama**' system, which are: **Brahmacharya** (student life), **Grihastha** (family life), **Vanaprastha** (retirement), and **Sanyasa** (renunciation).

Ans. (c)

04

Jainism and Buddhism

Mahavira Swami

1. At what age did Mahavir Jain decide to leave his home in search of spiritual truth?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 25 (b) 30
(c) 35 (d) 40

Exp.- **Vardhamana Mahavira** left his home at the **age of 30** after the death of his parents in search of spiritual truth. After leaving home, he led a life of rigorous penance and meditation for the next **12 years**.

❑ At the age of **42**, he attained '**Kaivalya**' (Supreme Knowledge), after which he came to be known as '**Mahavira**'.

Ans. (b)

2. The Tattvarthadigamasutra, regarded as the first book on Jain philosophy, was authored by _____.

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Mahavira (b) Umaswami
(c) Bhadrabahu (d) Rishabhadeva

Exp.- 'Tattvarthadigama Sutra' (also known as 'Tattvartha Sutra') was composed by **Acharya Umaswami** (known as Umasvati in the Shvetambara tradition). It is also called Moksha Shastra, as it explains the essence of Jain philosophy and the path to liberation (**Samyag-darshana-jnana-charitrani mokshamargah**).

❑ Tattvartha Sutra is the only text that is equally recognized by both major sects of Jainism (Digambara and Shvetambara).

Ans. (b)

3. What philosophical system did Lord Mahavira develop?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Dvaita
(b) Syadvada
(c) Vedanta
(d) Mimamsa

Exp.- Lord Mahavira developed the **Syadvada** philosophical system; it is also called the 'theory of relativity,' which means that truth can have many aspects and our knowledge about any object is incomplete or relative.

❑ **Anekantavada** is the fundamental basis of Jain philosophy, which teaches that truth and reality are complex and can have many perspectives (nay).

Ans. (b)



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4. Mahavira Jain was born in a royal family near which ancient city?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Taxila (b) Vaishali
(c) Ujjain (d) Pataliputra

Exp.- Lord Mahavira was born in a royal family at **Kundagram** near Vaishali. He belonged to the **gayatrika** Kshatriya clan. His father's name was Siddhartha and his mother's name was Trishala. Mahavira was the **24th** Tirthankara of Jainism. **Ans. (b)**

5. Who was the first Tirthankara of Jainism?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Parshvanath (b) Rishabhadev
(c) Sambhavanath (d) Chandraprabha

Exp.- Rishabhdev (also known as Adinath) was the first of the 24 Tirthankaras of Jainism and is considered the founder of the present Jain religion. He was born in the Ikshvaku dynasty of Ayodhya and his symbol is the 'bull' (vrishabha). **Ans. (b)**

Gautama Buddha

6. Which of the following is an approximate year (in BCE) of birth of Gautama Buddha?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 560 (b) 432
(c) 361 (d) 263

Exp.- According to most scholars, the estimated birth year of Gautama Buddha is considered to be around **560 BCE**, while his death is believed to be in 483 BCE.

- Gautam Buddha was born in Lumbini (Nepal) into a Shakya Kshatriya family. At the age of 29, he renounced his home, and at the age of 35, he attained enlightenment in Bodh Gaya. **Ans. (a)**

7. What was the main function of 'Chaityas' in Buddhist architecture?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Living quarters for monks
(b) Storehouses for grains
(c) Decorative gateways to monasteries
(d) Congregational halls for teaching and interaction

Exp.- In Buddhist architecture, a **Chaitya** meant a **prayer hall or a place of worship**. Buddhist monks and devotees used to gather here for prayer, receiving religious education, and mutual discussions. Chaityas were usually rectangular with a stupa located at the end. **Ans. (d)**

8. During whose reign was the second Buddhist council was held?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ajatashatru
(b) Bimbisara
(c) Kalashoka
(d) Mahapadma Nanda

Exp.- The Second Buddhist Council was organized in **Vaishali** during the reign of Kalashoka.

- In this council, the Buddhist Sangha was divided for the first time into two groups: **Sthaviravada and Mahasanghika**.
□ The Second Buddhist Council was presided over by **Sabbakami (Sarvakami)**. **Ans. (c)**

9. Which two causes did the Buddha identify as the roots of human suffering?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Hunger and Thirst
(b) War and Poverty
(c) Ignorance and Attachment
(d) Violence and Disease

Exp.- According to Buddha, the root cause of human suffering is **Avidya (ignorance)** and **Moha (attachment)**. According to Buddha, the failure to understand reality is the root cause of suffering, which is called **Avidya (ignorance)**.

- **Moha or Trishna** means excessive attachment and desire for the transient things of the world, which keeps a human being bound to the cycle of birth, death, and suffering.
□ According to Buddha, suffering can be ended by following the 'Dukkha Nirodha Gamini Pratipada', that is, the **Eightfold Path (Ashtangika Marga)**. **Ans. (c)**

10. Where did Siddhartha Gautam meditate for many days?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lumbini (b) Bodh Gaya
(c) Varanasi (d) Ujjain

Exp.- Siddhartha Gautama meditated under a Peepal tree on the banks of the Niranjana river in **Bodh Gaya** and attained enlightenment at the age of **35** to become the Buddha, and that same tree is known as the Bodhi tree.

- Lumbini is the birthplace of the Buddha, while in **Sarnath** (Varanasi) he gave his first sermon (Dharmachakra Pravartana). **Ans. (b)**

11. Kanishka convened the Fourth Buddhist Council at which of the following place?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Vaishali
(b) Ujjain
(c) Gwalior
(d) Kundalavana

Exp.- Kanishka organized the fourth Buddhist Council in **Kudalvan (Kashmir)**.

Council	Place	Ruler	Chairman
First	Rajgriha	Ajatashatru	Mahakas-hyapa
Second	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Sabakami
Third	Patali-putra	Ashoka	Moggali-putta Tissa
Fourth	Kudalvan	Kanishka	Vasumitra

Ans. (d)

12. Which of the following Buddhist Councils and their locations are correctly matched?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) First Buddhist Council – Rajagriha
(b) Second Buddhist Council – Lumbini
(c) Third Buddhist Council – Kashmir
(d) Fourth Buddhist Council – Pataliputra

Exp.- The First Buddhist Council was held in 483 B.C.E. at the Saptaparni Cave in **Rajagriha** under the patronage of Ajatashatru, immediately after the Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha.

- In contrast, the second council was held at Vaishali, the **third council** at Pataliputra (during the time of Ashoka), and the **fourth council** at Kundalvana, Kashmir (during the time of Kanishka). **Ans. (a)**

13. Who among the following is NOT a disciple of Buddha?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ananda
(b) Upali
(c) Sariputta
(d) Susima

Exp.- Susima was a wandering monk (bhikshu) who joined the Buddhist Sangha solely to gain knowledge, and he is not counted among the principal disciples of the Buddha.

- In contrast, Ananda was the Buddha's personal attendant, Upali was an expert in the Vinaya, and **Sariputta** was considered one of the wisest disciples of the Buddha. **Ans. (d)**



05

Mahajanapadas and Magadha Empire

Mahajanapadas

1. The famous center of learning, 'Takshashila', was the capital of which Mahajanapada in ancient India?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Avanti (b) Gandhara
(c) Kamboja (d) Kosala

Exp.- In ancient India, Taxila was a renowned centre of learning and the capital of the **Gandhara Mahajanapada**, located in the present-day Rawalpindi district of Pakistan.

- Avanti's capitals were Ujjaini (northern) and Mahishmati (southern), and Kosala's capital was Shravasti. **Ans. (b)**

2. Match the Mahajanapada with its capital:

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-03)

Column A: Mahajanapada	Column B: Capital
1. Vatsa	a. Kaushambi
2. Magadha	b. Rajagriha
3. Kuru	c. Ujjayini
4. Avanti	d. Indraprastha

- (a) 1 - a, 2 - b, 3 - d, 4 - c
(b) 1 - b, 2 - a, 3 - c, 4 - d
(c) 1 - c, 2 - d, 3 - a, 4 - b
(d) 1 - d, 2 - c, 3 - b, 4 - a

Exp.-

Mahajanapada	Capital	Current Location (Approximate)
1. Vatsa	Koshambi	Uttar Pradesh (near Prayagraj)
2. Magadha	Rajagriha / Girivraja	Bihar (Patna and Gaya district)
3. Kuru	Indraprastha	Delhi, Meerut and Haryana region
4. Avanti	Ujjayini / Mahishmati	Madhya Pradesh (Malwa region)

Ans. (a)

3. 'Rajagriha' was the capital city of which Mahajanapada in ancient India?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Vatsa (b) Kosala
(c) Matsya (d) Magadh

Exp.- Rajagriha (present-day Rajgir) was the first major capital of the **Magadha Mahajanapada**, which was founded by Bimbisara.

- Rajagriha was a fortified city surrounded by **five hills**, which was later shifted to Pataliputra during the reign of Ajatashatru. The first Buddhist Council was also organized in Rajgir. **Ans. (d)**

4. Under the policy of matrimonial alliances, Bimbisara married the sister of which king of Kosala?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Chetak (b) Ajatashatru
(c) Prasenjit (d) Brahmadatta

Exp.- Under the policy of **matrimonial alliances**, Bimbisara married the sister of **Prasenajit**, the King of **Kosala**.

- As a result of this alliance, Bimbisara received the region of **Kashi** as **dowry**, which yielded an annual income of 1 lakh to **Magadha**.
□ Bimbisara used matrimonial relations to strengthen his position; he also married the **Licchavi princess Chellana** and the **Madra princess Khema**. **Ans. (c)**

5. In ancient India, the Mahajanapada of 'Anga' had its capital at which city in Bihar?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Vaishali (b) Champa
(c) Kausambi (d) Gaya

Exp.- The ancient Anga Mahajanapada was located in the Bhagalpur and Munger districts of modern Bihar. Its capital was **Champa**, which was situated at the confluence of the Ganga and Champa rivers.

- According to the Buddhist text Anguttara Nikaya, there were **16 Mahajanapadas** in ancient India.
□ The capital of Vatsa was **Kaushambi** (Prayagraj) and the capital of **Vajji** was Vaishali, which was a republican state. **Ans. (b)**

6. Match the following Janapadas with their capitals:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

Column A	Column B
1. Kashi	a. Varanasi
2. Kosala	b. Shravasti
3. Avanti	c. Ujjayini
4. Magadha	d. Rajagriha

- (a) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d
(b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c
(c) 1-d, 2-c, 3-a, 4-b
(d) 1-c, 2-d, 3-b, 4-a

Exp.-

Kingdom (Janapada)	Capital
Kashi	Varanasi
Kosala	Shravasti
Avanti	Ujjayini
Magadha	Rajagriha

Ans. (a)

7. Which Mahajanapada rose to political and military prominence between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Avanti
(b) Kuru
(c) Gandhara
(d) Magadha

Exp.- Between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE, Magadha emerged as the most powerful Mahajanapada. The reasons for its power included iron ore, the fertility of the Ganga valley, and efficient leadership.

Mahajanapada	Capital
Magadha	Rajgir (Girivraja)
Avanti	Ujjain
Gandhara	Taxila

Ans. (d)

Haryanka Dynasty

8. Which of the following kings ruled during the lifetimes of both Buddha and Mahavira?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Ashok
(c) Ajatashatru
(d) Harshavardhana

Exp.- **Ajatashatru** was the king of the **Haryanka dynasty** of Magadha. He was a contemporary of both Gautama Buddha and Mahavira Swami.

- Immediately after the death of the Buddha, Ajatashatru organized the **First Buddhist Council** (Chairman - Mahakassapa) in Rajagriha (present-day Rajgir) in 483 BCE.
□ He attained power by imprisoning his father, Bimbisara, and used advanced weapons like **Rathamusala** and **Mahashilakantaka** to expand the Magadha Empire. **Ans. (c)**

9. What was the political significance of Bimbisara's marriage to a Kosala princess?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Spread of Buddhism
(b) Peace with Kosala
(c) Trade with South India
(d) Fall of Pasenadi

Exp.- **Bimbisara** (544 BCE to 492 BCE) received the region of Kashi after his marriage to Kosala Devi, the princess of Kosala (sister of King Prasenajit). This ended the long-standing political rivalry between Magadh and Kosala.

- Bimbisara married the Licchavi princess 'Chellana' (securing the northern frontier) and 'Khema', the princess of the Madra clan of Punjab. **Ans. (b)**



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10. _____ in Bihar was the capital of Magadha for several years. Later the capital was shifted to Pataliputra.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rajagriha (b) Ujjain
(c) Vaishali (d) Taxila

Exp.- For many years, **Rajagriha** remained the capital of Magadha. However, during the reign of Udayin, a ruler of the Haryanka dynasty, **Pataliputra** became the capital of Magadha, which was situated at the confluence of the Ganga and Son rivers.

- Pataliputra had become a more strategic center for trade and military operations due to its **water-fort (jal-durga)** like position. **Ans. (a)**

Nanda Empire

11. Which ancient Sanskrit grammarian lived during the time of the Nandas?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Kalidasa (b) Aryabhata
(c) Panini (d) Patanjali

Exp.- During the era of the Nanda dynasty, the renowned Sanskrit grammarian **Panini lived**, who authored the **Ashtadhyayi**.

- Patanjali belonged to the Shunga period, Kalidasa to the Gupta period, and Aryabhata was also a celebrated astronomer of the Gupta era. **Ans. (c)**

12. Which ruler was the founder of the Nanda Dynasty?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Dhanananda
(c) Mahapadma Nanda
(d) Chandragupta Maurya

Exp.- Mahapadmananda laid the foundation of the **Nanda dynasty** in Magadha by ending the Shishunaga dynasty.

- Dhanananda was the last ruler of this dynasty, by defeating whom **Chandragupta Maurya** established the Maurya dynasty.
□ **Ashoka** was the third and most powerful king of the Maurya dynasty, who ruled over almost the entire Indian subcontinent. **Ans. (c)**

06

Mauryan Empire

Chandragupta Maurya/Bindusara

1. _____ was an ambassador who was sent to the court of Chandragupta by the Greek ruler of West Asia.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Al-Biruni
(b) Ibn Battuta
(c) Marco Polo
(d) Megasthenes

Exp.- **Megasthenes** was a Greek ambassador, who was sent by Seleucus Nicator to the court of the Mauryan ruler Chandragupta Maurya. He wrote a famous book called **Indica**, which is an important source of information about Mauryan administration and society.

Ans. (d)

2. Which ruler founded the Mauryan Empire?

SSC Stenographer 06-08-2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Brihadrath
(b) Chandragupta Maurya
(c) Ashoka
(d) Bindusara

Exp.- The Mauryan Empire was founded in **321 BCE by Chandragupta Maurya**, with the help of his mentor Chanakya (Kautilya), after defeating Dhanananda, the last ruler of the Nanda dynasty.

- Chandragupta laid the foundation of a vast empire that stretched from the Hindu Kush Mountains in the northwest to the Bengal region in the east. **Ans. (b)**

3. Which Mauryan ruler is credited with the establishment of the spy system in his empire?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Bindusara
(b) Brihadrath
(c) Ashoka
(d) Chandragupta Maurya

Exp.- **Chandragupta Maurya** is credited with establishing a comprehensive and organized **spy system** in India. With the help of his mentor, **Chanakya**, he developed an information network that not only kept a watch on external enemies but also eliminated the possibilities of corruption and rebellion within the empire.

- **Chanakya** described the spies as **“the eyes and ears of the King.”** **Ans. (d)**

4. Around which year (in BC) did Chandragupta Maurya establish the Maurya Empire?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 211
(b) 321
(c) 426
(d) 524

Exp.- Chandragupta Maurya, with the help of his guru **Chanakya (Kautilya)**, laid the foundation of the Mauryan Empire in **321 BCE by defeating Dhanananda, the last ruler** of the Nanda dynasty.

- He created a vast centralized empire that extended from Afghanistan in the north-west to Karnataka in the south. **Ans. (b)**

5. The First Jain Council was convened at Pataliputra by whom?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Bhadrabahu
(b) Sthulabahu
(c) Moggallanna
(d) Rahula

Exp.- The first Jain Council was organized in Pataliputra around 300 BCE during the reign of the Maurya Emperor **Chandragupta Maurya**, and it was presided over by **Sthulabahu** (Sthulabhadra).

□ During this council, ideological differences emerged within Jainism, as a result of which the Jain Sangha was divided into two major sects: **Shvetambara** (under the leadership of Sthulabahu) and **Digambara** (under the leadership of Bhadrabahu). **Ans. (b)**

6. Which ancient ruler's administration is noted for its highly centralized structure?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 12/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Harshavardhana
(b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta Maurya
(d) Pulakeshin II

Exp.- The administration of **Chandragupta Maurya** was famous for its highly centralized structure in ancient India, which was established under the guidance of provincial division, bureaucracy, and espionage system described in **Kautilya's (Chanakya) Arthashastra**.

Ans. (c)

Ashoka

7. Which emperor's reign saw great advancements in Mauryan architecture?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Bimbisara
(b) Bindusara
(c) Ashoka
(d) Ajatashatru

Exp.- Emperor Ashoka had established **monolithic pillars** and **inscriptions** throughout his empire for the propagation of Buddhism.

- Ashoka built many stupas, among which the **Sanchi Stupa is the most famous**. **Ans. (c)**

8. What is the classical feature of Ashokan pillars?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) They had capitals topped with lion sculptures
- (b) They were only found in South India
- (c) They were made of bronze and silver
- (d) They served as fire altars

Exp.- The classical feature of the **Ashokan pillars** established for the propagation of **Dhamma** is the presence of **lion sculptures** at their top. Particularly famous is the **Sarnath pillar**, the **National Emblem of India**, which features a joint sculpture of **four lions**.

- These pillars are made of a **single stone** (monolithic) and are shaped such that they are **thick at the base** and **tapered towards the top**. **Ans. (a)**

9. Ashoka's famous stone pillars were mainly carved from which rock?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Marble
- (b) Granite
- (c) Sandstone
- (d) Basalt

Exp.- The famous stone pillars of **Ashoka** were primarily made of **red and yellow-spotted sandstone** obtained from the **Chunar hills** near **Mirzapur** in **Uttar Pradesh**.

- The most significant feature of Ashoka's pillars was that they were **'Monolithic'**, which means the entire pillar was carved out of a **single large piece of stone**. **Ans. (c)**

10. How many major rock edicts are there of Emperor Ashoka?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 10
- (b) 12
- (c) 14
- (d) 16

Exp.- There are **14 Major Rock Edicts** of Emperor Ashoka, which are inscribed at various places. These are focused on **Dhamma policy, morality, non-violence and social welfare**. The **total number of inscriptions is 33**, which includes 14 Major Rock Edicts, 7 Pillar Edicts, Minor Rock Edicts, and Cave Inscriptions. **Ans. (c)**

11. Which script is predominantly used in the inscriptions of Emperor Ashoka?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Kharosthi
- (b) Devanagari
- (c) Tamil
- (d) Brahmi

Exp.- Most of Emperor Ashoka's inscriptions are in the Prakrit language and **Brahmi script**, which was written from left to right. They were first deciphered by James Prinsep in **1837 CE**.

- In some parts of north-western India and Afghanistan (such as Kandahar), inscriptions have also been found in Kharosthi (written from right to left), Greek, and Aramaic languages/scripts, because the cultural influence there was different. **Ans. (d)**

12. Which foreign element, stemming from Achaemenid Persia, influenced Mauryan sculpture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Use of terracotta
- (b) Bold and massive realism
- (c) Employment of specific deities
- (d) Intricate filigree work

Exp.- Mauryan **court art**, particularly the **animal capitals** of Ashokan pillars, reflects the influence of **Achaemenian Persian realism**. This is evident in features such as bold figures, **mirror-like polish**, and the **bell-shaped base**.

- The capitals featuring the **lion, bull, and elephant** are a blend of Persian realism and **Indian symbolism**.
- The **80-pillared hall** at Pataliputra is often compared to the palace at **Persepolis** in Persia. **Ans. (b)**

13. Which of the following animals were NOT found on Mauryan stone pillars?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lions
- (b) Bulls
- (c) Elephants
- (d) Eagle

Exp.- Figures of the lion, bull, elephant, and horse are mainly found on the stone pillars of the Mauryan period, whereas the **Garuda** was prominently used as a royal symbol and on pillars (such as the Garuda pillar of Eran) after the Mauryan period, specifically during the **Gupta period**.

- On the famous Lion Capital of Sarnath, the bull, elephant, horse, and lion (all four animals) are carved along with a wheel.
- Pillar capitals of a 'Lion' at Lauriya Nandangarh, an 'Elephant' at Sankissa, and a 'Bull' at Rampurva have been found. **Ans. (d)**

14. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched with Ashokan pillar sites?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 13/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Lauriya Nandangarh – Bihar
- (b) Sarnath – Gujarat
- (c) Sanchi – Odisha
- (d) Amaravati – Madhya Pradesh

Exp.- The Ashoka Pillar is located in **Lauriya Nandangarh, Bihar**, where a **pillar with a single lion capital** exists.

- This pillar is one of the pillar edicts of Ashoka, on which **teachings related to Dhamma** are inscribed.
- The Sarnath Ashoka Pillar is in Uttar Pradesh, (a) the **Sanchi Pillar is in Madhya Pradesh and the Amaravati Pillar is located in Andhra Pradesh**. **Ans. (a)**

Mauryan Administration

15. Most of Ashoka's edicts were composed in which language?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Pali
- (b) Arabic
- (c) Prakrit
- (d) English

Exp.- Most of Ashoka's inscriptions were in the Prakrit language and were mainly written in **Brahmi** and **Kharosthi scripts**, while some inscriptions in the Afghanistan region have also been found in **Greek** and **Aramaic** languages. **Ans. (c)**

16. Who authored the treatise 'Arthashastra' that deals primarily with statecraft?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Kautilya
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Visakhadatta
- (d) Megasthenes

Exp.- The text Arthashastra was authored by **Kautilya (Chanakya)**, which is based on governance and politics.

- It describes the **seven organs** of the state (*Swami, Amatya, Janapada, Durga, Kosha, Danda and Mitra*).
- **Mudrarakshasa** is the most famous historical play by Vishakhadatta, based on the diplomacy of Chanakya and the story of Chandragupta Maurya becoming emperor.
- The most prominent and famous work of **Megasthenes** is **'Indica'**. **Ans. (a)**

17. The life-size standing image of Yakshini holding a chauri (flywhisk) is an example of the sculptural tradition of which period?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Mauryan Period
- (b) Gupta Period
- (c) Kushan Period
- (d) Sunga Period

Exp.- The **'Chamar-dharini'** (holding a chauri/fly-whisk) Yakshini statue found at Didarganj (Bihar) is considered the finest example of **Mauryan sculpture**.

- This statue is famous for the characteristic **'polished'** surface of the **Mauryan period**, which still shines like a mirror even today. **Ans. (a)**



07

Post Mauryan Period

Shunga

1. Who was the last ruler of the Sunga Dynasty?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Vasudeva
(b) Pushyamitra Sunga
(c) Devabhuti
(d) Agnimitra

Exp.- The last ruler of the **Shunga dynasty (185 - 73 BCE)** was **Devabhuti**. His reign lasted from **83-73 BCE**, and his minister **Vasudeva Kanva** assassinated him to establish the **Kanva dynasty**.

Ans. (c)

Shakas/Kushan

2. What title did many Kushana rulers adopt to signify their divine status?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rajadhiraja (b) Chakravartin
(c) Devaputra (d) Maharajadhiraja

Exp.- Many Kushana rulers adopted the title '**Devaputra**' (Son of God) to emphasize their divine origin and sacred authority. This title was inspired by Chinese rulership concepts and is found in **Kushana inscriptions** and coin legends, especially during the reign of kings like Kanishka.

Ans. (c)

3. Given below are two statements:

Statement I: The construction of Stupas, Chaityas, and Viharas became a significant trend during 200 B.C.-300 A.D.

Statement II: These structures were primarily secular in nature and excluded religious significance.

Which of the following statements is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both statements are true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I.
(b) Both statements are true but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I.
(c) Statement I is true but Statement II is false.
(d) Both statements are false.

Exp.- Between **200 BCE and 300 CE (Post-Mauryan Period - Shunga, Satavahana, and Kushana dynasties)**, the construction of **Stupas, Chaityas, and Viharas** in India was at its **climax** (peak) due to the influence of **Buddhism**. **Sanchi, Bharhut, and Amaravati** are prominent examples of this. Therefore, statement I is correct.

□ These structures were **religious** rather than **secular**. '**Chaityas**' were **prayer halls** for Buddhist monks, '**Viharas**' were their **residences (monasteries)**, and '**Stupas**' were centers of reverence associated with the **sacred relics of the Buddha**. Therefore, their entire foundation was religious. Therefore, statement II is incorrect.

Ans. (c)

4. Which among the following statements is not true about Kanishka?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) He patronized Buddhist scholars Vasumitra, Asvagosha and Nagarjuna
(b) He convened Fourth Buddhist Council
(c) Kaniska was succeeded by his son Vasudeva
(d) The famous physician Charaka was patronized by him

Exp.- Immediately after the greatest ruler of the Kushana dynasty, **Kanishka, Huvishka** took over the reign, while Vasudeva was one of the last major rulers of this dynasty.

□ The period of Kanishka is famous for its cultural and religious achievements, during which he organized the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir and patronized Buddhist scholars like Ashvagosha, Vasumitra, **Nagarjuna**, and the giant of the ancient Indian medical system, **Charaka**, as his royal physician.

Ans. (c)

Satavahana Dynasty

5. Gautamiputra Satakarni, who ruled in the first century AD, is regarded as the greatest among which dynasty's rulers?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gupta rulers
(b) Maurya rulers
(c) Chola rulers
(d) Satavahana rulers

Exp.- **Gautamiputra Satakarni** was the 23rd and the most illustrious ruler of the **Satavahana dynasty**. He restored the lost prestige of his dynasty by defeating the **Shakas** (Western Kshatrapas).

□ Among the Satavahana kings, there was a custom of using **metronymics** (names derived from the mother's name). Therefore, he is called '**Gautamiputra**' (meaning the son of **Gautami Balashri**).

Ans. (d)

08

Gupta Empire

Rulers of the Gupta dynasty

1. Which of the following rulers founded the Nalanda University?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Chandragupta
(c) Sri Gupta
(d) Kumaragupta

Exp.- The most important and world-famous center of higher education in ancient India, **Nalanda University**, was established by **Kumaragupta I**, a ruler of the Gupta dynasty.

Ans. (d)

2. The famous Chinese pilgrim Fahien visited India during the reign of ____.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Chandragupta II
(b) Kumaragupta
(c) Samudragupta
(d) Chandragupta I

Exp.- The famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien, who stayed in India from 399 AD to 412 AD, visited India during the reign of **Chandragupta II (Chandragupta Vikramaditya)**.

□ He gave a detailed description of the social, economic, and religious conditions of India in his book '**Fo-Kuo-Ki**' (**Record of Buddhist Kingdoms**).

Ans. (a)

3. Which of the following works was authored by Varahamihira?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mrichchakatika
(b) Sushruta Samhita
(c) Brihat Samhita
(d) Dashakumaracharita

Exp.-

Option	Composition	Author
A	Mricchakatika	Shudraka
B	Sushruta Samhita	Sushruta
C	Brihat Samhita	Varahmihir
D	Dashakumaracharita	Dandin

Ans. (c)



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4. Samudragupta celebrated his conquests by performing which Vedic sacrifice?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Shraddha (b) Agnihotra
(c) Upanayana (d) Ashvamedha

Exp.- Samudragupta performed the **Ashvamedha Yajna** to celebrate his military victories, an act that symbolized his imperial power and sovereignty.

- A detailed account of these victories can be found in the Prayag Prashasti, composed by **Samudragupta's** court poet, **Harishena**. **Ans. (d)**

5. Which of the following is a primary literary source for the Gupta period?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Nasik Prashasti of Gautamiputra Satakarni
(b) Aihole Inscription of Pulakeshin II
(c) Allahabad Pillar Inscription of Samudragupta
(d) Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela

Exp.- The Allahabad Pillar Inscription of Samudragupta (also known as the **Prayag Prashasti**) is one of the most important and direct archaeological sources of the Gupta Empire, which provides detailed information about the reign of Samudragupta. It was written in Sanskrit by Samudragupta's court poet, **Harishena**. **Ans. (c)**

6. Which Indian ruler is famously known as the "Napoleon of India"?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Samudragupta
(c) Harshavardhana
(d) Chandragupta Maurya

Exp.- Samudragupta has been called the "**Napoleon of India**" by V.A. Smith because of his extensive military conquests and imperial expansion. He defeated **9** kings of North India (Aryavarta) and **12** kings of South India (Dakshinapatha).

- A detailed description of these victories is found in the Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar Inscription) composed by his court poet Harishena. **Ans. (b)**

7. Which of the following titles means "Lord of the three worlds"?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Maharaja-adhiraja
(b) Tribhuvana-chakravartin
(c) Ektrat-Samrat
(d) Devraja

Exp.- In Sanskrit, 'Tri' means three, 'Bhuvan' means world, and 'Chakravartin' means emperor; that is, 'Lord of the three worlds'.

- In the medieval period, powerful kings like the Rashtrakutas and Cholas adopted such impressive titles to demonstrate their greatness.

- '**Maharaja-Adhiraj**' means '**king of kings**', which was quite prevalent during the Gupta period. **Ans. (b)**

8. Who was the composer of the Allahabad pillar inscription of Samudragupta?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Simuka (b) Kalidasa
(c) Harisena (d) Simhavishnu

Exp.- Harisena, the author of Samudragupta's Allahabad Pillar Inscription, was the court poet and minister (**Sandhivigrahika**) of Samudragupta.

- The Allahabad Pillar Inscription, also known as the **Prayag Prashasti**, is written in **Sanskrit** in the Champu Kavya style (a mixture of prose and verse).

- It provides a detailed description of Samudragupta's conquests, his military achievements, and the expansion of the Gupta Empire. **Ans. (c)**

9. During the Gupta period, 'Bhagvatism', which emphasized bhakti and ahimsa, centered on the worship of which deity?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Shiva (b) Vishnu
(c) Brahma (d) Indra

Exp.- During the Gupta period, Bhagavatism was centered on the worship of Vishnu (Lord Krishna/Vasudeva), emphasizing devotion (bhakti) and non-violence (ahimsa).

- Gupta kings called themselves 'Param Bhagavata' and gave state patronage to Vaishnavism. 'Garuda', the vehicle of Lord Vishnu, was the royal emblem of the Gupta dynasty. **Ans. (b)**

Gupta Period Administration

10. In the context of Gupta dynasty's administration, which of the following officers is correctly paired with their respective role?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Utkhetayita - Keeper of Royal Kitchen
(b) Dhruvadhikaranika - Chief Judicial Officer
(c) Pustapala - Notary and Keeper of Records
(d) Bhandagaradhikrita - Head of Village Watchmen

Exp.- During the Gupta period, the Pustapala maintained records of land transactions and important documents at the district level.

- On the other hand, the **Dhruvadhikaranika** was the officer in charge of land revenue collection, and the **Bhandagaradhikrita** was the keeper of the royal treasury. **Ans. (c)**

11. In the context of Gupta dynasty's urban administration, which of the following statements about the Adhistanadhikarana is correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) It was a military council composed entirely of royal generals.
(b) It was a court of law dealing exclusively with religious matters.
(c) It was a Board of Advisors representing guilds, artisans, and scribes.
(d) It was a temple committee managing offerings and rituals.

Exp.- During the Gupta period, a city council called the Adhistanadhikarana functioned for district/city administration, which, according to the Damodarpur copper plates, assisted the Vishayapati in administration.

- It included four prominent representatives of the local communities: **Nagarasreshthin** (chief merchant), **Sarthavaha** (leader of the merchant caravans), **Prathama-Kulika** (chief artisan), and **Prathama-Kayastha** (chief scribe). **Ans. (c)**

12. Which of the following fiscal terms related to Gupta dynasty is correctly matched?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Utkhetayita - temple priest
(b) Bhaga - judicial fee
(c) Vaishthika - forced labour
(d) Dasaparadha - annual cattle tax

Exp.- Vishti: In the Gupta period, this was forced labor, which the **state took as a tax**, (usually 1/6 of the produce) and **Dashaparadha** was the penalty collected for ten offenses.

- Other revenue terms included **Bhoga** (offerings to the King), **Udranga** (land revenue from permanent farmers), **Uparikara** (additional tax on temporary/outside farmers) and **Shulka** (commercial tolls/customs duty). **Ans. (c)**

13. Which title used by Gupta rulers reflected their Vaishnavite affiliation?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Lokadhama-deva
(b) Parameshvara
(c) Paramabhagavata
(d) Paramatman

Exp.- The Gupta rulers were primarily Vaishnavas, and therefore they assumed the title of 'Paramabhagavata', which reflects their faith in Lord Vishnu.

- The depiction of **Garuda** on their **coins and seals** also serves as evidence of this. Rulers such as **Chandragupta II, Kumaragupta, and Skandagupta** referred to themselves as 'Paramabhagavata' in their **inscriptions**. **Ans. (c)**

14. Which term-meaning pair is accurate in relation to the Gupta dynasty?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Vaishthika - enjoyment tax
(b) Bhaga - forced-labour levy
(c) Adeya - "that which is to be surrendered" (tribute/dues)
(d) Dasaparadha - grain tithe

Exp.- In the administrative and revenue terminology of the Gupta period, the term 'Adeya' was used for dues or taxes. Its literal meaning is 'that which should be given' or 'fit to be offered'.

□ Bhaga was the regular share of the produce given to the King. **Ans. (c)**

15. Determine the correctly matched pair for Gupta-era obligations.

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Dasaparadha – fines from ten offences
- (b) Bhoga – free labour levy
- (c) Adeya – registry-keeping duty
- (d) Dhanya – forced labour

Exp.- In the Gupta period, **Dashaparadha** was a judicial punishment or fine imposed for ten specific types of offenses (such as theft, murder, adultery, etc.).

□ Other taxes of the Gupta period were **Udranga** (tax on permanent peasants) and **Uparikara** (tax on temporary peasants). Additionally, the tax levied on goods produced within the state and on imported items was known as **Bhutovatapratyaya**. **Ans. (a)**

16. According to the Gupta dynasty's administrative structure, which one of the following pairs of officer and role is correctly matched?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Prathamakulika – Public Works Supervisor
- (b) Gramika (Gramadhyaksha) – Village Headman
- (c) Talavataka – Military Paymaster
- (d) Pustapala – Tax-Collection Officer

Exp.- The Gramika was the head of the smallest unit of Gupta administration, who was known as the 'Gram Pradhan' or village headman.

□ The **Gramika** (village headman) performed tasks such as resolving disputes, collecting taxes, and maintaining law and order with the help of a council of elders (**Panchamandali**).

□ The **Prathamakulika** was the head of the artisans, and the **Pustapala** was the keeper of official records. **Ans. (b)**

17. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched in accordance with Gupta's administration (Officer–Stated Role)?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Dhruvadhikaranika – Treasurer
- (b) Bhandagaradhikrita – Chief of Police
- (c) Talavataka – Village Accountant
- (d) Utkhetayita – Land-Survey Officer

Exp.- During the Gupta period, Talavataka oversaw administration at the village level and served as the village accountant.

Officer	Department
Dhruvadhikaranika	Collection of Land Revenue

Bhandagaradhikrita	In-charge of the Storehouse
Utkhetayita	Tax Collector

Ans. (c)

18. In the context of Gupta dynasty's taxation, which pair is correct?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Adeya – penalty for libellous speech
- (b) Bhaga – king's share of produce
- (c) Hiranya – forced labour
- (d) Dhanyagold – bullion fee

Exp.- During the Gupta period, **Bhaga** was an important tax, which amounted to **1/6th** of the total produce. It was a compulsory tax.

□ Other taxes of the Gupta period included **Uparikara**, **Bhoga**, and **Udranga**. **Shulka** was a commercial tax that had to be paid to the traders' guilds. **Ans. (b)**

19. Which of the following statements about the Mahasandhivigrahika during Gupta's rule is correct?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) He was the chief justice of the kingdom and presided over land disputes.
- (b) He supervised irrigation works and public revenue collection.
- (c) He acted as the foreign minister and collaborated closely with the king and military.
- (d) He managed temple endowments and religious affairs.

Exp.- Mahasandhivigrahika used to be the **foreign minister** of the Gupta period, who managed **Sandhi-Vigrah (policy of peace and war)**. Samudragupta's poet **Harishena** was himself a Mahasandhivigrahika. This post was associated with both diplomacy and military strategy. **Ans. (c)**

20. Determine the correctly matched Gupta fiscal term with its meaning.

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Hiranya - compulsory labour service
- (b) Dhana - gold tax
- (c) Bhoga - king's share of produce
- (d) Vaishthika - forced or corvée labour

Exp.- During the Gupta period, 'Vaishthika' (also known as 'Vishti') was **forced or compulsory labour** taken by the State, for which the labourers were not paid any remuneration. On the other hand, Hiranya was a tax collected in cash (gold) and Dhanya was a tax collected in the form of grain.

□ According to Gupta inscriptions, the King's customary share of the agricultural produce was called 'Bhaga', which was generally **1/6 part** of the total produce. **Ans. (d)**

21. Which of the following correctly describes the Sarthavaha in Gupta dynasty's administration?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 15/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Chief artisan overseeing temples and sculpture guilds.
- (b) Officer-in-charge of military recruitment.
- (c) Head of the trading guilds representing various trading communities.
- (d) Official supervising irrigation and waterworks.

Exp.- During the Gupta period, the Sarthavaha, the head of merchant guilds/associations, represented various merchant communities. These guilds were autonomous in economic matters and played an important role in tax collection and trade regulation. **Ans. (c)**

Gupta Period Temples/Religion

22. The first temple-building activity in India began during the rule of which dynasty?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gupta Dynasty
- (b) Ahom Kingdom
- (c) Vijayanagara Empire
- (d) Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty

Exp.- The first temple construction activity in India began during the Gupta period. The **Gupta period** is considered the 'Golden Age' of Indian temple architecture, where the Panchayatana style and temples with Shikhara originated.

□ Early temples started being built with **stone and bricks** instead of wood or bamboo, such as the Dashavatara Temple of Deogarh, Jhansi. **Ans. (a)**

23. Which of the following period is known as the "Golden age" of Indian temple architecture?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gupta period
- (b) Maurya Period
- (c) Delhi Sultanate Period
- (d) Mughal Period

Exp.- The **Gupta period** is known as the "**Golden Age**" of Indian temple architecture, as it was during this time that the art of temple construction reached its zenith.

□ The construction of stone temples began during this period, and the **Nagara style** of architecture was developed (for example, the **Dashavatara Temple** at Deogarh). **Ans. (a)**

24. Which district is home to the Bhitargaon (Bhitargaon) temple, a fine example of Gupta architecture?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Jhansi
- (b) Kanpur
- (c) Gwalior
- (d) Allahabad

Exp.- An excellent example of **Gupta architecture** is the **Bhitargaon Temple**, located in the **Kanpur** district of Uttar Pradesh. Its roof is in the **Shikhara style**, and its outer walls are adorned with beautiful **terracotta sculptures**. **Ans. (b)**



09

Post-Gupta Period

Maitraka Dynasty

1. Dhruvasena II was the most important ruler of which dynasty?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Maitrakas (b) Satavahana
(c) Chola (d) Kushan

Exp.- Dhruvasena II was the most powerful king of the **Maitrak dynasty** of Gujarat, whose capital was **Valabhi**.

- He was the son-in-law of the famous Emperor **Harshavardhana**. After defeating him, Harsha married his daughter to him.
□ The Chinese traveler **Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang)** visited Valabhi during his reign and described him as a generous and scholarly ruler. **Ans. (a)**

Pushybhuti dynasty

2. Read the following statements:

1. After Harsha's death, the Rajputs rose to prominence in northern Indian politics.
2. The Rajputs maintained strong unity, which helped them resist foreign invasions effectively.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 24/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

Exp.- After the death of **King Harshavardhana** in **647 CE**, a **political vacuum** was created in North India. Subsequently, during the **7th to 12th centuries**, the **Rajputs** rose to power and gained **prominence** in North India. This period is also known as the **'Rajput Period'** in Indian history. Therefore, **Statement 1 is correct.**

- There was a lack of strong unity among the Rajputs. They remained entangled in mutual rivalry, tribal pride, and continuous conflicts (such as the Tripartite Struggle). Due to this internal dissent and lack of political unity, they could not offer an organised and effective resistance to the Turkish and other foreign invasions (such as those of Mahmud of Ghazni and Muhammad Ghori). Therefore, **Statement 2 is incorrect.**

Ans. (a)

3. Whom Hiuen Tsang called "one of the four lights of world", who's also called Indian Einstein?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Charak (b) Vasumitra
(c) Ashvaghosha (d) Nagarjuna

Exp.- The Chinese traveller Hsuan Tsang described the Buddhist philosopher and scientist **Nagarjuna** as **"one of the four lights of the world."** Nagarjuna is also called the **"Einstein of India"** because of his wisdom and the principle of Shunyavada.

Ans. (d)

4. Which of the following text was written by Banabhatta?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Dhatupatha
(b) Kadambari
(c) Ritusamhara
(d) Raghuvamsha

Exp.- The famous Sanskrit text composed by Banabhatta is **Kadambari**. In the 7th century CE, Banabhatta also wrote **'Harshacharita'**, the biography of King Harshavardhana.

- 'Ritusamhara' and 'Raghuvamsha' are the works of the great poet **Kalidasa**.

Ans. (b)

5. Who among the following travelers visited India in the 7th century CE?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Faxian (Fa-Hien)
(b) Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang)
(c) Megasthenes
(d) Marco Polo

Exp.- This famous Chinese traveller came to India in **629 AD (7th Century AD)** during the reign of Emperor **Harshavardhana** and stayed here for about 15 years.

- **Fa-Hien** came to India in the 5th Century, **Megasthenes** in the 4th Century BC and **Marco Polo** at the end of the 13th Century.

Ans. (b)

10

Sangam Era

Chera and Pandya Kingdoms

1. Which Chola ruler is credited with the extensive overseas expedition to Southeast Asia, particularly against the Srivijaya Empire?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rajendra (b) Kulothunga I
(c) Vijayalaya Chola (d) Rajaraja I

Exp.- In the history of the Chola dynasty, the reign of **Rajendra I (Rajendra Chola)** is most famous for his naval power and overseas conquests.

- He carried out a campaign up to the Ganga River in North India, after which he assumed the title **'Gangaiikonda Chol'** and established his new capital **'Gangaiikonda Cholaपुरam'**. **Ans. (a)**

2. In the context of the Sangam age of South India, the term 'Sangam' refers to_____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) a royal festival of Tamil kings
(b) a council of military leaders
(c) a gathering of South Indian traders
(d) an assembly or 'meeting together' of Tamil poets

Exp.- In the Sangam Age of South India, the word Sangam means an **assembly/gathering of Tamil poets and scholars**, where literary works were composed and discussed.

- It is believed that a total of **three Sangams** took place, and the literature composed during these is called **'Sangam Literature'**. It is the primary source for understanding the history of South India (especially the **Chera, Chola, and Pandya dynasties**).

Ans. (d)

3. What actions did Vijayalaya Chola take after capturing the Kaveri delta?

- I. He established the town of Thanjavur.

- II. He built a temple for the goddess Nishumbhasudini.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- In the middle of the ninth century, Vijayalaya Chola captured the Kaveri delta by defeating the Muttarayars and performed the following tasks:

- He built the town of **Thanjavur** and made it his capital.
□ There, he built a grand temple for his family deity, **Nishumbhasudini**.

Ans. (c)

4. Neither the Chola nor the Chera dynasty was directly responsible for the establishment of:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Naval expeditions to Southeast Asia
(b) Tamil literary renaissance
(c) Devadasi temple system
(d) Bahmani kingdom



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aditya__ranjan

Exp.- The Bahmani Kingdom was established in the Deccan in 1347 AD by Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (Zafar Khan). It was formed long after the decline of the Chola-Chera dynasties and was an independent Muslim state that broke away from the **Delhi Sultanate**.

- ❑ The Chola ruler Rajendra I conducted successful naval expeditions in the Srivijaya Empire; the Chola and other Tamil dynasties contributed to the revival of Sangam literature and established the **Devadasi system** in temples. **Ans. (d)**

Chola Kingdom and Administration

5. "Rajendra I" was the son of which Chola ruler?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Vijayalaya
- (b) Parantaka I
- (c) Kulothunga
- (d) Rajaraja I

Exp.- Rajendra I was the son of the great Chola emperor Rajaraja I and succeeded to the Chola Empire in 1014 AD.

- ❑ After his conquests up to the Ganges River in northern India, he assumed the title 'Gangaikonda Chola' (Chola who conquered the Ganges). **Ans. (d)**

6. What does the term "Ur" refer to in the context of early South Indian villages?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) A tax official in the Chola kingdom
- (b) A temple priest
- (c) A village assembly or council
- (d) A military commander

Exp.- During the **Chola period**, the Ur was a general assembly of all tax-paying residents of the village, which managed public works and tax administration at the local level.

- ❑ The **Sabha/Mahasabha** was an organized council of **Brahman agraharas** (land grants to Brahmins), which functioned through various committees (**variyaams**). Meanwhile, the Nagaram was an assembly of merchants and artisans that looked after the administration of towns and commercial centers. **Ans. (c)**

7. Which of the following rulers is NOT part of the Kadai Yelu Vallalgal (The Seven Great Patrons)?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Pari
- (b) Nediyan
- (c) Adiyaman
- (d) Pegan

Exp.- According to Sangam literature, Kadai Yelu Vallalgal refers to those seven generous rulers or patrons who gained fame for their philanthropy and love for art and literature. **Ans. (b)**

8. Who is known as Sungam Tavirtta Cholan?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Kulottunga I
- (b) Rajendra III
- (c) Rajaraja I
- (d) Kulottunga III

Exp.- The Chola Emperor Kulottunga I is known as '**Sungam Thavirtta Cholan**'. The literal meaning of this title is— "**The Chola Emperor who abolished tolls.**"

Ans. (a)

9. The Chola inscription at Uttaramerur is primarily concerned with:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Maritime trade
- (b) Military conquest
- (c) Temple rituals
- (d) Village administration

Exp.- The famous Chola period inscription found at Uttaramerur near **Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu)** during the reign of Chola King **Parantaka I** is primarily related to **village administration**.

Ans. (d)

10. Who among the following is considered the most powerful Chola ruler?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Dantidurga
- (b) Harshvardhan
- (c) Virarajendra Chola
- (d) Rajaraja I

Exp.- **Rajaraja I (reign 985-1014 AD)** is considered the most powerful Chola ruler because he extensively expanded the Chola Empire and built the magnificent Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur in 1010 AD.

Ans. (d)

11. Which Chola ruler is credited with the construction of irrigation systems to support agriculture?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Raja Raja Chola I
- (b) Rajendra Chola
- (c) Kulottunga Chola I
- (d) Aditya Chola I

Exp.- The **Chola emperor Rajendra Chola I (1014-1044 CE)** constructed a large artificial lake named **Cholagangam** near his new capital **Gangaikondacholapuram** in memory of his **northern conquest (Ganga campaign)**.

- ❑ This 16-mile-long embankment system lake was known as the "liquid victory pillar" (Ganga-jalamayam Jayastambha). It brought revolutionary improvements in irrigation, water management, and paddy cultivation in the Kaveri Delta region. **Ans. (b)**

12. What was the term for land revenue in the Chola kingdom?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 30/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Vetti
- (b) Ladder tax
- (c) Cess tax
- (d) Kadamai

Exp.- The Chola inscriptions mention more than 400 terms for different kinds of taxes. Among these, '**kadamai**' was the land revenue tax. **Vetti** was a form of '**begar**' or forced labour, which was paid in the form of physical labour rather than cash. **Kudimai** was the tax paid by cultivators to their landlords. **Ans. (d)**

13. Which Rashtrakuta king defeated Parantaka I of the Chola dynasty?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Krishna I
- (b) Dantidurga
- (c) Krishna III
- (d) Govinda II

Exp.- In 949 CE, the Rashtrakuta king Krishna III defeated the Chola king Parantaka I in the famous **Battle of Takkolam**. Following this, King Krishna III assumed titles such as '**Amoghavarsha**' and '**Tanjaikonda**'.

- ❑ After the Battle of Takkolam, Krishna III led a military campaign as far as Rameshwaram, where he also built a victory pillar and a temple (**the Krishneshvara Temple**). **Ans. (c)**

14. What was a major challenge for agriculture in the Chola kingdom apart from rocky land?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Lack of seeds
- (b) Lack of labour
- (c) Irrigation water
- (d) Pest infestation

Exp.- In the Chola Empire, besides the rocky terrain, the biggest challenge was the **constant management of irrigation water**, as rainfall was limited to the monsoon and water was needed for **cultivation throughout the year**.

- ❑ The Chola ruler **Rajendra Chola I** constructed a massive artificial lake called **Cholagangam**; **Karikala Chola** had constructed a '**Kallanai**' dam. **Ans. (c)**

15. Who among the following Chola emperors constructed the grand temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rajaraja Chola I
- (b) Rajendra Chola I
- (c) Rajadhiraja Chola I
- (d) Kulothunga Chola I

Exp.- **Rajendra Chola I (1014-1044 AD)** built the Gangaikonda Cholapuram (Brihadisvara) temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram to commemorate his successful military expedition to the Ganga valley in North India.

- ❑ After the victory over the Ganga region, he assumed the title of '**Gangaikonda Chola**' and established the city of Gangaikonda Cholapuram, making it his new capital. **Ans. (b)**

Pallava Dynasty

1. Who was the Pallava king that built the 'seven rathas' at Mahabalipuram?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Pulakeshin I
(b) Rajendra II
(c) Senguttuvan
(d) Narasimhavarman

Exp.- The 'Sapt Pagoda' or Seven Rathas (monolithic temples carved out of a single rock) of Mahabalipuram were built by Narasimhavarman I 'Mahamalla'.

- These temples are excellent examples of the Pallava style of architecture, known as 'Ratha' temples (such as Yudhisthira Ratha, Arjuna Ratha, etc.).

Ans. (d)

2. Vichitrachitta, Chitrakarapuli, and Chaityakari are the titles given to which of the following rulers?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Kirtivarman I
(b) Narasimhavarman II
(c) Mahendravarman I
(d) Parantaka I

Exp.- Mahendravarman I (Pallava dynasty) was known for his versatile talent. For his love of art, literature, and architecture, he was given several unique titles such as **Vichitrachitta** (the curious-minded), **Chitrakarapuli** (tiger among painters), and **Chaityakari** (builder of temples).

Ans. (c)

3. During the Pallava period, what do the terms Brahmadeya and Devadana refer to?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Educational Institutions
(b) Administrative Titles
(c) Land grants
(d) Religious festivals

Exp.- During the Pallava dynasty, land grants played a significant role in the administration and social structure. Through Brahmadeya, land was granted to learned Brahmins, which led to the spread of education and religion, while Devadana involved land grants to strengthen the economic base of grand temples (such as the Rath temples of Mahabalipuram).

Ans. (c)

4. Dakshinchitra was compiled during the reign of which Pallava ruler?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Sivaskandavarman
(b) Vijayaskandavarman
(c) Mahendravarman I
(d) Narasimhavarman I

Exp.- A new style of painting and architecture developed under the patronage of the great art lover and artist, the Pallava ruler Mahendravarman I. During his reign, a famous treatise on painting named 'Dakshinachitra' was compiled, which was based on the principles and techniques of South Indian painting.

- Example – Magnificent frescoes are found in the Sittannavasal caves.

Ans. (c)

5. In which city is the sculptural panel of "Descent of the Ganges" located?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Ellora
(b) Mahabalipuram
(c) Pattadakal
(d) Badami

Exp.- The sculpture panel of "Descent of the Ganga" is located in Mahabalipuram. Built by King Narasimhavarman I (7th Century) of the Pallava dynasty, this massive rock-cut relief depicts the penance of Bhagiratha and the descent of the Ganga from heaven to earth. In this, Ganga is shown being contained within the matted locks of Shiva.

Ans. (b)

Chalukya Dynasty

6. Which among the following was the capital of the Western Chalukyas founded by Pulakeshin II?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Badami
(b) Kalyani
(c) Kanchi
(d) Purushapura

Exp.- Badami (ancient name **Vatapi**) was the early capital of the **Western Chalukyas (Badami Chalukyas)** established by **Pulakeshin I** (543-566 AD), which is located in the Bagalkot district of Karnataka.

Ans. (a)

7. Consider the following statements regarding South Indian dynasties in the 12th and 13th centuries:

Statement I: The Kakatiyas, ruling from Manyakheta, were the primary successors to the Later Chalukyas in the western Deccan.

Statement II: The Hoysalas, based in Devagiri, were the sole dynasty responsible for the complete overthrow of the Later Chalukyas across all their territories.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 28/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor statement 2

Exp.- The **Kakatiya** dynasty did not rule from **Manyakheta**; instead, their capital was **Warangal (Ekashila Nagari)**. The Kakatiyas were one of the **successor states** of the later **Chalukyas**, not the sole or primary ones. During this same period, the **Hoysalas** and the **Yadavas of Devagiri** also emerged simultaneously. Therefore, **Statement (I)** is false.

- **Devagiri** was the capital of the **Yadava (Seuna) dynasty**, not the **Hoysalas**. The capital of the Hoysalas was **Dwarasamudra (Halebidu)**. Therefore, **Statement (II)** is false.

Ans. (d)

Rashtrakuta dynasty

8. Which of the following pair of dynasty region is correct?

- I. Rashtrakuta Tamil Nadu
II. Gurjara-Pratihara Rajasthan

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- The Gurjara-Pratihara rule was primarily over the regions of Rajasthan and Gujarat (later Kannauj), while the main territory of the Rashtrakutas was Karnataka-Deccan (**Capital: Manyakheta**).

- Nagabhata I is considered the founder of the Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty, whereas Dantidurga established the Rashtrakuta dynasty in the **8th century** by defeating the Chalukya rulers.

Ans. (b)

9. Which dynasty was founded by Dantidurga in the mid-8th century?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rashtrakuta Dynasty
(b) Chola Dynasty
(c) Pala Dynasty
(d) Pratihara Dynasty

Exp.- Dantidurga established the Rashtrakuta dynasty in the middle of the 8th century (around 752-753 AD) by defeating the Chalukya ruler Kirtivarman II. He also performed a famous ritual called 'Hiranya-garbha'.

Dynasty	Founder	Main Region
Chola Dynasty	Vijayalaya	Tanjore (South India)
Pala Dynasty	Gopala	Bengal and Bihar
Pratihara Dynasty	Nagabhata I	Avanti/Jalore (Rajasthan and Central India)
Rashtrakuta Dynasty	Dantidurga	Manyakheta (Modern Karnataka/Deccan)

Ans. (a)



10. Consider the following statements regarding political rivalries in early medieval India:

Statement I: The Rashtrakutas launched several campaigns to gain control over the region of Kanauj

Statement II: The Pratiharas were primarily based in eastern India, while the Palas were established in the western and central regions

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only Statement I is correct.
(b) Only Statement II is correct.

- (c) Both Statement I and II are correct.
(d) Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct.

Exp.- The Rashtrakutas actively participated in the **Tripartite Struggle** with the Pratiharas and the Palas for control over Kanauj.

- The participants in the **Tripartite Struggle** in North India from the **8th to the 10th century** were the **Rashtrakutas** from the South, the **Pala dynasty** of Bengal, and the **Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty** ruling from Malwa. **Ans. (a)**

11. Who was the founder of the Rashtrakuta dynasty?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Amoghavarsha
(b) Dantidurga
(c) Krishna III
(d) Krishna I

Exp.- The **Rashtrakuta dynasty** was founded by **Dantidurga (735-756 AD)**. He established his power in the Deccan by defeating the Chalukya king **Kirtivarman II**, and his capital was **Manyakheta (Malkhed, Maharashtra)**. **Ans. (b)**

12

States of North India

Pala and Pratihara Dynasties

1. Who was the Pratihara ruler who successfully repelled the Arab invasions in north-west India?

SSC Stenographer 06-08-2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mihir Bhoj
(b) Nagabhata I
(c) Governor
(d) atsaraja

Exp.- The role of Nagabhata I (730-760 AD), the actual founder of the Gurjar Pratihara dynasty, is most significant in stopping the Arab invasion of north-west India.

- During the 8th century, when the Arab armies led by Junaid advanced from Sindh and invaded Malwa and Gujarat, Nagabhata I, the founder of the Gurjar Pratihara dynasty, defeated them. **Ans. (b)**

2. Which Pala ruler is known for founding the great Buddhist university at Vikramashila?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Mahipala I
(c) Gopala I (d) Devapala

Exp.- One of the most powerful rulers of the **Pala dynasty, Dharmapala (770-810 CE)**, established **Vikramashila University at Bhagalpur** in present-day Bihar in the late 8th century or early 9th century.

- It was a major centre of **Buddhist education** (famous for the teaching of Vajrayana Buddhism and Buddhist philosophy) and, after **Nalanda University** in eastern India, it emerged as the most important centre of learning. **Ans. (a)**

3. At which of the following places was the inscription of Pratihara king Nagabhata found?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh
(b) Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh
(c) Agra, Uttar Pradesh
(d) Kandahar, Afghanistan

Exp.- The famous **inscription** of the **Pratihara ruler Nagabhata** was discovered in **Gwalior** (Madhya Pradesh). It describes the military conquests of his ancestor, Nagabhata.

- In this inscription, **Nagabhata I** is described as the conqueror of the **'Mlechchhas'** (Arab invaders) and as an **incarnation of Narayana**. **Ans. (b)**

4. Which of the following ruler was Brahmins who gave up their traditional professions and established kingdom in Rajasthan?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Dantidurga
(b) Gurjara-Pratihara Harichandra
(c) Nagabhata
(d) Dharmapala Deva

Exp.- Harichandra, who was originally a Brahmin, gave up his traditional profession and established the **Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty** in Rajasthan, setting up a kingdom. He established his empire in Mandore, Rajasthan.

- **Dantidurga** was the founder of the Rashtrakuta dynasty, **Nagabhata** was a Pratihara ruler, and **Dharmapala Dev** was a prominent ruler of the Pala dynasty, but none of them belonged to the Brahmin class. **Ans. (b)**

13

Ancient Architecture

1. What do the carved wheels on the Konark Sun Temple represent?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 15/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Planets (b) Time divisions
(c) Festivals (d) Weapons

Exp.- In the 13th century, **King Narasimha Deva I** of the Eastern Ganga Dynasty built the Konark Sun Temple in **1250 AD**, dedicated to the Sun God.

- The 24 wheels of the Konark Sun Temple represent the 24 hours of the day, and the **8 thick spokes** of each wheel represent the **8 prahars (every 3 hours)** and **8 thin spokes** mark the subtle divisions of time. These wheels also function as sun dials. **Ans. (b)**

2. How many pairs of decorative wheels are found on the Konark Sun Temple chariot?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 15/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 10 pairs (b) 11 pairs
(c) 12 pairs (d) 13 pairs

Exp.- **King Narasimha Deva I** of the **Eastern Ganga Dynasty** built the **Konark Sun Temple** between **1238-64 AD**. Located in Puri, Odisha, it is the finest example of **Kalinga architecture**.

- It symbolizes the colossal chariot of the Sun God, featuring **12 pairs (24 decorative wheels)** representing the 24 hours of the day and **7 horses** marking the days of the week. **Ans. (c)**

3. Consider the following statements about Gwalior Fort:

- It is spread over a hilltop more than 2 km in length.
- Its southern path features intricately carved rock-cut temples of Jain tirthankars.
- The Caturbhuj Mandir within the fort is an example of a Vaishnavite shrine.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 13/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Exp.- Gwalior Fort is spread over a length of more than **2 km** on the top of a hill. Complex **rock-cut temples** of Jain Tirthankaras are located on the southern path of the Gwalior Fort, such as Urwahi Valley and Siddhachal Caves, and the Chaturbhuj Temple inside the fort is a Vaishnava pilgrimage site dedicated to Lord Vishnu. **Ans. (d)**

4. The rock at Dhauri (Orissa) has been sculpted to resemble which animal?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Lion (b) Bull
 (c) Elephant (d) Horse

Exp.- The rock at Dhauri in Odisha has been carved and sculpted into the forepart of an elephant.

- It is considered one of the oldest and finest examples of **Maurian art (third century BCE)**. **Ans. (c)**

5. Which structural elements enhance the visual grandeur of Kangra Fort?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Wooden sculptures
 (b) Colorful glass windows
 (c) Arches, domes, and rock carvings
 (d) Painted ceilings and tiled floors

Exp.- Kangra Fort (Himachal Pradesh) is famous for its distinct architecture, where the use of **arches and domes** is visible. Built on a steep cliff, this fort is secure and aesthetically pleasing with its rock-cut passages and carvings. It is considered one of the oldest forts in India, built by the **Katoch dynasty**. **Ans. (c)**

6. Consider the following statements about Chittorgarh Fort:
1. The fort features iconic structures like the Vijay Stambha and Kirti Stambha
 2. The fort complex includes nineteen main temples
 3. Its main entrance was established in the 5th century

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
 (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Exp.- The Chittorgarh Fort houses iconic structures such as the **Vijay Stambha** (built by Rana Kumbha) and the **Kirti Stambha** (built by a Jain merchant). There are approximately **19 main Hindu and Jain temples** located within the fort complex.

- Among the major gateways of the fort, the Padan Pol is considered to date back to around the 5th century, which indicates its antiquity. **Ans. (d)**

7. The famous Meenakshi Temple in Madurai is known for which architectural feature?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) White marble walls
 (b) Hidden underground shrines
 (c) Shikhara covered in gold
 (d) Gigantic Gopurams (gateway towers)

Exp.- The **Meenakshi Amman Temple** located in Madurai, Tamil Nadu, is famous for its Dravidian architectural style and 14 gopurams (the southern gopuram is 170 feet tall).

- It is dedicated to Goddess Meenakshi and Lord Sundareswara, originally built in the 6th century and expanded during the reign of the Nayaka dynasty in the 17th century. **Ans. (d)**

8. What kind of architectural feature are the Jain temples known for?
SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Highly intricate marble carvings
 (b) Enormous domes without any pillars
 (c) Bronze statues of horses
 (d) Gothic vaults and arches

Exp.- Jain temples are known for their highly intricate marble carvings. Maru-Gurjara style Jain temples such as Ranakpur (Rajasthan), Dilwara (Mount Abu), and Shrivastanabelagola are famous for their fine and complex carvings on marble, Tirthankara idols, and mandapa pillars. **Ans. (a)**

9. In which district of Uttarakhand is the Jageshwar temple complex located?
SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)
- (a) Tehri Garhwal (b) Almora
 (c) Chamoli (d) Rudrapur

Exp.- Jageshwar Temple Complex is located about 36 km from Almora district of Uttarakhand on the banks of the 'Jataganga' river and amidst dense Deodar forests.

- This temple complex is a group of 124 small and large ancient stone temples (**Nagara style**), which are also called the 'Valley of Gods'. These were constructed between the 7th and 14th centuries by the kings of the Katyuri and Chand dynasties. **Ans. (b)**

10. The Bhimakali Temple in Sarhan is a fine example of which architectural style?
SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Chalukyan (b) Kath-Kuni
 (c) Dravidian (d) Indo-Gothic

Exp.- The Bhimakali Temple of Himachal Pradesh is world-famous for its Kath-Kuni style, which demonstrates a skillful combination of local natural resources such as deodar wood and stones. Its multi-storeyed structure and pagoda-like roofs make it distinct from other Indian temples. **Ans. (b)**

11. Jagannath Temple constructed by a famous king of Ganga Dynasty Ananta Varman Chodaganga Deva dating back to 12th century is located at _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-02)
- (a) Odisha (b) Madhya Pradesh
 (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Karnataka

Exp.- Built in the 12th century by the famous King Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva of the Eastern Ganga dynasty, the **Jagannath Temple is located in Puri, Odisha**.

- It is also known as the 'White Pagoda' and is an important part of the Char Dham Yatra. **Ans. (a)**

12. Meenakshi Amman Temple was constructed by _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Kulasekhara
 (b) Karikala Chola
 (c) Pulakeshin I
 (d) Narasimha Deva I

Exp.- The Meenakshi Amman Temple, located in Madurai (Tamil Nadu), was constructed by King Kulasekhara of the Pandya dynasty.

- This temple is world-famous for its magnificent **Dravidian architecture** and tall **Gopurams** (gateway towers). **Ans. (a)**

13. The rock-cut ratha temples at Mahabalipuram were built by the _____.
SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-03)
- (a) Cholas
 (b) Cheras
 (c) Mauryas
 (d) Pallavas

Exp.- The rock-cut Rath temples (**Pancha Pandava Rathas**) in Mahabalipuram were constructed by the Pallava dynasty (**King Narasimhavarman I**). **Ans. (d)**

14. How many major rock edicts are there of Emperor Ashoka?
SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)
- (a) 10 (b) 12
 (c) 14 (d) 16

Exp.- There are **14 Major Rock Edicts** of Emperor Ashoka, which are inscribed at various places. These are focused on **Dhamma policy, morality, non-violence** and **social welfare**. The **total number of inscriptions is 33**, which includes 14 Major Rock Edicts, 7 Pillar Edicts, Minor Rock Edicts, and Cave Inscriptions. **Ans. (c)**

15. The rock-cut Kailasa temple at Ellora was carved out of how many rocks?
SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-01)
- (a) One single rock
 (b) Cement blocks
 (c) Three adjoining rocks
 (d) A cluster of stones

Exp.- The Kailash Temple at Ellora was built by carving out a single monolithic rock from top to bottom.
 □ It was built in the **8th century** by the Rashtrakuta King **Krishna I** and is considered the world's largest **single monolithic structure**. **Ans. (a)**

16. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options:

Assertion (A): The murals in Tirumalaipuram and Sittannaval caves are important surviving examples of Pandya art.

Reason (R): These murals are mainly found on the outer walls of temples and depict mythological war scenes.

SSC PHASE XIII 24/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) Both A and R are false.

Exp.- The **Tirumalaipuram** and **Sittannaval** caves are important surviving examples of **Pandyan art**, dating back to the **7th-9th century CE**. Therefore, **Assertion (A)** is true.

- These **mural paintings** are not on the outer walls but are found in the **interiors** of the caves (ceilings and pillars). Furthermore, they do not depict **mythological war scenes** but instead showcase **Jain themes** such as **lotuses**, animals, birds, and **dancing figures**. Therefore, **Reason (R)** is false. **Ans. (c)**

17. Which art form developed as a result of the fusion of Greek and Indian artistic styles?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mathura art
(b) Amaravati sculpture
(c) Gandhara art
(d) Gupta art

Exp.- The **Gandhara school of art** developed through a blend of Greek and Indian artistic styles. It is also known as **'Indo-Greek'** art, in which Indian themes were depicted in the Greco-Roman style.

- In this, the statues of Buddha are shown with curly hair, moustaches, and a **muscular body**, similar to the Greek god **'Apollo'**.
□ The maximum development of this art style occurred during the **Kushan period** (especially during the time of Kanishka). **Ans. (c)**

18. In the context of Hindu temple architecture, the place where the main idol of a deity is placed is known as _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Garbhagriha (b) Mandapa
(c) Shikhara (d) Vaahan

Exp.- In Hindu temple architecture, the place where the main idol of the deity is installed is called the **Garbhagriha**.

- **Mandapa** is the entrance to the temple or the hall where devotees gather, and **Shikhara** or **Vimana** refers to the high mountain-like structure built directly above the Garbhagriha. **Ans. (a)**

19. Which of the following ancient Indian sites is famous for its chaityas and viharas carved into rock?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ajanta
(b) Thanjavur
(c) Mahabalipuram
(d) Hampi

Exp.- The **Ajanta Caves**, located in the **Aurangabad** (now **Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar**) district of **Maharashtra**, are famous for their unique rock-cut architecture, including both **Chaityas** (prayer halls) and **Viharas** (residences of monks). **Ans. (a)**

20. The architectural style of ancient temples in Uttarakhand is primarily influenced by:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) North Indian Nagara style
(b) Indo-Gothic style
(c) Vesara style
(d) Chalukyan style

Exp.- Most of the ancient temples of Uttarakhand, such as **Jageshwar** and **Bajinath**, are examples of the **North Indian Nagara style**, in which high **shikharas** (spires) and stone carvings are prominent.

- The **Katyuri** and **Chand** dynasties contributed to the construction of these temples, developing this architectural art with local elements in the Himalayan regions. **Ans. (a)**

21. Which of the following statements is/are true?

Statement 1: The Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram exemplifies Dravidian architecture built of carved granite blocks

Statement 2: This temple showcases architectural continuity from Pallava-era rock-cut caves temples to fully structural stone constructions.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both statements are true and Statement 2 correctly explains Statement 1.
(b) Both statements are true but Statement 2 does not explain Statement 1.
(c) Statement 1 is true, Statement 2 is false.
(d) Neither 1 nor 2 is true.

Exp.- Built by the **Pallava King Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)** in the **8th century**, this is an important early example of the **Dravidian style** and the first structural temple made of **granite**. It marks the transition of **Pallava architecture** from **rock-cut temples** to **complete structural temples**. It is a **UNESCO World Heritage site** and is dedicated to **Shiva and Vishnu**. **Ans. (a)**

22. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct option:

Assertion (A): Gandhara images frequently feature halo and curly hair.

Reason (R): These elements symbolise Graeco-Roman influence in North-West India.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- In **Gandhara art**, the halo and curly hair of **Buddha** statues are clearly inspired by **Greco-Roman art**.

- The presence of **Greek rulers** in north-western India gave birth to this unique blend of **Indian Buddhist subjects** and **Hellenistic techniques**. **Ans. (a)**

23. Which of the following best characterizes the Mathura school of Buddhist art and architecture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Use of sandstone and floral arches.
(b) Hellenistic drapery and realism.
(c) Indigenous features with Yaksha influence.
(d) Predominantly wooden monastery design.

Exp.- The defining feature of the **Mathura school of Buddhist art** is its indigenous style influenced by **Yaksha-Yakshini** figures, which is of purely **Indian origin** (characterised by broad shoulders, round faces, and Indian stylistic elements).

- This style primarily utilised **Spotted Red Sandstone**.
□ This school was not limited to Buddhism alone; it also produced a large number of images of **Jain (Tirthankara)** and **Hindu (Brahmanical)** deities. **Ans. (c)**

24. Which of the following statements most accurately describes a key difference between the Mathura and Gandhara schools of art, as broadly understood in Indian architectural history?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mathura art primarily used green phyllite, while Gandhara art used spotted red sandstone.
(b) Gandhara art developed on purely indigenous lines, whereas Mathura art showed foreign influences.
(c) Mathura art predominantly focused on Buddhist themes, while Gandhara focused on Hindu deities.
(d) Mathura art depicted Buddha in an indigenous Yaksha-like style, whereas Gandhara art reflected Hellenistic (Greco-Roman) features.

Exp.- In **Gandhara art**, the **Greek influence** on **Buddha** statues (wavy hair, drapery like a **Roman toga**) is evident, whereas **Mathura art** is entirely based on the **Indian tradition** where **Buddha** has been depicted as **robust and cheerful**.

- Regarding the material, **blue-grey schist stone** was used in **Gandhara**, and **spotted red sandstone** was used in **Mathura**. **Ans. (d)**

25. Which of the following is true about the Deogarh temple built in the early 6th century CE?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) It follows a panchayatana layout and is an early example of Nagara style.
- (b) It was built by Chandela rulers and faces east like most Hindu temples.
- (c) Its main deity is Shiva in the form of Mahadeo.
- (d) It is entirely rock-cut with vaulted interiors.

Exp.- The Dashavatara Temple of Deogarh (Lalitpur, Uttar Pradesh) is an excellent example of Gupta architecture, built in the **Panchayatana style**, and showcases the early **shikhara of the Nagara style**.

- This temple is dedicated to Lord Vishnu in his Dashavatara forms; it is unique for being **west-facing** and is primarily constructed of stone blocks.

Ans. (a)

26. The Jagannath Temple in Puri is an example of which style of architecture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Dravidian
- (b) Maratha
- (c) Nagara (Kalinga)
- (d) Vesara

Exp.- The Jagannath Temple of Puri (Odisha) is built in the **'Kalinga style'**, a sub-style of **Nagara architecture**, whose main features are the vertical-shaped **Rekha Deula** (main shikhara) and the **'Jagamohana'** (prayer hall) built in front of it.

- This temple was built in the 12th century by **Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva (Eastern Ganga Dynasty)**, and is world-famous for its grandeur and unique Rath Yatra.

Ans. (c)

27. In the Nagara temple, which element is the projecting central offset of the wall face?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Karna Sringa
- (b) Pratritha
- (c) Anuratha
- (d) Bhadra

Exp.- In Nagara style temples, the central and prominent projection of the outer wall (**jangha**) is called **Bhadra**, where the main idols are installed. In a **Triratha** temple, the central part is the **Bhadra** and the corner projections are called **Karna**.

- The projection situated between the **Bhadra** and the **Karna** is the **Pratritha**, while the subtle gap between them is called **Anuradha/Nandika**.

Ans. (d)

28. Which of the following temple architectural features is characteristic of the Nagara style, especially found in central and northern India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Vimana
- (b) Shikhara
- (c) Mandapa with barrel vaults
- (d) Gopuram

Exp.- The most prominent feature of the **Nagara style** is its **'Shikhara'**, which is built as a curvilinear and spiral tower over the **Garbhagriha** (sanctum sanctorum). It is topped by the **Amalaka** and the **Kalasha**.

- In contrast, the **'Vimana'** and the **'Gopuram'** (grand entrance gateway) are the primary characteristics of the South Indian **Dravida style**.

Ans. (b)

29. What is the main tower of a Dravida-style temple known as?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Shikhara
- (b) Vihara
- (c) Gopuram
- (d) Vimāna

Exp.- In the Dravida style (South Indian temple architecture), the main pyramidal tower located above the garbhagriha (sanctum sanctorum) is called the **'Vimana'**.

- 'Shikhara' is the curvilinear tower of the Nagara style (North India); 'Gopuram', a massive gateway; 'Vihara', a Buddhist monastery.

- There are three main styles of Indian temple architecture: Nagara (Northern style), Vesara (mixed style), and Dravida (Southern style).

Ans. (d)

30. Read the following statements and choose the correct option:

Statement 1: The amalaka sits atop the shikhara in Nagara-style temples.

Statement 2: In Dravida-style temples, the vimana refers to the gateway tower (gopuram).

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct.
- (b) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are incorrect.
- (c) Statement 1 is correct, but Statement 2 is incorrect.
- (d) Statement 1 is incorrect, but Statement 2 is correct.

Exp.- In the Nagara style of temples, there is a stone disc-like structure at the top of the **Shikhara** (mountain-like structure) called the **'Amalaka'**. A **'Kalasha'** is placed above it. Therefore, statement 1 is correct.

- In the Dravida style, **Vimana** refers to the tower-like structure above the main temple (**Garbhagriha**), and not the entrance. The massive entrance gateways of Dravida temples are called **'Gopurams'**. Thus, statement 2 is incorrect.

Ans. (c)

31. Which of the following pairs of temple style & region are correctly matched?

- 1. Vesara – Deccan
- 2. Rekha-Deul – Odisha
- 3. Bhumija – Malwa
- 4. Kalinga – Tamil Nadu

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1 & 2 only
- (b) 1, 2 & 3 are correct
- (c) 2 & 4 only
- (d) Only 1

Exp.- The Vesara style is a hybrid of the Nagara and Dravida styles and developed in the Deccan region (Chalukyas-Hoysalas); Rekha-Deul is a distinct feature of the Nagara tradition of Odisha; and the Bhumija style is a sub-style of Nagara that developed in Malwa (Paramaras).

- The Kalinga style is a regional style of Odisha (not Tamil Nadu). Therefore, the correct matches are 1, 2, and 3.

Ans. (b)

32. Consider the following statements about Gandhara art beyond stone sculptures:

- 1. A gold reliquary with figures in an arcade was found at Bimaran.
- 2. Intricately carved ivory plaques were discovered at Begram.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 15/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only 1 is correct
- (b) Only 2 is correct
- (c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

Exp.- A famous **'Golden Casket' (reliquary)** has been found at Bimaran in Afghanistan. It features figures of the Buddha and other deities carved within arched niches, representing an early and excellent example of **Gandhara art**. Statement 1 is correct.

- During excavations at **Begram** in Afghanistan, a large number of **ivory plaques** and artifacts were discovered. These objects reflect the artistic skills and trade relations (especially between India and the Roman Empire) of the Gandhara region during the **Kushan period**. Statement 2 is correct.

Ans. (c)

33. Based on the given statements which option is correct:

Statement I: Mathura art produced images for both Indian and non-Indian patrons.

Statement II: Mathura art ignored nature-based themes in its sculptures.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Statement I and II both are correct.
- (b) Only statement I is correct.
- (c) Only statement II is correct.
- (d) Neither I nor II.

Exp.- The Mathura school of art was a mixture of Indian and foreign (**Greek and Central Asian**) influences and produced sculptures for both Indian and foreign patrons (**Kushana rulers**).

- Statement II is incorrect because Mathura art does not neglect nature; instead, this art often included natural subjects like animals, plants, trees, floral motifs, and divine beings, which reflected the relationship between religion and nature.

Ans. (b)

34. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options:

Assertion (A): Post-Mauryan Buddhist stupas show regional variations in form, such as cruciform bases and pyramidal superstructures.

Reason (R): Use of diverse local materials and building techniques led to the emergence of distinct stupa styles across regions.

SSC PHASE XIII 29/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) Both A and R are false.

Exp.- Regional variations are clearly visible in the **Buddhist Stupas** of the **Post-Mauryan period**. Differences are found in the forms of the **base** and **superstructure** across various regions (such as angular/pyramidal tendencies in some places, and more circular designs with elaborate **Vedika-Torana** traditions in others). Therefore, **Assertion (A)** is true.
□ Due to the varying use of **local materials** (stone, brick, lime) and **construction techniques**, different stupa styles developed in various regions. Thus, the **Reason (R)** explains the assertion.
Ans. (a)

35. What is the typical base design of the simplest Nagara-style shikhara?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Circular base with domes
(b) Square base with curving walls
(c) Triangular base with garden
(d) Rectangular base with domes

Exp.- The main feature of temples in the **Nagara style** is their **Square Base** and a **Curvilinear Shikhara** that curves inward towards the top. The simplest form is called '**Rekha-Prasad**', where the walls of the shikhara gradually slope inwards and finally meet at a single point at the top. This architecture is mainly found in North India.
Ans. (b)

36. Arrange the following sites in chronological order based on the stylistic development of Buddhist sculpture:

- a) Mathura
b) Bharhut
c) Sanchi Stupa-1

SSC CGL TIER-I, 13/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) b-c-a (b) c-a-b
(c) c-b-a (d) a-c-b

Exp.- The early phase of **Buddhist sculpture** is symbolic in **Sanchi Stupa-1** (3rd century BCE), where Buddha is represented by footprints, the wheel, etc. This was followed by the development of a transitional style in **Bharhut** (2nd century BCE), featuring intricate carvings of Jataka tales. **Mathura** (1st century CE) appeared latest, where the first anthropomorphic (human form) depiction of Buddha occurred.
Ans. (a)

37. In which district of Uttarakhand is the Jageshwar temple complex located?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Tehri Garhwal
(b) Almora
(c) Chamoli
(d) Rudrapur

Exp.- Jageshwar Temple Complex is located about 36 km from Almora district of Uttarakhand on the banks of the 'Jataganga' river and amidst dense Deodar forests.

- This temple complex is a group of 124 small and large ancient stone temples (**Nagara style**), which are also called the 'Valley of Gods'. These were constructed between the 7th and 14th centuries by the kings of the Katyuri and Chand dynasties.
Ans. (b)

38. The Kailasa Temple at Ellora was built by which ruler?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Krishna I
(c) Rajaraja Chola
(d) Chandragupta II

Exp.- The world-famous **Kailasa Temple** at Ellora (Cave No. 16) was built by the **Rashtrakuta ruler Krishna I** in the 8th century. Dedicated to Lord Shiva, this temple is known for its grandeur and intricate carvings, largely inspired by the **Dravidian architectural style**.
Ans. (b)

39. The Mathura School of Art flourished during which period?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Maurya (b) Gupta
(c) Kushan (d) Chola

Exp.- The **Golden Age** of the **Mathura school of art** is considered to be the **Kushan period** (1st-3rd century CE). During this period, life-size idols of the **Buddha, Jain Tirthankaras**, and Hindu deities were extensively created. This style reached its peak under the patronage of **Emperor Kanishka**.
Ans. (c)

40. Which ruler greatly supported Gandhara art?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Kanishka
(c) Samudragupta
(d) Harsha

Exp.- The **Gandhara art** witnessed its maximum development under the patronage of the Kushan ruler **Kanishka**. The **Greco-Roman (Hellenistic)** influence is clearly visible in this art form.
Ans. (b)

41. The famous "Katra" mound in Mathura is known for remains of:

SSC PHASE XIII 26/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Temples and monasteries
(b) Forts and palaces
(c) Modern buildings
(d) Colonial structures

Exp.- Significant archaeological remains of ancient Hindu temples and Buddhist monasteries (**Viharas**) have been found at the **Katra mound** in Mathura. This site was a major religious and cultural center in ancient times. Architectural remains and sculptural evidence associated with the **Kushan period** have been recovered from here, which help in gaining a deeper understanding of the **Mathura art tradition**.
Ans. (a)

42. The style of architecture associated with Mathura sculptures is called:

SSC PHASE XIII 26/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gandhara style
(b) Mathura style
(c) Dravidian style
(d) Mughal style

Exp.- The **Mathura style** flourished mainly during the **Kushan period**, characterized by the use of **spotted red sandstone**, fleshy and powerful figures, and the dominance of indigenous Indian elements. This style was inspired by Buddhism, Jainism, and Hinduism, and it saw the development of human idols of the Buddha.
Ans. (b)

43. The art of Mathura influenced which other ancient Indian art style?

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gandhara art
(b) Mughal art
(c) Chola art
(d) Rajput art

Exp.- Both the **Mathura school of art** and the **Gandhara school of art** developed primarily during the **Kushan period** (during the reign of **Kanishka**). Both styles influenced each other deeply.
Ans. (a)

44. The Mathura school of art flourished mainly during which period?

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gupta period
(b) Mughal period
(c) British period
(d) Maurya period

Exp.- Although the foundation of the **Mathura school of art** was laid during the **Kushan period**, the **Gupta period** is considered the '**Golden Age**' of Indian art, where the Mathura style reached its peak of development.

- The Mathura school of art emerged around the 1st century AD during the Kushan dynasty (especially during the time of **Emperor Kanishka**).
□ Later, during the Gupta period (4th-6th century), it received immense patronage, and the most beautiful statues of the Buddha were created in the Mathura style during this era.
Ans. (a)

45. The rock-cut caves of Ajanta and Ellora, famous for their murals and sculptures, are located in which present-day state of India?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rajasthan
(b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Maharashtra
(d) Karnataka

Exp.- The **Ajanta and Ellora caves**, famous for their frescoes, sculptures, and **rock-cut architecture**, are located in the Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar (formerly Aurangabad) district of Maharashtra. Developed from the 2nd century BCE, these caves are **UNESCO World Heritage Sites** that preserve the artistic heritage of Buddhism, Hinduism, and Jainism.

Ans. (c)

46. The famous Sanchi Stupa is associated with which ancient architectural tradition?

SSC PHASE XIII 26/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Hindu (b) Jain
(c) Buddhist (d) Mughal

Exp.- The **Sanchi Stupa** is one of India's most important and well-preserved Buddhist monuments. Located in the Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh, it was originally built in the 3rd century BCE by the Mauryan Emperor **Ashoka**. It represents the 'Stupa' style of architecture, featuring a hemispherical dome (**Anda**); it symbolizes the life and teachings of Lord Buddha. It was declared a **World Heritage Site** in 1989.

Ans. (c)

47. The Gandhara art style is primarily associated with which religion?

SSC PHASE XIII 24/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Hinduism
(b) Buddhism
(c) Jainism
(d) Zoroastrianism

Exp.- The **Gandhara school of art** is primarily related to **Buddhism (Mahayana)**, which developed between the 1st century BCE and the 5th century CE (mainly during the **Kushan period**) in North-Western Pakistan and Eastern Afghanistan. It features anthropomorphic depictions of the Buddha and Bodhisattvas with **Greco-Roman influence**. It is a blend of Indian and Greek art, primarily using **grey schist stone and stucco**.

Ans. (b)

48. The Vesara style of temple architecture is a combination of which two styles?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Gandhara and French
(b) Nagara and Gothic
(c) Dravidian and Nagara
(d) Mughal and Dravidian

Exp.-

Style	Main Region	Features
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Nagara	North India	Curvilinear/bee-hive shaped shikhara, temples built on a raised platform, and absence of boundary wall or gopuram in the temple complex
Dravida	South India	Pyramidal multi-storeyed shikhara (vimana) , tall and grand entrance gateways (gopuram), and large water tanks in the temple complex
Vesara	Central India/Deccan	A combination of both Nagara and Dravida styles

Ans. (c)

49. Consider the following statements about Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves:

- These caves are near Bhubaneswar and were meant for Jain monks.
- All caves are shaped like flowers and are carved from independent boulders.
- Each cave has multiple shrines dedicated to different Buddhist deities.

Which of the above is/are correct?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only 1
(b) All 1, 2, and 3 are correct
(c) 1 and 2 Only
(d) 2 and 3 Only

Exp.- The **Udayagiri and Khandagiri Caves** are excellent examples of ancient **Jain establishments** located near **Bhubaneswar in Odisha**. They were built before the Christian era, in the first or second century BCE, under the protection of the **Kalinga king Kharavela** as residences for monks by cutting the soft **sandstone hills**.

- There are **18 caves in Udayagiri** and **15 caves in Khandagiri**. The **Hathigumpha inscription** presents important evidence about the history of **Jainism** and the achievements of **King Kharavela**.

Ans. (a)

50. Match the following cave sites with their architectural characteristics:

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

Column A-Cave Site	Column B-Architectural Feature
A. Udayagiri	1. Circular caitya with stupa and arch
B. Guntapalle	2. Pillared veranda with cells at the back
C. Khandagiri	3. Animal-shaped single rock excavations

- (a) A - 3, B - 1, C - 2
(b) A - 1, B - 2, C - 3
(c) A - 1, B - 3, C - 2
(d) A - 2, B - 1, C - 3

Exp.-

Column A (Cave Sites)	Column B (Architectural Features)
A. Udayagiri	2. Back side with rooms, verandah with pillars
B. Guntupalli	1. Chaitya hall with stupa and verandah
C. Khandagiri	3. Excavation of caves in the shape of animals

Ans. (d)

51. Which of the following features distinguishes the Elephanta Caves from other rock-cut sites of early India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 12/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) They are primarily Buddhist caves with large stupas.
(b) The caves focus on Shaivite themes and feature sculptural depth through light and shadow.
(c) They contain a mix of Jain and Vaishnavite depictions in pillar halls.
(d) The caves are entirely monolithic structures from the Mauryan period.

Exp.- The **Elephanta Caves**, located on Elephanta Island near Mumbai, are primarily centered on Shaivite themes, where magnificent sculptures of the three forms of Shiva, such as **Trimurti, Nataraja and Ardhanarishvara**, are carved.

- The sculpture of Shiva gains depth through the effect of **light and shadow**, which distinguishes them from early **rock-cut** sites like the **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra, Aurangabad) and the **Barabar Caves** (Bihar, Gaya). Ans. (b)

52. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options:

Assertion (A): The Buddha sculptures of the Gandhara School show Hellenistic features.

Reason (R): The Buddha head from this school has curly hair and shows typical Hellenistic elements.

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.



Exp.- Gandhara Art is a unique blend of **Greco-Roman (Hellenistic)** and **Indian styles**. Assertion (A) is correct because the Buddha statues in the Gandhara style clearly show physical features and characteristics similar to the **Greek god Apollo**.

- ❑ Elements such as the Buddha's **curly hair, facial musculature**, and finely carved **drapery** (folded clothing) on the body directly reflect the **Hellenistic influence**. Therefore, Reason (R) is also correct and confirms Assertion (A). **Ans. (a)**

53. Which of the following features are associated with the Gothic architectural style?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Sloping tiled roofs
(b) Pointed arches and stained glass windows
(c) Flat roofs with courtyards
(d) Domes with minarets

Exp.- The Gothic style is an architectural method that developed in medieval Europe, which was introduced in India by the British as 'Indo-Gothic' or 'Neo-Gothic'.

- ❑ The most prominent features of this style are its pointed arches, stained glass windows, high rising ribbed vaults, and flying buttresses that provide strength to the walls. **Ans. (b)**

54. Which of the following sculptures does not originate from the Mathura region's Kushana-period artistic production?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Katra Keshav Dev fragment
(b) Govind Nagar Yaksha
(c) Bala Buddha of Sultanganj
(d) Standing Buddha from Govindnagar

Exp.- The colossal copper statue of Buddha found from Sultanganj (Bihar) belongs to the **Gupta period (approx. 5th-7th century)**, and not the Kushan period. In contrast, the statues of Buddha and Bodhisattva found from Katra Keshav Dev and Govind Nagar are prominent examples of the Mathura school and **artistic excellence of the Kushan period**.

- ❑ Sculptures of the Mathura school were mainly made of **spotted red sandstone**. **Ans. (c)**

14

Miscellaneous

1. In the following questions, a statement of Assertion (A) is followed by a statement of Reason (R).

Select the correct option from the following:

Assertion (A): People who used copper hoards in the upper Gangetic basin were nomadic hunters.

Reason (R): Copper hoards were often found with ochre-coloured pots and mud structures.

SSC PHASE XIII 28/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R explains A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A.
(c) A is false, but R is true.
(d) Both A and R are false.

Exp.- In the Upper Ganga Basin, the people of the **Copper Hoards** and **Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)** culture were not nomadic hunters. Archaeological evidence suggests that they led a settled agricultural life and practiced animal husbandry along with farming. Therefore, Assertion (A) is false.

- ❑ These copper hoards (such as axes, spears, etc.) have been found along with Ochre Coloured Pottery. Excavations in the **Ganga-Yamuna Doab** region have revealed deep associations of these copper objects with clay structures and pottery. Therefore, Reason (R) is true. **Ans. (c)**

2. What did kings often rewarded brahmanas with in the seventh century?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Gold coins
(b) Land grants
(c) Cattle
(d) Horses

Exp.- In the seventh century, kings often rewarded Brahmanas by making grants of land, and the land given to Brahmanas was known as '**brahmadeya**'.

- ❑ The revenue received from these land areas went to the Brahmanas, and often these areas were tax-free. The details of these land grants were recorded on **copper plates**. **Ans. (b)**

3. Who among the following was the author of Virasoliyam?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Buddhmitra
(b) Ottakuthar
(c) Amirthasagarar
(d) Sekkilar

Exp.-

Option	Author	Composition
A	Buddhamitra	Virasoliyam
B	Ottakuthar	Muchandram
C	Amirthasagar	Nayachandra Charit
D	Sekkizhar	Aalappillai

Ans. (a)

4. The most important achievement of Shishunaga was _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) conquering Kalinga.
(b) building Pataliputra fort.
(c) holding the first Buddhist council.
(d) defeating Avanti (Malwa) and annexing it to Magadh.

Exp.- Shishunaga's greatest achievement was ending the Pradyota dynasty of Avanti. This brought an end to the years-long conflict between Magadha and Avanti.

- ❑ **Kalinga Victory** was an achievement of Mahapadma Nanda and later Emperor Ashoka.

- ❑ **First Buddhist Council** was organized by King Ajatashatru of the Haryanka dynasty. **Ans. (d)**

5. In Buddhist teachings, what does the term metta primarily refer to?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mindful meditation
(b) Ritual purity
(c) Fellow feeling
(d) Celibacy and renunciation

Exp.- In Buddhism, **Metta** (Pali) or **Maitri** (Sanskrit) means to have a feeling of selfless love, compassion, and friendliness towards all living beings. It is the first of the '**Brahmaviharas**' (four divine abodes), which emphasizes developing universal goodwill in the mind by removing anger and ill-will. **Ans. (c)**

6. Which two languages flourished alongside Sanskrit in Vedic ancient India?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Hindi and Urdu
(b) Pali and Prakrit
(c) Bengali and Tamil
(d) English and Persian

Exp.- During the Vedic and ancient Indian periods, languages like **Pali** and **Prakrit** flourished and were widely prevalent alongside **Sanskrit**. However, Sanskrit remained the primary language of scholars, Brahmins, and religious texts (the Vedas).

- ❑ **Pali** became the language of the common people and gained particular fame for the teachings of **Lord Buddha** and Buddhist scriptures such as the **Tripitaka**. **Ans. (b)**



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7. According to Jaina ethics, the vow of 'aparigraha' refers to _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Fasting until death.
- (b) Refraining from theft.
- (c) Speaking only the truth.
- (d) Non-possession of things more than one's requirement.

Exp.- The vow of Aparigraha means not accumulating possessions beyond one's needs. It is one of the **Pancha Mahavratas** (five great vows) of Jainism (the other four are: Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, and Brahmacharya).

- Aparigraha has also been included under 'Yama' in Maharishi Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga. **Ans. (d)**

8. The Gwalior Fort, was initiated by _____ who finished the fortification system around the plateau in 773CE.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Rana Sanga
- (c) Raja Sourya Sena
- (d) Ashoka

Exp.- The construction of the Gwalior Fort was started in the 8th century (773 AD) by Raja **Suryasen**. Due to its strategic importance, this fort is called the '**Pearl among the fortresses of India**'.

- Later, the Tomar King **Mansingh**, as well as the Mughal, Maratha, and Scindia dynasties, also ruled over the Gwalior Fort. **Ans. (c)**

9. What was the total number of Alvar saints in the Bhakti movement tradition?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 12
- (b) 29
- (c) 44
- (d) 63

Exp.- In the **Vaishnava tradition** of the **Bhakti Movement**, the total number of **Alvar saints** is considered to be **12**. Their devotional hymns are compiled in the **Nalayira Divya Prabandham**.

- They were ardent devotees of **Lord Vishnu** and propagated the message of love and devotion through their songs. **Ans. (a)**

10. In which of the following are the songs of Alvar saints compiled?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Divya Prabandham
- (b) Ettutogai
- (c) Tipitaka
- (d) Adi-Puran

Exp.- **Nalayira Divya Prabandham** is a compilation of the devotional hymns of the **Alvar saints**. It is considered a significant text of the **Vaishnava Bhakti tradition**. It contains a collection of **4,000 hymns** composed by the 12 Alvars.

- In the Divya Prabandham, the compositions of **Nammalvar** and the woman saint **Andal** are particularly famous. **Ans. (a)**

11. Which of the following pair regarding monument - location is correct?

- I. Golconda Fort - Rajasthan
- II. Bharatpur Fort - Telangana

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Golkonda Fort is located in Telangana and its construction was carried out by the Kakatiya dynasty in the 12th century.

- Bharatpur Fort (Lohagarh Fort) is located in Rajasthan and was built by the Jat ruler **Maharaja Suraj Mal**. It is also considered as the 'Invincible Fort' of India. **Ans. (d)**

12. Which metal was first used by early human communities in ancient India?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Iron
- (b) Bronze
- (c) Gold
- (d) Copper

Exp.- In ancient India, **copper** was the first metal used by early human communities. After the end of the Stone Age, when humans began using metals, copper was the first metal they identified and used to make tools. This period is called the **Chalcolithic Age**, which began around 5000 BCE. **Ans. (d)**

13. Which 7th-century mathematician and astronomer revolutionized the study of numbers?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Patanjali
- (b) Salim Ali
- (c) Brahmagupta
- (d) Srikrishna

Exp.- **Brahmagupta**, a great mathematician and astronomer of the **7th century**, brought a **revolution** in the study of numbers by providing rules for zero and negative numbers. Through his book '**Brahmasphutasiddhanta**' in the 7th century, he explained complex mathematical formulas and their mathematical behavior. **Ans. (c)**

14. Which of the following influential philosophers were born in Kerala in the eighth century?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Chaitnya
- (b) Ramanuja
- (c) Shankara
- (d) Namdev

Exp.- Adi Shankaracharya was born in the 8th century in the village of **Kaladi** in Kerala. He propounded the doctrine of '**Advaita Vedanta**', which means that the soul (Atman) and the Supreme God (Brahman) are one.

- He established four monasteries (mathas) in the four corners of India (Badrinath, Dwarka, Puri, and Sringeri). **Ans. (c)**

15. Some of the earliest works in Tamil, known as Sangam literature, were composed around _____ years ago.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 6500
- (b) 5000
- (c) 2300
- (d) 3300

Exp.- Sangam literature was composed approximately **2300 years ago (between 300 BCE and 300 CE)**.

- Sangam literature contains descriptions of **three major South Indian dynasties (Cheras, Cholas, and Pandyas)**.
- These compositions provide details about ancient Tamil society, culture, trade, and politics. **Ans. (c)**

16. The grammar composed by Panini consists of over, grammatical rules.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 692
- (b) 1632
- (c) 4000
- (d) 7012

Exp.- Panini wrote a famous treatise on Sanskrit grammar called '**Ashtadhyayi**'. It contains about **4,000 sutras** (grammatical rules).

- It is divided into eight chapters, and it is considered one of the oldest and most scientific grammatical treatises in the world. **Ans. (c)**

17. What were the coins minted in Delhi during the reign of Tomar and Chauhan called?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rupees
- (b) Dehliwal
- (c) Dinar
- (d) Tanka

Exp.- During the time of the Tomara and Chauhan kings, Delhi was a major center of trade, where coins called '**Dehliwal**' were minted.

- These coins often had the image of a **bull (Nandi)** on one side and a **horseman** on the other.
- **Tanka** and **jital** were later introduced during the **Delhi Sultanate** (Iltutmish). **Ans. (b)**

18. The 'Charaksamhita' is a treatise on which of the following subjects?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Medicine
- (b) Astronomy
- (c) Architecture
- (d) Mathematics

Exp.- The Charakasamhita is a foundational text of medical science (Ayurveda), which focuses on the diagnosis of diseases, treatment, and a healthy lifestyle.

- It is authored by the renowned sage **Charaka** of ancient India, who is considered the 'father of Indian medical science'. **Ans. (a)**

19. Identify the correctly matched pairs.

Kalibangan - Fire altars

Megasthenes - Arthashastra

Chalcolithic culture - Use of both copper and stone

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 2 only
- (d) 1, 2, and 3



Exp.- Kalibangan - Fire Altars: 'Fire altars' were discovered during excavations at Kalibangan, a Harappan site located in Rajasthan.

□ 'Arthashastra' was authored by Chanakya (Kautilya). **Megasthenes** wrote a book titled 'Indica', which provides an account of India during the Mauryan period. **Ans. (a)**

20. Which of the following scholars wrote the Ashtanga Sangraha?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Charaka
- (b) Sushruta
- (c) Bhaskaracharya
- (d) Vagbhata

Exp.- 'Ashtanga Sangraha' is an extremely important text of Ayurveda composed by **Vagbhata**, in which he has provided a detailed compilation of the eight branches of Ayurveda, including general medicine (Kayachikitsa) and surgery (Shalyachikitsa).

□ Vagbhata is considered a part of the 'Brihat Trayi' (the three great works) of Ayurveda, which includes the **Charaka Samhita**, **Sushruta Samhita** and **Vagbhata's Ashtanga Sangraha or Ashtanga Hridaya**. **Ans. (d)**

21. Approximately how many water bodies originally existed in Chittorgarh Fort?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 22
- (b) 50
- (c) 84
- (d) 100

Exp.- Chittorgarh Fort is known as the 'Water Fort of Rajasthan', where historically **84 water bodies** (ponds, wells, and stepwells) were located.

□ **Cenotaphs (chhatris)** have been built here in memory of **Jaimal and Kalla**, who attained martyrdom during the **siege of 1568**. This fort is spread over approximately **240 hectares** and is situated on a hill **180 meters** high. **Ans. (c)**

22. Who visits the forest in the Tamil epic Silappadikaram?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Chera
- (b) Cholan
- (c) Senguttuvan
- (d) Ilango

Exp.- According to the third part of Silappadikaram, '**Vanji Kandam**', the Chera king Chera Senguttuvan goes on a visit to the forests of the Nilgiri hills with his queen and courtiers.

□ This epic was composed by his brother, the Jain monk **Ilango Adigal**. It is one of the five great epics of Sangam literature and provides a vivid portrayal of the Chola-Pandya-Chera society. **Ans. (c)**

23. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct option:

Assertion (A): The sculptures of the Nalanda School are three-dimensional and delicately ornamented.

Reason (R): The Nalanda sculptural tradition was influenced by Sarnath, local Bihar styles, and central Indian art.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false
- (d) A is false, but R is true

Exp.- The sculptural tradition of Nalanda was influenced by the **Sarnath school**, local traditions of Bihar, and the art of Central India. It was through the amalgamation of these influences that tenderness, refined expression, and three-dimensional beauty developed in the sculptures of Nalanda.

□ This art, which developed during the Pala period, utilized **black basalt** and **bronze (lost wax technique)**, and its influence extended from India to Southeast Asia. **Ans. (a)**

24. Match the dynasties listed in Column A with the regions they primarily ruled over, as given in Column B:

Column A: Dynasty	Column B: Region
A. Gurjara-Pratiharas	1. Bengal
B. Rashtrakutas	2. Tamil Nadu
C. Palas	3. Gujarat and Rajasthan
D. Cholas	4. Western Deccan

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) A - 3, B - 4, C - 1, D - 2
- (b) A - 4, B - 3, C - 1, D - 2
- (c) A - 2, B - 3, C - 1, D - 4
- (d) A - 4, B - 3, C - 2, D - 1

Exp.-

Dynasty	Major Region	Important Rulers	Period
A. Gurjara-Pratihara	Gujarat, Rajasthan	Nagabhata-I, Mihira Bhoja	8 th -10 th century
B. Rashtrakuta	Western Deccan	Dantidurga, Amoghavarsha	8 th -10 th century

C. Pala	Bengal	Gopala, Dharma Pala	8 th -12 th century
D. Chola	Tamil Nadu	Vijayalaya, Rajaraja	9 th -13 th century
Ans. (a)			

25. Who wrote 'Indica: A Deep Natural History of the Indian Subcontinent'?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Sanjeev Sanyal
- (b) Pranay Lal
- (c) Rohan Murty
- (d) Tony Joseph

Exp.- Pranay Lal is the author of the book 'Indica: A Deep Natural History of the Indian Subcontinent', who is a biochemist. In this book, he has scientifically presented the geological, fossil, and ecological history of India. **Ans. (b)**

26. In Bhakti traditions, which two broad types of worship are mentioned?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 13/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Vedic and Non-Vedic
- (b) Saguna and Nirguna
- (c) Orthodox and Reformist
- (d) Shaiva and Vaishnava

Exp.- In the Bhakti tradition, there were two main forms of worship, the first being Saguna which means worship of God in a **concrete form and idol worship (Meera, Tulsidas)** were prominent) and the second being **Nirguna** meaning devotion to the **formless and abstract Brahman (Kabir, Nanak)** were prominent). **Ans. (b)**

27. Which of the following best describes Annamacharya's contribution to Indian devotional music?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 13/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Composed Sanskrit hymns on caste rituals.
- (b) Wrote over 32,000 songs promoting devotion and equality.
- (c) Restricted songs to temples and priests only.
- (d) Focused only on melody, not on social reform.

Exp.- Annamacharya was a great **saint/poet** of South India from the 15th century who composed approximately **32,000 sankirtans/devotional songs** in praise of Lord Venkateswara. These songs beautifully express social/spiritual themes such as devotion, dharma, morality, and equality.

□ He also challenged caste/discrimination and social inequality through his compositions. **Ans. (b)**



01

Arab invasions

Muhammad Gori/Rajput Dynasty

1. Which Rajput ruler defeated Muhammad Ghori in the First Battle of Tarain?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Hem Chandra Vikramaditya
(b) Rana Sanga
(c) Bappa Rawal
(d) Prithviraj Chauhan

Exp.-

Battle	First Battle of Tarain	Second Battle of Tarain
Year	1191 AD	1192 AD
Winner	Prithviraj Chauhan	Muhammad Ghori

Ans. (d)

2. Which of the following kingdom was under the rule of the Sisodia dynasty during the 15th century?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Gujarat
(b) Malwa
(c) Mewar
(d) Bengal

Exp.- In the 15th century, Mewar was ruled by the Sisodia dynasty, with its capital at Chittorgarh, and its military and political power reached its zenith during the time of Rana Kumbha (1433-1468).

- The Sisodia rulers fought continuously against the Delhi Sultanate and the Sultans of Gujarat and Malwa to protect the independence of Mewar.

Ans. (c)

3. Which Chahamana ruler defeated Sultan Muhammad Ghori in 1191 A.D?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Ajayaraja II
(b) Vigraharaja IV
(c) Prithviraja III
(d) Vigraharaja V

Exp.- Prithviraj III (also known as Prithviraj Chauhan) decisively defeated Muhammad Ghori in the first battle of Tarain in **1191 AD**. He was a famous ruler of the **Chahamana (Chauhan)** dynasty of Ajmer and Delhi.

- In **1192 AD**, Muhammad Ghori defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in the second battle of Tarain.

Ans. (c)

4. The reign of Prithviraj Chauhan concluded in which year?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1175 CE
(b) 1192 CE
(c) 1206 CE
(d) 1210 CE

Exp.- The reign of Prithviraj Chauhan ended with his defeat by Muhammad Ghori in the Second Battle of Tarain in **1192 CE**. This decisive battle paved the way for the establishment of the **Delhi Sultanate** and Muslim rule in India.

Ans. (b)

5. Which of the following dynasties minted the "Dehliwal" coins in Delhi?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) The Gahadavalas
(b) The Tomaras
(c) The Khaljis
(d) The Lodis

Exp.- In Delhi, "Dehliwal" coins were first minted by the Tomara Rajputs, which were primarily made from a mixture of silver and copper.

- These coins often featured images of 'Nandi' (the bull) and a 'Horseman'.

Ans. (b)

02

Delhi Sultanate

Slave Dynasty

1. Arrange the following rulers of the Delhi Sultanate in the correct chronological order of their reigns, starting from the earliest:

1. Razia Sultan
2. Ghiyas ud din Balban
3. Qutb ud-Din Aibak
4. Iltutmish

SSC CGL TIER-I, 15/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 3-4-1-2 (b) 4-3-1-2
(c) 3-1-4-2 (d) 1-3-4-2

Exp.- The Delhi Sultanate began with the **Slave Dynasty (1206 - 1290)**. Qutubuddin Aibak established independent rule in **1206 AD** after the death of Muhammad Ghori. Iltutmish ascended the throne in 1211 AD, and Iltutmish's daughter, Razia Sultan, the only female ruler of the Delhi Sultanate, took over the reins of government in **1236 AD**. **Ghiyasuddin Balban** sat on the throne in **1266 AD** and suppressed rebellions with stern policies.

Ans. (a)

2. Which one of the following pairs of ruler and length of their reign, is correctly matched?

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Muhammad Tughluq - Ruled for 15 years
(b) Raziyya - Ruled for 4 years
(c) Alauddin Khalji - Ruled for 10 years
(d) Ghiyasuddin Balban - Ruled for 35 years

Exp.- **Razia Sultan**: She ruled from **1236 to 1240 AD**, a period of approximately **4 years**. She was the **first female ruler** of the **Delhi Sultanate**.

Other Options:

- **Muhammad Tughlaq**: Reigning period **1325-1351 AD** (approximately **26 years**).
□ **Alauddin Khalji**: Reigning period **1296-1316 AD** (approximately **20 years**).
□ **Ghiyasuddin Balban**: Reigning period **1266-1287 AD** (approximately **21 years**).

Ans. (b)

3. Consider the following statements:

1. Iltutmish succeeded Qutub-ud-din Aibak and was later followed by his daughter Razia.
2. Razia ruled the Delhi Sultanate for several decades, marking one of the longest reigns of any female monarch.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 30/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) only 1
(b) only 2
(c) neither 1 nor 2 is correct
(d) both 1 and 2 are correct

Exp.- After the death of **Qutb-ud-din Aibak (1210 AD)**, **Aram Shah** ascended the throne, but **Iltutmish** removed him from power and became the ruler of **Delhi** in **1211 AD**, reigning until **1236 AD**. Following him, his daughter **Raziyya Sultan** ruled and became the **first female Sultan** of Delhi. Therefore, statement (I) is correct.



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- The reign of **Raziyya Sultan** was very brief. She ruled for only **4 years** (from **1236 AD to 1240 AD**). Therefore, statement (II) is incorrect. *Ans. (a)*

4. Who ruled the Delhi Sultanate from 1236 to 1240 A.D. as the only woman monarch?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Noor Jahan
(b) Razia Sultana
(c) Rani Durgavati
(d) Chand Bibi

Exp.- Razia Sultan (1236–1240 CE)
Razia Sultan was the **only female ruler** of the Delhi Sultanate. She ascended the throne and ruled after the reign of **Iluttmish**.

- Razia abandoned the **pardah system** (the practice of veiling). She began appearing in the royal court wearing a **Quba** (a long coat) and a **Kulah** (a cap), similar to the attire worn by men.

- In **1240 CE**, Razia Sultan was assassinated by bandits near Kaithal (present-day Haryana). *Ans. (b)*

5. Which contemporary chronicler acknowledged that Raziyya Sultan was more capable than her brothers?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Minhaj-us-Siraj
(b) Ziauddin Barani
(c) Al-Biruni
(d) Ibn Battuta

Exp.- The contemporary historian **Minhaj-i-Siraj** believed that **Raziyya Sultan** was more able and qualified than all her brothers, and in his famous book '**Tabaqat-i-Nasiri**', he praised Raziyya's abilities openly.

- **Ziyyaaddin Barani** composed the text **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**, which provides an account of the rule of the Tughluq dynasty. *Ans. (a)*

6. Who were called 'Bandagan' in Persian in Delhi Sultanate?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Aristocrats and nobles
(b) Landed chieftains appointed as governors
(c) Religious scholars
(d) Military slaves purchased by the Sultan

Exp.- 'Bandagan' is a Persian term used specifically for **slaves** who were purchased for **military service**.

- Sultans like Iluttmish appointed them to important positions such as governors (**iqtadars**) and military commanders because they were completely loyal to the Sultan. *Ans. (d)*

7. The red sandstone tower of Qutb Minar has meters diameter at its base.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 14.32 (b) 16.32
(c) 10.32 (d) 12.32

Exp.- The diameter of the base of the Qutub Minar is **14.32 metres**, which tapers to only **2.75 metres** at the top.

- Its foundation was laid by **Qutubuddin Aibak** in 1199 AD, and it was later completed by Iluttmish and Firoz Shah Tughlaq. *Ans. (a)*

8. The Chahalgani (Group of Forty) nobles were formed during the reign of:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Balban
(b) Iluttmish
(c) Alauddin Khalji
(d) Qutb-ud-din Aibak

Exp.- Chahalgani (Turkan-i-Chahalgani or the Group of Forty) was formed during the reign of Iluttmish. Iluttmish created a group of 40 loyal Turkish slave officers who served as advisors in the administration and military affairs of the Delhi Sultanate. *Ans. (b)*

9. Consider the following statements:

Statement 1: Qutub-ud-din Aibak established the Slave Dynasty after the death of Mohammad Ghori

Statement 2: The Delhi Sultanate began with the rule of Balban, one of the notable rulers of the Khalji dynasty

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Exp.- Qutubuddin Aibak laid the foundation of the **Delhi Sultanate** and the **Slave Dynasty** (Mamluk Dynasty) in **1206 AD** after the death of Muhammad Ghori.

- Meanwhile, statement 2 is incorrect because **Balban** was not a part of the Khalji dynasty, but was a powerful ruler of the Slave dynasty. *Ans. (a)*

Khilji Dynasty

10. Which of the following was the primary objective of Alauddin Khalji's market control regulations?

SSC CGL TIER - II, 18/01/2026

- (a) To expand treasury revenues by encouraging unrestricted trade with neighboring regions.
(b) To keep prices of essential commodities low so that soldiers could be maintained on fixed salaries.
(c) To replace religious taxation with a uniform system of commercial levies in markets.
(d) To promote foreign trade by encouraging Indian textile exports to foreign empires.

Exp.- Alauddin Khalji's market controls or economic reforms were not motivated by philanthropy, but by strategic and military necessity.

- Alauddin Khilji needed a large standing army to protect against Mongol invasions and expand his empire.

- Alauddin Khilji began paying his soldiers in cash instead of in **iqta (land)**. He kept their salaries low to avoid burdening the treasury. *Ans. (b)*

11. Which Sultan was responsible for shifting the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
(b) Muhammad bin Tughlaq
(c) Balban
(d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq

Exp.- For protection from Mongol invasions and with the objective of ruling from the center of the empire, Muhammad bin Tughluq shifted his capital from Delhi to **Daulatabad (Devagiri) in 1327 CE**. However, this decision of his remained unsuccessful and later they had to return to Delhi. *Ans. (b)*

12. Which Delhi sultan was known for his "Market Reforms"?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Balban
(b) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
(c) Alauddin Khalji
(d) Iluttmish

Exp.- Alauddin Khalji introduced the most comprehensive **market control and economic reforms** in the Delhi Sultanate to maintain his huge army and to prevent inflation.

- Three separate markets were set up for trade, **Sarai-i-Adl** (cloth and expensive items), and the market for horses or slaves and cattle. *Ans. (c)*

13. Which of the following rulers mobilized a large standing army in Delhi due to the Mongol invasion, which posed a huge administrative challenge?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- I. Alauddin Khalji
II. Muhammad Tughluq
(a) Only I
(b) Only II
(c) Both I and II
(d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Seeing the threat of constant Mongol invasions, both Sultans, Alauddin Khalji and Muhammad bin Tughluq, raised a large standing army.

- **Alauddin Khalji** adopted a **defensive strategy** and fortified his defenses (fortification) to stop the Mongols.

- On the other hand, **Muhammad bin Tughluq** planned an **offensive strategy** and raised an army to attack the Mongol territory. However, his plans failed due to his administrative experiments (shifting of the capital and the introduction of token currency). *Ans. (c)*



14. Which Sultan used the Banjaras to transport grain to city markets?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Muhammad bin Tughlaq
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Sher Shah Suri
- (d) Babur

Exp.- Alauddin Khalji is known for his market control and economic reforms. He made significant use of the Banjaras to ensure a continuous supply of grain to the towns.

- The market control policy of Alauddin Khalji is mentioned by the famous historian Ziauddin Barani in his book '**Tarikh-i Firoz Shahi**'. Ans. (b)

15. Alauddin Khalji's reign is marked by his successful defense against which foreign invader?

SSC PHASE XIII 28/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Timur
- (b) Mongols
- (c) Babur
- (d) Mahmud of Ghazni

Exp.- The reign of **Alauddin Khalji** (1296–1316 CE) is famous in Indian history for successfully repelling the devastating **Mongol invasions** from the North-West frontier. Between 1296 and 1306, he foiled several major Mongol attacks through efficient military strategy, a large standing army, the strengthening of frontier forts (such as **Siri**), and rigorous defensive reforms. Ans. (b)

16. Consider the following statements:

Statement 1. Alauddin Khalji is remembered for administrative reforms and military expansion in the north.

Statement 2. Muhammad Bin Tughlaq's project to transfer the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad ultimately failed.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Exp.- **Alauddin Khalji** maintained a **massive standing army** to protect against the **Mongols** and for **imperial expansion**. To manage the expenditure and efficiency of this army, he introduced significant reforms such as **Market Control (Price Control)**, the '**Dag**' system (branding of horses), and the recording of the '**Huliya**' (descriptive roll of soldiers). Therefore, statement 1 is correct.

- **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** transferred the capital from **Delhi to Daulatabad** in **1327 CE** for **administrative reasons**. However, due to **practical problems** and the **suffering of the people**, this plan was a complete failure, and he had to return to Delhi. Therefore, statement 2 is correct. Ans. (c)

17. Neither Malik Kafur nor Alauddin Khalji led campaigns against:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Devagiri
- (b) Warangal
- (c) Vijayanagara
- (d) Madurai

Exp.- **Alauddin Khalji** and his commander **Malik Kafur** had conquered many kingdoms of South India such as **Devagiri (1296)**, **Warangal (1309-10)** and **Madurai (1311)**, but they never launched any campaign against **Vijayanagara**. Ans. (c)

Tughlaq Dynasty

18. The Feroz Shah Kotla Fort, also known as the home of the djinns, was built in_____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1321
- (b) 1354
- (c) 1267
- (d) 1492

Exp.- The Feroz Shah Kotla Fort was built by Sultan Feroz Shah Tughlaq in **1354 AD**.

- Feroz Shah Tughlaq brought two **Ashoka Pillars** from Topra and Meerut and installed them here, which can still be seen in the fort today.
- This fort was part of his new capital '**Firozabad**', which is considered the fifth city of Delhi. Ans. (b)

19. Which fourteenth-century traveller described how Indian chieftains fortified themselves using bamboo groves and rugged terrains for defence?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Al-Baruni
- (b) Ibn Battuta
- (c) Marco Polo
- (d) Megasthenes

Exp.- The Moroccan traveler Ibn Battuta, in his work '**Rihla**', has described how local chieftains in India used hilly, rocky, and dense bamboo forests as natural fortifications.

- He came to India from the north-western frontier in **1333 AD** during the reign of **Muhammad bin Tughluq** and reached Delhi, where the Sultan honored him and appointed him as the **Qazi** of the capital. Ans. (b)

20. Which Delhi Sultan appointed people from humble professions to high administrative posts?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Muhammad Tughlaq
- (b) Ruknuddin Firuz
- (c) Minhaj-us-Siraj
- (d) Ghiyasuddin Balban

Exp.- Muhammad bin Tughluq gave importance to merit in his administrative system and appointed people from humble social backgrounds to high offices.

- He appointed **Aziz Khummar** (a wine distiller), **Firuz Hajjam** (a barber), **Manka Tabbakh** (a cook), and **Ladha** and **Pira** (gardeners) to high administrative posts. Ans. (a)

21. Who constructed the city of Tughlaqabad?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Alauddin Khilji
- (b) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- (c) Mohammad Bin Tughlaq
- (d) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq

Exp.- **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**, the founder of the Tughlaq dynasty, laid the foundation of Tughlaqabad in **1320-21 AD**. It was a massive fort-city, which was built with strong stones and high walls for protection against **Mongol invasions**. Ans. (d)

22. Which of the following pair regarding the Ruler of Delhi sultanate-period of their rule is correct?

- I. Ghiyasuddin Balban-1266-1287
- II. Firuz Shah Tughluq-1351-1388

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- **Ghiyasuddin Balban (1266-1287)** was a powerful ruler of the Slave dynasty who adopted the policy of '**Iron and Blood**' and introduced the practices of '**Sijda and Paibos**'.

- **Firoz Shah Tughlaq (1351-1388)** was a ruler of the Tughlaq dynasty, who is known for his public welfare schemes, construction of canals, and the founding of several new cities (such as Hissar, Firozabad). Ans. (c)

Lodi Dynasty

23. After the Tughlaqs, which two dynasties ruled Agra until 1526?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Sur and Khaljis
- (b) Tughlaqs and Mughals
- (c) Khiljis and Lodis
- (d) Sayyids and Lodis

Exp.- After the fall of the Tughlaq dynasty, Delhi and Agra were ruled by the **Sayyid dynasty (1414-1451)** and the **Lodi dynasty (1451-1526)**. In 1504, **Sikandar Lodi**, the ruler of the Lodi dynasty, founded the city of Agra and made it his capital.

- In 1526 AD, **Babur** established the Mughal Empire after winning the First Battle of Panipat. Ans. (d)

24. Name the Lodhi ruler shifted the capital from Delhi to Agra?

SSC PHASE XIII 26/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sikandar Lodhi
- (b) Ibrahim Lodhi
- (c) Bahlul Lodhi
- (d) Daulat Khan Lodhi

Exp.- **Sikandar Lodi** laid the foundation of the city of **Agra** in 1504 CE and shifted his capital from Delhi to Agra in 1506 CE for strategic and administrative reasons. He ruled from 1489 to 1517 CE and made Agra a major political and commercial center of North India. Ans. (a)

25. In which battle was Ibrahim Lodhi defeated by Babur?

SSC PHASE XIII 26/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Battle of Khanwa
- (b) Battle of Panipat (1526)
- (c) Battle of Chausa
- (d) Battle of Ghagra

Exp.- In the **First Battle of Panipat**, fought on April 21, 1526, **Babur** defeated **Ibrahim Lodi**. This decisive victory marked the end of the **Delhi Sultanate** and laid the foundation of the **Mughal Empire** in India.

- Babur's success is attributed to his advanced artillery and the **Tulughma** system of warfare.

Ans. (b)

Administration of the Delhi Sultanate

26. In the Delhi Sultanate, what was the main duty of the 'Muqtis' in their assigned Iqta?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) To manage high quality of horses.
- (b) To manage trade and commerce.
- (c) To construct forts and palaces.
- (d) To lead military campaigns and maintain law and order.

Exp.- In the Delhi Sultanate, the primary duty of the **muqti (iqtdar)** was to lead military campaigns and maintain law and order in their iqtas.

- The surplus revenue that remained after meeting their own expenses had to be deposited in the state treasury; this was called **fawazil**.

Ans. (d)

27. During the Delhi Sultanate period, which one of the following taxes was levied on treasure looted in war?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Kharaj
- (b) Jizyah
- (c) Zakat
- (d) Khums

Exp.- During the Delhi Sultanate period, the **Khums** tax was levied on the spoils of war. According to Shariat, 1/5th of it went to the state treasury, and 4/5th was distributed among the soldiers.

- **Kharaj** was a land tax, **Jizya** was a personal tax collected from non-Muslims, and **Zakat** was a religious tax paid by Muslims.

Ans. (d)

28. The architectural feature of the true arch and dome in India was first introduced by the:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Ghaznavids
- (b) Delhi Sultanate
- (c) Rashtrakutas
- (d) Chalukyas

Exp.- The arrival of the Delhi Sultanate brought revolutionary changes to Indian architecture, the most significant of which was the introduction of the '**arcuate**' style. In this style, arches and domes were used to support the weight, which was different from the ancient Indian '**trabeate**' style.

Ans. (b)

03

Vijayanagar Empire

1. The Battle of Talikota (1565) led to the downfall of which empire?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Mughal Empire
- (b) Vijayanagara Empire
- (c) Chola Dynasty
- (d) Maratha Empire

Exp.- The Battle of Talikota (Rakshasa-Tangdi) was fought in 1565 AD between the Vijayanagara Empire and the combined Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Ahmednagar, Golconda, Bidar).

Ans. (b)

2. Neither the Iqta system nor the Mansabdari system was prevalent under the:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Delhi Sultanate
- (b) Mughals
- (c) Vijayanagara Empire
- (d) Lodi Dynasty

Exp.- During the Vijayanagara Empire, neither the Iqta system nor the Mansabdari system was prevalent. In Vijayanagara, the **Amara-nayaka system (Nayaka system)** existed, where military officers (**Nayakas**) were given the right to collect revenue.

Ans. (c)

3. Who was the leader that defeated Krishnadevaraya of Vijayanagara in the Battle of Raichur?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Alauddin Khilji
- (b) Ahmed Shah Bahmani
- (c) Ibrahim Lodi
- (d) Adil Shah of Bijapur

Exp.- The Battle of Raichur (1520 AD) was fought between Krishnadeva Raya, the great ruler of the Vijayanagara Empire, and Sultan **Ismail Adil Shah** of Bijapur. In this battle, Krishnadeva Raya achieved a decisive victory. The main reason for continuous conflicts between the Vijayanagara and Bijapur (Deccan Sultanate) was **control over the Raichur Doab**, which was a highly fertile region located between the Krishna and Tungabhadra rivers.

Ans. (d)

4. Which confederation of Sultanates defeated the Vijayanagara Empire in the Battle of Talikota?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rajput Confederacy
- (b) Mughal Empire
- (c) Bahmani Sultanate
- (d) Deccan Sultanates

Exp.- The Battle of Talikota, which was fought on **23 January 1565**, saw Vijayanagara face a powerful confederacy of the Deccan Sultanates, which included the armies of Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, and Bidar. The Vijayanagara army was led by **Rama Raya**.

Ans. (d)

5. The term "Amaram" in Vijayanagara administration was associated with:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Tax exemption
- (b) Military fief
- (c) Land redistribution
- (d) Merchant guilds

Exp.- In the Vijayanagara Empire, the kings (Raya) used to provide a specific tract of land to their military commanders, known as 'nayakas', in return for their military services; this land was called '**amaram**'.

Ans. (b)

6. Which of the following works was composed by the Vijayanagara ruler Krishnadevaraya and is renowned for its poetic richness and devotion to Lord Vishnu?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Ramacharitam
- (b) Amuktamalyada
- (c) Gita Govinda
- (d) Manimekalai

Exp.- Amuktamalyada was composed by the Vijayanagara Emperor Krishnadevaraya in Telugu. It describes the marriage of Lord Ranganatha (Vishnu) and the devotee Andal, and this text is important for understanding both the bhakti tradition and the political-administrative ideology of the Vijayanagara Empire.

- Ramacharitam is a Tamil Jain epic (not authored by Krishnadevaraya), **Gita Govinda** is composed by Jayadeva, and **Manimekalai** is a Tamil Buddhist epic authored by Sattanar.

Ans. (b)

7. In the traditional accounts of Vijayanagara, who were referred to as narapati or "lord of men"?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)



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- (a) Mughals (b) Deccan Sultans
(c) Cholas (d) Rayas

Exp.- The rulers of Vijayanagara called themselves '**Raya**' and titles based on military power were prevalent, such as **Narapati** (Vijayanagara), **Gajapati** (Odisha), and **Ashvapati** (Deccan).

Under the **Amara-nayaka system** here, the Rayas granted **Amaram (land)** to their military officers. The title '**Narapati**' reflected their massive infantry and extensive control over people.

Krishnadeva Raya was the most powerful ruler, who assumed titles like '**Yavanarajya Sthapanacharya**'.

Ans. (d)

8. Which of the following sequences correctly arranges the Vijayanagara rulers in the order of their reign periods?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Krishnadeva Raya → Harihara I → Devaraya II
(b) Harihara I → Devaraya II → Krishnadeva Raya
(c) Devaraya II → Krishnadeva Raya → Harihara I
(d) Devaraya II → Harihara I → Krishnadeva Raya

Exp.- Harihara I established the Vijayanagara Empire in 1336; Deva Raya II was a great ruler of the **15th century** (Sangama dynasty), and Krishnadevaraya took the empire to its zenith in the **16th century** (Tuluva dynasty).

The historical sequence of the dynasties of Vijayanagara is also in this order: Sangama dynasty, Saluva dynasty, Tuluva dynasty, and Aravidu dynasty.

Ans. (b)

9. Which one of the following statements accurately describes a feature of the Vijayanagara Empire?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) The Hazara Rama temple was a public temple for commoners.
(b) The Lotus Mahal shows clear Persian (Indo-Islamic) architectural influence.
(c) The Mahanavami Dibba is topped by a stone super-structure.
(d) The city's sacred centre lay north of the Tungabhadra.

Exp.- The **Lotus Mahal** (Kamal Mahal) of the Vijayanagara Empire is also known as the **Chitrangini Mahal**, which is an excellent example of Indo-Islamic architecture.

Located in the Royal Centre of Hampi, this building displays Islamic style in its **arched domes** and Hindu style in its **base carvings**.

Ans. (b)

10. Which of the following statements is correct regarding Vijayanagara traditions?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rayas were called Ashvapati; Sultans were Narapati.
(b) Rayas were called Gajapati; Sultans were Rajguru.
(c) Rayas were called Narapati; Sultans were Ashvapati.
(d) Both Rayas and Sultan were called Rajadhiraj.

Exp.- The rulers of Vijayanagara were called 'Raya' and they called themselves 'Narapati' (lord of the people or lord of men). The Sultans of the Deccan (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, etc.) were called 'Ashvapati' because the strongest part of their army was the cavalry.

The Vijayanagara Empire was established in 1336 CE by two brothers named Harihara and Bukka.

Ans. (c)

04

Mughal Empire

Babur

1. In early sixteenth-century, which ruler was known for the effective use of cannons in battles?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
(b) Sher Shah Suri
(c) Ibrahim Lodi
(d) Babur

Exp.- Babur used cannons and gunpowder effectively for the first time in India in the **First Battle of Panipat** in 1526.

He defeated the vast army of Ibrahim Lodi by using the '**Tulghuma**' warfare strategy and the '**Rumi**' method of arranging cannons. His two famous gunners were Ustad Ali and **Mustafa**.

Ans. (d)

2. On their mother's side, the Mughals were descendants of which of the following?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Timur
(b) Genghis Khan
(c) Muhammad bin Qasim
(d) Sabuktigin

Exp.- Mughal ruler Babur was a descendant of **Genghis Khan** on his mother's side, while on his father's side, he was a descendant of **Timur**.

The first volume of 'Akbarnama' deals with Akbar's ancestors and the period from his birth to the early years of his reign (up to 1572 CE). Its third volume is called '**Ain-i-Akbari**', which contains information about administration and revenue. It was written by Abul Fazl.

Ans. (b)

3. Consider the following statements:

Statement 1. Babur was of Mongol and Timurid descent and founded the Mughal Empire after defeating Ibrahim Lodi.

Statement 2. Babur was overthrown by Sher Shah and later succeeded by his grandson Akbar.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Exp.- Babur was a descendant of the **Mongols** (on his mother's side) and the **Timurids** (on his father's side). In **1526**, he defeated **Ibrahim Lodi** in the **First Battle of Panipat** and established the **Mughal Empire**. Therefore, **Statement 1** is correct.

Ans. (a)

Babur was not deposed by **Sher Shah Suri**. Sher Shah defeated Babur's son, **Humayun**, in the **Battle of Chausa (1539)** and the **Battle of Kanauj (1540)**. **Akbar** was the son of Humayun. Therefore, **Statement 2** is incorrect.

Ans. (a)

4. Which of the following pairs of rulers and their immediate successors is correctly matched?

SSC PHASE XIII 02/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Alauddin Khalji - Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
(b) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq-Iltutmish
(c) Ibrahim Lodi - Babur
(d) Babur-Sher Shah Suri

Exp.- In the **First Battle of Panipat** in **1526**, **Babur** defeated **Ibrahim Lodi**, took control of Delhi, and established the **Mughal Empire**. Although Babur did not belong to the **Lodi Dynasty**, he became the **immediate successor ruler** to Ibrahim Lodi.

Ans. (c)

5. In which year did Babur defeat Ibrahim Lodi?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1515
(b) 1526
(c) 1530
(d) 1535

Exp.- Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi in the First Battle of Panipat in **1526 AD**. With this victory, the Delhi Sultanate came to an end in India and the **Mughal Empire** was established.

- The primary reasons for Babur's victory were his efficient **artillery** and the '**Tulughma**' system of warfare.

Ans. (b)

6. The first Mughal Emperor to be buried outside India:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Babur (b) Humayun
(c) Akbar (d) Shah Jahan

Exp.- Babur, the founder of the Mughal Empire, was the first Mughal Emperor to be buried outside India. After his death in Agra in 1530, he was initially buried in the Aram Bagh of Agra.

- Later, according to his wish, his remains were taken to Kabul in Afghanistan and buried in '**Bagh-e-Babur**'.

Ans. (a)

7. In which year did Babur take control of Kabul?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1500 CE
(b) 1508 CE
(c) 1504 CE
(d) 1512 CE

Exp.- After losing his ancestral kingdom in Central Asia (Fergana and Samarkand), Babur crossed the Hindu Kush mountains and **conquered Kabul from the Arghun rulers in 1504**. This was his first major permanent victory, which provided him with a strong base to invade India in the future.

Ans. (c)

8. In which year did Babur defeat Ibrahim Lodi in the First Battle of Panipat?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1519 CE (b) 1526 CE
(c) 1529 CE (d) 1530 CE

Exp.- The First Battle of Panipat was fought between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi on 21 April **1526**. Babur defeated Lodi by effectively using the Tulughma policy and artillery, which led to the end of the **Delhi Sultanate and the establishment of the Mughal Empire**.

Ans. (b)

Humayun

9. Name the Mughal emperor known for promoting Persian art and literature?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Humayun (b) Shah Jahan
(c) Akbar (d) Jahangir

Exp.- All major Mughal rulers promoted art, but the credit for establishing and enriching Persian (Iranian) art and literature in the **Indian subcontinent is mainly given to Humayun**. During his exile in Iran, he brought **great Persian painters like Mir Sayyid Ali to India**.

Ans. (a)

10. The Taj Mahal was inspired by which famous monument?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Humayun's Tomb
(b) Jama Masjid
(c) Victoria Memorial
(d) Qutub Minar

Exp.- Humayun's tomb (1569-70) is the first major garden tomb of the Indian subcontinent, which was commissioned by his wife **Maharani Bega Begum (Haji Begum)** and designed by Persian architects.

- It is the first major Mughal structure that uses the **Charbagh style** and a **double dome**, and is often called the 'precursor to the **Taj Mahal**'.

Ans. (a)

11. What position did Hindu Beg hold during Humayun's reign?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rajput chief
(b) Court scholar
(c) Provincial governor
(d) Spiritual guide

Exp.- Hindu Beg was a trusted noble during the reign of Humayun (1530-1556 CE), who was appointed as the provincial governor of Kannauj and Sambhal.

- Hindu Beg was a trusted and high-ranking Mughal noble, equivalent to the rank of 'Amir-ul-Umara' (Chief of Chiefs).
□ Key officials involved in Humayun's administrative system were Tardi Beg, Bairam Khan, and Qasim Khan (Engineering and Construction works).

Ans. (c)

12. Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options:

Assertion (A): Humayun's Tomb was the first major Mughal garden tomb and directly inspired the design of the Taj Mahal.

Reason (R): It introduced the charbagh garden layout and double-domed mausoleum style that became characteristic of later Mughal architecture.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 12/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- Humayun's Tomb (1569-70) was India's first major garden-tomb, whose Chahar Bagh garden layout and double dome style tomb directly inspired the design of the Taj Mahal.

- This is an early Mughal example of a style featuring a **double dome and red sandstone-marble** combination, which became the foundation for later Mughal tombs.

Ans. (a)

Sher Shah Suri

13. Which of the following dynasty ruled India for only fifteen years?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 30/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Sur (b) Khilji
(c) Tughlaq (d) Lodi

Exp.- The Sur dynasty ruled over India for about 15 years (**1540-1555 AD**), in which Sher Shah Suri was the most prominent ruler. Despite a short tenure, Sher Shah introduced major reforms such as the construction of the **GT Road** and the introduction of the '**Rupaya**' currency.

Ans. (a)

14. Whose administrative system later became the model for Emperor Akbar's consolidation of the Mughal Empire?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Babar
(b) Humayun
(c) Sher Shah Suri
(d) Jahangir

Exp.- Sher Shah Suri's efficient administrative and land revenue system (such as the 'Zabt' system and the unit of land measurement '**Gaj-i-Sikandari**') became a basis for Akbar, which was later further refined with the help of Raja Todar Mal.

- The **system of roads and sarays** (rest houses) and the silver coin (**Rupiya**) introduced by Sher Shah became the main pillars of economic and administrative stability during the Mughal period.

Ans. (c)

15. Fill in the blank:

After defeating the Mughal emperor, _____ declared himself the ruler and founded the Second Afghan Empire.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Humayun (b) Sher Shah Suri
(c) Bahlul Lodi (d) Sikandar Lodi

Exp.- In the **Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram) (1540)**, Sher Shah Suri defeated the Mughal Emperor Humayun and established the second Afghan Empire (**Suri Dynasty**) in India.

- Sher Shah Suri is known for introducing the **Rupiya**, repairing the **Grand Trunk Road**, and for his efficient **land revenue system**.

Ans. (b)

Akbar

16. The Rajput ruler who maintained cordial relations with Akbar was:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rana Sanga
(b) Udai Singh
(c) Raja Man Singh
(d) Rana Pratap

Exp.- Raja Man Singh of Amber served as one of Akbar's most trusted generals and was a prominent member of his **Navaratnas (Nine Gems)**.



- Unlike the rulers of Mewar who resisted Mughal authority, the Kachwaha Rajputs of Amber established a powerful alliance with Akbar through both military service and matrimonial ties. *Ans. (c)*

17. Which Mughal emperor prohibited the practice of Sati and issued farmans to that effect?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Babur
(b) Humayun
(c) Akbar
(d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- Mughal Emperor Akbar had taken active steps to curb the practice of Sati and issued a royal farman (decree), according to which forcing any woman to commit Sati against her will was prohibited. He had appointed special government inspectors and Kotwals to strictly enforce this rule. *Ans. (c)*

18. The Mughal Emperor who abolished the Jizya tax in 1564 was:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Akbar (b) Humayun
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Jahangir

Exp.- is policy of religious tolerance and 'Sulh-i-kul' (universal peace), abolished the Jizya tax (a protection tax levied on non-Muslims) in 1564. Later, the Jizya tax was re-introduced by Aurangzeb in 1679 *Ans. (a)*

19. Which Mughal ruler made Gakkhar chief Kamal Khan, a Mansabdar?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- Kamal Khan Gakkhar greatly assisted Akbar in protecting the North-West Frontier and suppressing the rebellious Afghans. Pleased with his loyalty and military service, Akbar appointed him as a **mansabdar** in the imperial army.

- He was the leader of the powerful Gakkhar tribe of the northern part of Punjab (Potohar region). *Ans. (b)*

20. What does the term 'sulh-i-kul' refer to in the context of Akbar's reign?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) A military strategy
(b) Universal peace
(c) Economic reforms
(d) A legal code

Exp.- During Akbar's reign, the meaning of 'Sulh-i-kul' was the policy of **tolerance** towards all religions and **universal peace**. On this basis, Akbar established 'Din-i-Ilahi' and abolished the jizya tax.

- The objective of this policy was to create harmony among people of different religions. It emphasized honesty, justice, and peace. *Ans. (b)*

21. What was the 'zat' in the Mughal mansabdari system?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) It determined the land a mansabdar was given.
(b) It was the numerical value determining a noble's rank and salary.
(c) It referred to the military responsibilities assigned to a noble.
(d) It was a tax imposed on the mansabdar.

Exp.- The 'Mansabdari System' introduced by Mughal Emperor Akbar was the basis of administration and the army. In this, every officer (mansabdar) was given a rank, which was called 'mansab'.

- **Zat:** This indicated the personal status of the mansabdar and his **salary**.
□ **Sawar:** This indicated the number of **horsemen** to be maintained by the mansabdar. *Ans. (b)*

22. Who among the following rulers is known to have translated the Mahabharata into Persian as Razmnama?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- On Akbar's orders, between 1582-1588, scholars such as Naqib Khan, Badauni, and Faizi translated the Mahabharata into Persian as the **Razmnama** at the Maktab Khana (translation bureau) in Fatehpur Sikri. *Ans. (b)*

23. In 1576, the Battle of Haldighati was fought between:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Akbar and Rana Kumbha
(b) Babur and Rana Sanga
(c) Akbar and Maharana Pratap
(d) Humayun and Sher Shah

Exp.- The Battle of Haldighati was fought on 18 June 1576 between the Mughal Emperor Akbar and Maharana Pratap, the ruler of Mewar, in the Haldighati pass in the Rajsamand district of Rajasthan. In this battle, the Mughal army was led by Raja Man Singh of Amer. *Ans. (c)*

24. Which Mughal emperor did Maharana Pratap face in the Battle of Haldighati?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Akbar (b) Babur
(c) Aurangzeb (d) Jahangir

Exp.- The **historic Battle of Haldighati** was fought on **18 June, 1576** in the Aravalli Hills between the Mewar ruler Maharana Pratap and the army of the **Mughal emperor Akbar**.

- In this battle, the large army of **Akbar** was led by the **King of Amer, Raja Man Singh I**, while the army of **Maharana Pratap** was led by the **commander Hakim Khan Sur**. *Ans. (a)*

25. Which of the following statements about the Mughal mansabdari system is/are correct?

Statement I: A mansab indicated both the rank (zat) and salary of a noble.

Statement II: Every mansabdar was required to reside personally in the jagir whose revenue he drew.

SSC PHASE XIII 29/07/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I
(b) Only II
(c) Both I and II are correct
(d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- During the reign of **Akbar**, the term '**Mansab**' in Mughal administration referred to a **position or rank**. This system had two main components: '**Zat**', which determined the **rank and salary** of the official, and '**Sawar**', which fixed the **number of cavalrymen** (horsemen) he was required to maintain. Therefore, statement (I) is true.

- The land areas allotted to **Mansabdars** in lieu of salary were called '**Jagirs**'. However, it was **not mandatory** for Mansabdars to **reside personally** in those jagirs. Therefore, statement (II) is false. *Ans. (a)*

26. Who wrote the three-volume history of Akbar's reign?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Abul Fazl
(b) Birbal
(c) Tansen
(d) Todar Mal

Exp.- The Akbarnama was written by Abul Fazl. This work is in three volumes- the first deals with the history of Akbar's ancestors, the second recorded the events of his reign, and the third is the Ain-i-Akbari, which describes the administration and revenue system. It was originally written in the Persian language. *Ans. (a)*

27. In which of the following provinces did NOT have the 'Zabt' system during Akbar's time due to difficulties in land inspection?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Punjab and Delhi
(b) Agra and Rajasthan
(c) Malwa and Awadh
(d) Bengal and Gujarat

Exp.- During Akbar's reign, the '**Zabt**' system was not implemented in the provinces of Bengal and Gujarat due to difficulties in land survey.

- In these regions, revenue systems based on '**Nasaq**' or estimation were often used.
□ The system could not be fully implemented in Bengal and Gujarat because of practical difficulties encountered in land measurement and survey. *Ans. (d)*



28. Which of the following tribe was very influential in Punjab during the thirteenth and fourteenth century?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) The Khokhar (b) The Gond
(c) The Santhal (d) The Bhil

Exp.- During the 13th and 14th centuries, the **Khokhar tribe** was very influential in the **Punjab region**. Later, the **Gakkhar tribe** became more prominent.

□ The influence of this tribe was so significant that their leader, **Kamal Khan Gakkhar**, was appointed as a **mansabdar** by the Mughal Emperor **Akbar**.
Ans. (a)

29. Which of the following pairs is correct regarding the campaign years of Akbar at various places?

- I. Ranthambore-1569
II. Gujarat-1572

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only I
(b) Only II
(c) Both I and II
(d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Akbar began the **siege of Chittor** in 1567, which concluded in February 1568. Following this, Akbar successfully besieged the **Ranthambhore fort** in 1569, after which its ruler, **Surjan Hada**, accepted Mughal suzerainty.

□ Akbar conquered **Gujarat** in 1572. To commemorate this victory, he later built the '**Buland Darwaza**' at Fatehpur Sikri.
Ans. (c)

30. The first volume of 'Akbar Nama' focuses on which of the following?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Akbar's administration
(b) Events of Akbar's reign
(c) Geography of the Mughal Empire
(d) Akbar's ancestors

Exp.- The 'Akbarnama', written by Abul Fazl, is divided into three parts (**volumes**).

□ The first volume of the **Akbarnama** describes the birth of Akbar, his ancestors from Timur to Humayun, and the history of the Mughal dynasty.
□ The second volume deals with the events of Akbar's reign, and the third volume is the '**Ain-i-Akbari**', which relates to the administration and geography.
Ans. (d)

31. Which Mughal emperor led a campaign against Kashmir, and in which year did it took place?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Babur, 1531
(b) Humayun, 1538
(c) Akbar, 1586
(d) Jahangir, 1617

Exp.- In 1586 CE, Mughal Emperor Akbar launched a campaign against Kashmir (led by Raja Bhagwan Das and Qasim Khan) and annexed Kashmir into the Mughal Empire.

□ In 1586, the ruler of Kashmir, Yusuf Shah Chak, surrendered and Kashmir was formally incorporated into the Mughal Empire (as a part of the Kabul province).
Ans. (c)

32. Who was the revenue minister of Akbar?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Raja Bharmal
(b) Birbal
(c) Raja Man Singh
(d) Todar Mal

Exp.- During Akbar's reign, Raja Todar Mal was the revenue minister and he organized the revenue system (**Dahshala or Zabti system**).

□ He was one of the '**Navaratnas**' in Akbar's court; he had developed a scientific method of collecting land revenue based on the measurement and classification of land.
Ans. (d)

33. Which of the following regions was annexed by Akbar in 1568?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Bengal (b) Gujarat
(c) Chittor (d) Orissa

Exp.- Akbar attacked Chittorgarh in late 1567 and conquered it in **February 1568**. After the victory of Chittorgarh, Akbar also captured Ranthambore in 1569.

□ At that time, the ruler of Mewar was Maharana Udai Singh, but the responsibility of defending the fort rested on two brave commanders named Jaimal and Patta.
Ans. (c)

34. _____ Akbar's famous general, attacked and defeated the Cheros in 1591.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Raja Man Singh
(b) Raja Jai Singh
(c) Todarmal
(d) Birbal

Exp.- Raja Man Singh, Akbar's general, attacked the **Cher** tribal chiefdoms of the Bihar and Jharkhand region in 1591 CE.

□ Man Singh was a Kachhwaha Rajput ruler of Amer and was one of the **nine gems** (navaratnas) of Akbar.
Ans. (a)

35. Which Mughal ruler was referred to as Insan-i-Kamil or 'Perfect Man'?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/10/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Akbar
(b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan
(d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- The Mughal court historian Abul Fazl described Akbar as the '**Insan-i-Kamil**' (the Perfect Man). According to him, Akbar was an ideal ruler who possessed both temporal authority and spiritual perfection, endowed with **farr-i-izadi** (divine light)—as described in the '**Akbarnama**' and the '**Ain-i-Akbari**'.
Ans. (a)

36. Akbar's policy of Sulh-i-Kul was fundamentally based on the principle of:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Military conquest
(b) Religious exclusivity
(c) Universal tolerance
(d) Islamic orthodoxy

Exp.- Akbar's policy of **Sulh-i-kul** meant **universal peace** and **religious tolerance**. Its objective was to establish harmony among all religions and communities. To further this idea, in 1582, he founded **Din-i-Ilahi**, which was based on ethics and the shared values of different religions.
Ans. (c)

Jahangir

37. Which Rajputs refused to accept the authority of the Mughals for a long time?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rathore (b) Kachhwaha
(c) Chauhan (d) Sisodiya

Exp.- The **Sisodiya rulers** of Chittor and Udaipur resisted the Mughals for the longest time and did not accept their suzerainty.

□ They continued a tough struggle until the **reign of Jahangir** (1615). Later, in 1615 AD, the **Mewar-Mughal treaty** was signed between Amar Singh, the son of Maharana Pratap, and the Mughal Emperor **Jahangir**.
Ans. (d)

Aurangzeb & his Successors

38. The Battle of Samugarh was fought between Aurangzeb and which Mughal prince?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Jahangir (b) Murad Baksh
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Dara Shikoh

Exp.- The **Battle of Samugarh** in Mughal history was the most decisive battle of the **war of succession** (29 May, 1658). It was fought near Agra between the joint armies of **Shikoh** (the eldest son of **Shah Jahan**) and his younger brothers **Aurangzeb** and **Murad Baksh**.

□ After this victory, **Aurangzeb** imprisoned his father **Shah Jahan** in the **Agra Fort** and declared himself the **Mughal Emperor**. **Shikoh** was eventually captured in **1659** and was executed on the orders of **Aurangzeb**.
Ans. (d)

39. Which of the following Mughal Emperors was assassinated by his nobles?

- I. Farrukh Siyar
- II. Alamgir II

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 12/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Both the Mughal Emperors, **Farrukhsiyar** and **Alamgir II**, were assassinated by their own powerful nobles or ministers. **Farrukhsiyar** was strangled to death in **1719 AD** by the **Sayyid Brothers** (nobles), while **Alamgir II** was assassinated in **1759 AD** by his Wazir, **Imad-ul-Mulk**. Ans. (c)

40. In 1722, Sawai Raja Jai Singh was given the governorship of which of the following regions?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Bengal (b) Awadh
- (c) Agra (d) Odisha

Exp.- In 1722, the Mughal Emperor **Muhammad Shah** granted the governorship (**subedari**) of **Agra to Sawai Raja Jai Singh**.

□ He was also appointed as the governor (**subedar**) of **Malwa** three times during his lifetime (between 1714 and 1737). **Sawai Raja Jai Singh** founded his new capital, **Jaipur**, in 1727. Ans. (c)

41. Which Mughal Emperor issued the Deccan campaign against the Marathas and spent significant time in the region?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Shah Jahan (b) Aurangzeb
- (c) Jahangir (d) Akbar

Exp.- Aurangzeb spent the last **25-26 years (1681-1707)** of his reign in the Deccan, where he remained constantly engaged in wars, and finally, he died in **Ahmadnagar** in the Deccan in **1707**. During the Deccan campaign, Aurangzeb annexed **Bijapur (1686)** and **Golconda (1687)** into the Mughal Empire after conquering them. Ans. (b)

42. The title "Zinda Pir" or "Living Saint" was attributed to:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Aurangzeb
- (c) Babur
- (d) Jahangir

Exp.- Aurangzeb was called "**Zinda Pir**" or "**Living Saint**" because, unlike other Mughal emperors, he did not lead a life of luxury and did not use the royal treasury for his personal expenses. Ans. (b)

43. Who was the last of the powerful Mughal ruler?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
- (c) Shahjahan (d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- Aurangzeb (Reign: 1658-1707) is considered the last 'powerful' emperor of the Mughal dynasty, because the rulers after him were unable to keep the empire united.

□ After his death in 1707, the Mughal Empire declined rapidly and the empire came to an end with the last Mughal emperor **Bahadur Shah Zafar II**. Ans. (d)

44. Which Sikh Guru instituted the Khalsa in 1699?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Guru Nanak
- (b) Guru Ramdas
- (c) Guru Tegh Bahadur
- (d) Guru Gobind Singh

Exp.- Guru Gobind Singh Ji laid the foundation of the '**Khalsa Panth**' at Anandpur Sahib on the day of Baisakhi on **13 April 1699**.

□ On this occasion, he initiated the first five disciples (Panj Pyare) by administering '**Amrit**' and made the '**five Kakar**' (Kesh, Kangha, Kara, Kachera, and Kirpan) mandatory for Sikhs. Ans. (d)

Mughal Administration: Architecture, Music, Painting, Language-Literature

45. Which of the following best explains the reason to hold Qandhar strategically important for the Mughals?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) It provided direct naval access to the Red Sea for Mughal expeditions.
- (b) It served as a religious pilgrimage center linking India with Central Asian Sufi shrines.
- (c) It was a crucial trade hub connecting the Arabian Sea with the Persian Gulf.
- (d) Controlled key land routes between Kabul and Herat and acted as a fortified military outpost

Exp.- The strategic importance of Qandahar for the Mughals lay in its geographical location, as it was an impregnable fort and military outpost that controlled the major land routes between **Kabul and Herat**. This region was considered the "**gateway**" for the defense of India's north-western frontier, as only by controlling it could potential invasions from Central Asia be prevented. Ans. (d)

46. Which of the following statements is correct about Urs at Ajmer Sharif?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) It follows the lunar calendar and marks the saint's death.
- (b) It is celebrated annually based on the solar calendar.
- (c) It marks the birth anniversary of Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti.
- (d) It is held only once every five years during Ramzan.

Exp.- The literal meaning of the word 'Urs' is 'union'. It is celebrated as the death anniversary (punyatithi) of the Sufi saint **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (also known as 'Gharib Nawaz').

□ It is organised at the dargah of **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** located in Ajmer district of Rajasthan. Ans. (a)

47. How did the administrative roles of rajas differ from those of zamindars under the Mughal system?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Zamindars were subordinate tax officers under the rajas, appointed directly by the emperor.
- (b) Rajas and zamindars performed identical roles but differed in their religious affiliations.
- (c) Rajas governed broader regions and held a higher status, while zamindars primarily managed land revenue collection.
- (d) Zamindars exercised complete political control, whereas rajas held only ceremonial titles.

Exp.- In the **Mughal administrative system**, the **king (or emperor)** was the central authority of power, who ruled over vast territories and controlled the military and administration. In contrast, the **zamindar** was a local hereditary landlord whose main role was to collect revenue from agricultural land and act as an intermediary between the emperor and the peasants in the **administrative system**. Ans. (c)

48. In the context of Mughal administration, who were referred to as Shaikhzadas or Hindustanis?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Central Asian nobles of Turkic origin serving the Mughals.
- (b) Rajput converts elevated to noble ranks for loyalty.
- (c) Persian-trained officers recruited from Safavid Iran.
- (d) Indigenous Muslims who held administrative posts under Mughal rule.

Exp.- The Mughal nobility was an extremely diverse class, which included people of different origins. In Mughal administration, the terms 'Shaikhzada' or 'Hindustani' were used for those Muslims who were born in India and not for those who were foreigners (**such as Iranians or Turanians**). Ans. (d)

49. Around which year did the construction of the Red Fort in Delhi begin?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1605
- (b) 1622
- (c) 1639
- (d) 1658



Exp.- Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan began the construction of the Red Fort after the decision to shift the capital from Agra to Delhi (**Shahjahanabad**) in **1639 AD**. Its chief architect was Ustad Ahmad Lahori.

- Constructed in approximately 9 years, this fort was completed in **1648 AD**. It is an excellent example of the grandeur of Mughal architecture.

Ans. (c)

50. Which of the following statements is correct regarding the Agra Fort?

- It is NOT a UNESCO World Heritage site.
- It was the main residence of the emperors of the Mughal Dynasty.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Agra Fort is a UNESCO World Heritage **site**. It was **included** in this list along with the Taj Mahal in **1983**.

- It was the **main residence (until 1638)** of the emperors of the Mughal dynasty (Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan), until the capital was shifted to Delhi.

Ans. (b)

51. The Gol Gumbaz the tomb of Mohammed Adil Shah is in-----.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Delhi (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Telangana

Exp.- The tomb of Mohammad Adil Shah, Gol Gumbaz, is located in Bijapur (Vijayapura) of Karnataka.

- This is the tomb of Sultan Mohammad Adil Shah (Adil Shahi dynasty), which was built in 1656 by the architect Yaqut.

Ans. (c)

52. Shivaji's exploits against which forces made him a legendary figure?

- Mughal
- Bijapur

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- Shivaji's exploits against both the Mughal and Bijapur sultanates made him famous.

- Shivaji **captured** the forts of Bijapur at a young age and proved his military strength by defeating Afzal Khan in 1659.
- Shivaji challenged **Aurangzeb's army**, raided Surat, and became famous throughout the country after cleverly escaping from Agra.

Ans. (c)

53. Around 1713, Sawai Raja Jai Singh of Amer was appointed governor of which region?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 12/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Bengal (b) Lahore
(c) Agra (d) Malwa

Exp.- Sawai Raja Jai Singh was appointed the Governor of **Malwa** in 1713 by the Mughal Emperor Farrukhsiyar.

- Between 1714 and 1737, he was appointed the Governor of Malwa three times. Sawai Jai Singh also received the Subedari of **Agra** in 1722.

Ans. (d)

54. Who built the famous Red Fort in Delhi?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Jahangir

Exp.- Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan shifted the capital from Agra to Delhi and built the famous Red Fort in Shahjahanabad (Old Delhi). Its construction began in 1638 and was completed in 1648.

Ans. (c)

55. By which concept are the Mughal style of gardens in India inspired?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sacred groves of Vedic times.
(b) The Persian idea of paradise gardens.
(c) Stepwell architecture.
(d) British botanical gardens.

Exp.- The philosophy of Mughal gardens is completely influenced by Persian culture. These were created not only for beauty but as a reflection of spiritual peace and divine paradise. In these, four streams emerging from a central pool or fountain give a systematic geometric form to the entire landscape.

Ans. (b)

56. The Fatwa-i-Alamgiri, a major compilation of Islamic law, was commissioned by:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Shah Jahan
(b) Akbar
(c) Aurangzeb
(d) Jahangir

Exp.- Fatawa-e-Alamgiri is a major compilation of Islamic law, which was got compiled by the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb through a committee of **500 scholars**.

Ans. (c)

57. Which of the following Mughal emperors was responsible for the construction of the Red Fort in Delhi?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- In 1638, Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan decided to shift his capital from Agra to Delhi and laid the foundation for the city of Shahjahanabad (Old Delhi) as well as the Red Fort.

- The construction of this fort was carried out under the supervision of the renowned architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori, who had also designed the Taj Mahal.

- The construction of the Red Fort was completed in about 10 years, from 1638 to 1648.

Ans. (c)

58. Which among the following was NOT a Mughal provincial capital?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Lahore (b) Allahabad
(c) Ajmer (d) Bidar

Exp.- Bidar was never a Mughal provincial capital; it was the capital of the Bahmani and later the Barid Shahi dynasty. Aurangzeb annexed it into the Mughal Empire in 1656-57, but it remained a strategic fort rather than a provincial capital (suba capital).

- Lahore, Allahabad, and Ajmer were capitals of the 12 original Mughal subas established by Akbar.

Ans. (d)

59. Which Mughal Emperor is known for popularising pietra dura, or stone inlay technique, and the double dome in Indian architecture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Exp.- Pietra dura is also known as 'Parchin Kari'. In this technique, beautiful floral designs were created by inlays of **precious gems and coloured stones** into marble. The most magnificent example of this is the Taj Mahal.

Ans. (c)

60. Arrange the following historical structures in chronological order of their completion (earliest to latest):

- Red Fort, Delhi
- Jahangir Mahal, Orchha
- Agra Fort (Akbar)

SSC CGL TIER-I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) a - b - c
(b) c - b - a
(c) b - c - a
(d) c - a - b

Exp.- The correct chronological explanation is as follows:—

Historical Structure	Construction Period	Ruler/Builder	Main Description
(c) Agra Fort	1565-1573	Akbar	Built of red sands tone
(b) Jahangir Mahal, Orchha	1605-1627	Bir Singh Deo	Built by Bundela ruler Bir Singh Deo to welcome Mughal Emperor Jahangir



(a) Red Fort, Delhi	1638–1648	Shah Jahan	Shah Jahan built it as the center of his new capital Shahjahan abad.
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Ans. (b)

61. Which of the following building materials were primarily used in constructing Purana Qila?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Granite and lime plaster
- (b) Concrete and red bricks
- (c) Sandstone and marble
- (d) Wood and terracotta

Exp.- The Purana Qila (Delhi) is a blend of the architecture from the reigns of Humayun and Sher Shah Suri, in which red sandstone and white-black marble have been used for decoration and geometric patterns.

□ Humayun laid its foundation as the city of 'Dinpanah', which was completed by Sher Shah Suri and named '**Shergarh**'; it is an excellent example of Indo-Islamic architecture.

Ans. (c)

62. Which of the following Mughal tombs deviates from the typical square 'hasht-bihisht' (eight-part) layout?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Humayun's Tomb
- (b) Akbar's Tomb (Sikandra)
- (c) Itimad-ud-Daulah
- (d) Safdarjung's Tomb

Exp.- Humayun's Tomb, Itimad-ud-Daula's Tomb, and Safdarjung's Tomb are built in the '**hasht-bihisht**' (eight heavens) layout, whereas Akbar's Tomb (Sikandra) is built in a five-storeyed pyramidal structure instead of a square '**hasht-bihisht**' layout.

Ans. (b)

□ In the **hasht-bihisht** (eight heavens) tradition, a central hall is surrounded by eight smaller rooms or sections.

Ans. (b)

63. What material were the double-storeyed gates of Purana Qila primarily built with?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Marble
- (b) Red sandstone
- (c) Glazed tiles
- (d) Rubble

Exp.- The two-storeyed main gates of Purana Qila, located in Delhi, were built of red sandstone during the reign of Humayun (1530-1540, 1555-1556). Sher Shah Suri (1540-1545) also reconstructed it.

Ans. (b)

05

Maratha Empire

1. In historical texts, Baji Rao I is popularly referred to as:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Peshwa Vishwajeet
- (b) Balaji Rao
- (c) Baji Rao Ballal
- (d) Shahu's Commander

Exp.- Baji Rao I (1720–1740), whose family name was Baji Rao Ballal, was the influential Peshwa of the fourth Chhatrapati of the Maratha Empire, **Shahu Maharaj**.

□ He is known for his invincible military strategy and the expansion of the **Hindu Empire**, and he never lost any battle in his life.

Ans. (c)

2. Which Maratha ruler founded the Maratha Empire in 1674, proclaiming himself Chhatrapati?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sambhaji
- (b) Shahu
- (c) Shivaji
- (d) Bajirao

Exp.- Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj was crowned on **6 June, 1674** at the **Raigad Fort** and formally laid the foundation of an **independent Maratha Empire**. By constantly challenging the **Mughals** and the **Bijapur Sultanate**, he established a **sovereign Hindu kingdom (Hindavi Swarajya)**.

Ans. (c)

3. The First Anglo-Maratha War ended with which of the following treaty?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Treaty of Surat
- (b) Treaty of Seringpatanam
- (c) Treaty of Salbai
- (d) Treaty of Bassein

Exp.- The **first Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782)** ended with the **Treaty of Salbai in 1782**. This treaty was signed between Warren Hastings (British) and Mahadji Sindhia (Maratha).

□ Due to the **Treaty of Salbai**, peace was maintained between the British and the Marathas for the next **20 years**.

Ans. (c)

4. Ujjain expanded under the patronage of which Maratha chief?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Holkar
- (b) Gaikwad
- (c) Bhonsale
- (d) Sindhia

Exp.- The expansion of Ujjain city took place under the patronage of the Maratha chiefs of the **Scindia dynasty**, and it became a major administrative center during their reign.

□ It was the Scindia rulers who carried out the restoration of the famous **Mahakaleshwar Temple** and constructed several ghats and temples here.

Ans. (d)

5. Who was the father of Baji Rao I?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Raghunath Rao
- (b) Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath
- (c) Shahu ji Maharaj
- (d) Peshwa Madhavrao

Exp.- Baji Rao I's father was **Balaji Vishwanath**, who became the first hereditary Peshwa of the Maratha Empire. In 1720, after the death of his father, Baji Rao I was appointed as the Peshwa by **Chhatrapati Shahu Maharaj** at the young age of only 20 years. Raghunath Rao was his son, while Peshwa Madhavrao was his grandson.

Ans. (b)

6. What was the name of the principal minister in the Maratha kingdom?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Nawab
- (b) Peshwa
- (c) Diwan
- (d) Subedar

Exp.- In the **Maratha Empire**, the post of **Prime Minister** was known as the **Peshwa**. The Peshwa was the head of the **Ashtapradhan** (council of eight ministers) of the administration and managed the **administrative, military, and financial functions** of the state. Over time, the position of the Peshwa became extremely powerful, and on many occasions, **actual power** remained concentrated in the hands of the Peshwas, while the **Chhatrapati** remained as the **formal ruler**. Thus, the position of the Peshwa was of great importance in the administrative system of the Maratha Empire.

Ans. (b)

7. Which military strategy did Shivaji often use against his opponents?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Open field battle
- (b) Warfare with the help of elephant
- (c) Guerrilla warfare
- (d) Siege tactics

Exp.- Shivaji Maharaj skillfully employed '**Ganimi Kava**' or **guerrilla warfare**, which involved launching sudden attacks and hiding in the hills.

□ In this strategy, the highest importance was given to speed, secrecy, and knowledge of the local geography.

Ans. (c)



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8. From which decade did the Maratha campaigns into Rajasthan put severe pressure on principalities and checked their further expansion?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1560s (b) 1620s
(c) 1680s (d) 1740s

Exp.- From the **1740s**, Maratha campaigns in Rajasthan put heavy pressure on the princely states and checked their further expansion.

- By this decade, the Marathas had started collecting heavy '**Chauth**' and '**Sardeshmukhi**' from states like Bundi, Jaipur, and Mewar, which put heavy economic and military pressure on the Rajput kings.

Ans. (d)

9. Who succeeded Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj as the ruler of the Maratha Empire?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Chhatrapati Shahu
(b) Chhatrapati Rajaram
(c) Chhatrapati Sambhaji
(d) Maharani Tarabai

Exp.- After the death of Shivaji Maharaj in 1680, his eldest son **Sambhaji Maharaj** became the Chhatrapati of the Maratha Empire. During his reign of 9 years, he continued a fierce struggle against the Mughals (Aurangzeb) and other enemies.

Ans. (c)

10. Who were the parents of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Shahaji and Jijabai
(b) Sambhaji and Saibai
(c) Dada Konddev and Jijabai
(d) Shahaji and Saibai

Exp.- Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's father was **Shahaji Bhonsle** and his mother was Jijabai. His father was Shahaji Bhonsle, who was a powerful general in the Bijapur Sultanate.

- **Dadaji Kondadev** was Shivaji Maharaj's guru and guardian. Ans. (a)

11. Which group provided the backbone of the Maratha army?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Ur
(b) Zamindars
(c) Kunbis
(d) Mansabdar

Exp.- Kunbis were mainly groups of peasant-warriors, who were considered the backbone of the Maratha army.

Due to their good knowledge of the geography of the Deccan hills, the Kunbi community was highly skilled in '**guerrilla warfare**' (ambush warfare).

Ans. (c)

12. What does the term "Kunbis" refer to in the context of Maratha society?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) A warrior caste
(b) A priestly class
(c) A peasant-pastoral community
(d) A merchant banking group

Exp.- In Maratha society, the '**Kunbis**' were the peasant-pastoralist community, who acted as the backbone of the Maratha army.

- Shivaji Maharaj and his successors organised them into a powerful fighting force, through which the Marathas became renowned for their military prowess.

Ans. (c)

13. After the death of Shivaji, which group came to hold effective political power in the Maratha state?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mughals
(b) Deshmukhs
(c) Kunbis
(d) Chitpavan Brahmanas

Exp.- During the time of the successors of Shivaji Maharaj, the actual power gradually passed into the hands of the **Peshwas**, who were mostly Chitpavan Brahmanas.

- During the time of **Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath (1713-1720)**, this office became **hereditary**, and Pune became the main centre of Maratha politics.

Ans. (d)

06

Miscellaneous

1. To whom was Gond king Dalpat married?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Rudrama Devi
(b) Durgawati
(c) Ahilyabai
(d) Chandramani Devi

Exp.- The Gond King Dalpat Shah was married to the Chandel Princess **Rani Durgavati**, who was the daughter of the King of Kalinjar.

- Rani Durgavati fought bravely against the army of Mughal Emperor Akbar and Asaf Khan, and she sacrificed her life in 1564 while defending her motherland.

Ans. (b)

2. Arrange the following historical events in their correct chronological order, from the earliest to the latest:

1. Construction of the Grand Trunk Road.
2. Akbar begins his reign
3. Death of Humayun

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 3-2-1
(b) 1-3-2
(c) 2-1-3
(d) 1-2-3

Exp.- The correct **chronological order** of these events is the **reconstruction of the Grand Trunk Road** by Sher Shah Suri (c. 1540-45 CE), followed by the death of Humayun (January 1556 CE), and finally, the **coronation of Akbar** (February 1556 CE).

- This sequence represents the significant phases of the **rise of the Sur dynasty** in North India and the subsequent **restoration of Mughal power**.

Ans. (b)

3. Match the dynasties listed in Column A with their respective founders mentioned in Column B:

Column A	Column B
A. Tomaras	1. Bahlul Lodi
B. Khalji Dynasty	2. Ananga Pala
C. Sayyid Dynasty	3. Jalaluddin Khalji
D. Lodi Dynasty	4. Khizr Khan

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) A - 2, B - 3, C - 4, D - 1
(b) A - 3, B - 2, C - 4, D - 1
(c) A - 4, B - 3, C - 2, D - 1
(d) A - 1, B - 3, C - 4, D - 2

Exp.-

Column A (Dynasty)	Column B: Founder
A. Tomar Dynasty	2. Anang Pal
B. Khalji Dynasty	3. Jalaluddin Khalji
C. Sayyid Dynasty	4. Khizr Khan
D. Lodi Dynasty	1. Bahlul Lodi

Ans. (a)

4. What led to the decline of Timurid power in the second half of the 15th century?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Economic decline due to maritime trade shifts
(b) Internal wars due to partitioning
(c) Rise of Uzbeks
(d) Ottoman invasions

Exp.- After the death of Timur (1405 AD), there were constant **internal civil wars** and division of the empire among his successors for power, which greatly weakened the central authority. Taking advantage of this political instability, external groups like the Uzbeks and Safavids began to capture their territories, which eventually led to the decline of Timurid power.

Ans. (b)



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5. Consider the following statements regarding provincial architecture in medieval India and choose the correct option:

1. Bengal and Jaunpur developed distinct architectural styles separate from the Delhi Sultanate,
2. Regional styles often blended Islamic structures with local artistic traditions.
3. Provincial styles remained completely uniform across all regions of India.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only 1
(b) 1 and 2 Only
(c) 2 and 3 Only
(d) All 1, 2, and 3 are correct

Exp.- In medieval India, the 'do-chala' roof of Bengal and the massive mosques of Jaunpur, after becoming independent from the Delhi Sultanate, developed their own **distinct regional styles**. These styles were never uniform; instead, they reflect a unique **fusion** of local Hindu and Buddhist artistic traditions with Islamic architecture.

Ans. (b)

6. Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding the regional features of Gujarat's medieval architecture?

1. Architectural forms in Gujarat often incorporated elements from local temple traditions.
2. Structures such as mosques and tombs in Gujarat featured ornamental carvings like toranas and bell motifs.
3. Gujarat's architectural style strictly avoided any decorative influence from indigenous practices.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only 1
(b) 2 and 3 Only
(c) All 1, 2, and 3 are correct
(d) 1 and 2 Only

Exp.- When the **medieval Muslim rulers of Gujarat** constructed **mosques and tombs**, they took the help of **skilled local craftsmen** from the **Hindu and Jain temple traditions**. As a result, elements of **local temple architecture**, such as **carved pillars and chhatris**, were included in Islamic structures.

- In the **mosques and tombs** here (such as the **Jama Masjid of Ahmedabad** and the **Sidi Saiyyed Mosque**), decorative carvings like **torana, bells and chains, and lotus flowers** are found in abundance.

Ans. (d)

7. Which architectural style is best described by the following features: ribbed vaults, pointed arches, flying buttresses, and stained-glass windows?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mughal (b) Deccan
(c) Indo-Islamic (d) Gothic

Exp.- The architectural style defined by ribbed vaults, **pointed arches, flying buttresses**, and stained glass windows is **Gothic Architecture**.

- This style developed in Europe between the **12th** and **16th** centuries, and is known for its tall, airy, and grand structures.
□ The most magnificent example of this style in India is Mumbai's **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus**, which is an excellent specimen of the Victorian Gothic Revival style.

Ans. (d)

8. Which feature of Mughal architecture was inspired by Persian styles?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Flat roofs and simple courtyards
(b) Large domes and iwans (vaulted halls)
(c) Stepwells and pavilions
(d) Minimal ornamentation

Exp.- Prominent features in Mughal architecture like '**double domes**' and the '**Iwan**' (a high arched entrance/hall) were directly adopted from the **Persian (Iranian) Safavid style**. Humayun's Tomb was the first major example of this style, where high domes and massive iwans were used to provide grandeur to the buildings.

Ans. (b)

9. The Mughal architecture is best known for which of the following features?

SSC PHASE XIII 25/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Wooden beams
(b) High domes and minarets
(c) Flat roofs
(d) Simple stone walls

Exp.- The Mughals introduced the trend of high, **double domes** and tall minarets by blending Central Asian and Persian styles with Indian elements. The **Taj Mahal** and **Humayun's Tomb** are excellent examples of this.

- **Mughal architecture** is a unique synthesis of Indian, Persian, and Islamic architectural styles.

Ans. (b)

10. Which fort is an example of Rajput military architecture?

SSC PHASE XIII 24/07/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Red Fort
(b) Agra Fort
(c) Chittorgarh Fort
(d) Golkonda Fort

Exp.- Chittorgarh Fort is located in Rajasthan and is the most magnificent example of Rajput military architecture. It is considered a symbol of the courage and sacrifice of the Rajputs. Chittorgarh Fort was included in the **UNESCO World Heritage List** in June 2013.

Ans. (c)

11. The main temple of Shri Jagannath is an impressive and amazing structure constructed in Kalinga architecture, with a height of _____ meters placed on an elevated platform.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 105 (b) 65
(c) 85 (d) 35

Exp.- The height of the main **shikhara** of the Shri Jagannath Temple in Puri is approximately **65 metres (214 feet)**.

- Established in the **12th century** by King **Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva** of the **Ganga dynasty**, this temple is an excellent example of **Kalinga architecture**. Its main structure is in the shape of a curvilinear tower.

Ans. (b)

12. Who among the following established close relations with the French and modernized his army with their help?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mahadji Shinde
(b) Ali Wardi Khan
(c) Tipu Sultan
(d) Shah Alam II

Exp.- Tipu Sultan sought the assistance of the French to train his army on **European lines** and established a modern **arsenal** at Dindigul.

- Tipu Sultan also established a '**Jacobin Club**' in his capital, Seringapatam.

Ans. (c)

13. Veerashaiva movement begun in _____ in the mid-twelfth century.

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Karnataka
(b) Assam
(c) Bengal
(d) Maharashtra

Exp.- The Virashaiva (Lingayat) movement began in the mid-twelfth century in **Karnataka** under the leadership of **Basavanna**.

- The Lingayats gave priority to the direct worship of Shiva and rejected Vedic authority, the caste system, and Brahmanical rituals.

Ans. (a)

14. Nagaur was conquered and annexed by which house of Rajputs during late Mughal period?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Mewar (b) Amber
(c) Bikaner (d) Jodhpur

Exp.- In the year **1713**, during the time of Mughal Emperor Jahandar Shah, Marwar strengthened its dominance over Nagaur. Finally, during the time of **Maharaja Bakht Singh (of the Rathore dynasty of Jodhpur)**, Nagaur became a complete part of the Jodhpur state.

Ans. (d)

15. Which one of the following was the only Rajput state that defied Mughal power?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Mewar
(b) Amber
(c) Bikaner
(d) Marwar



Exp.- Mewar was the only Rajput state that openly challenged **Mughal authority** for a long time and did not accept their suzerainty.

- In 1615, a treaty was signed between Maharana Amar Singh and Jahangir, in which Mewar was granted specially honorable terms. **Ans. (a)**

16. The Virupaksha Temple in Hampi, is dedicated to ____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Shiva (b) Goddess Durga
(c) Lord Indra (d) Lord Brahma

Exp.- The Virupaksha Temple located in Hampi (Karnataka) is dedicated to **Lord Shiva**; Virupaksha is considered a form of Shiva himself. This temple is situated on the banks of the Tungabhadra River and is an excellent example of Vijayanagara architecture. **Ans. (a)**

17. Which of the following battles was fought in 1761?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Third Battle of Panipat
(b) First Battle of Panipat
(c) Second Battle of Tarain
(d) First Battle of Tarain

Exp.- The **Third Battle of Panipat** was fought in January 1761 between the **Maratha Empire** and the Afghan ruler, **Ahmad Shah Abdali**.

- The **First Battle of Panipat** took place in **1526**, while the **Battles of Tarain** (Taraori) were fought in **1191** and **1192**. **Ans. (a)**

18. Which Mughal emperor ruled between 1713 and 1719?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ahmad Shah (b) Farrukh Siyar
(c) Shah Alam II (d) Alamgir II

Exp.- **Farrukhsiyar** ruled the Mughal Empire from **1713** to **1719**. He ascended the throne after defeating his uncle, Jahandar Shah.

- In 1717, he granted the British East India Company the right to duty-free trade (farman) in Bengal, which is known as the '**Magna Carta**' of the Company. **Ans. (b)**

19. Under whose leadership did the Khalsa revolt against the Mughal rule after the death of Guru Gobind Singh?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Chattar Singh Attriwal
(b) Banda Bahadur
(c) Duleep Singh
(d) Udai Singh

Exp.- After the death of Guru Gobind Singh in 1708, Banda Singh Bahadur took over the leadership of the Sikhs and launched an armed rebellion against the Mughals.

- He struck coins in the name of Guru Nanak Dev and Guru Gobind Singh and established his own administration at Mukhlispur. **Ans. (b)**

20. Where is the Hawa Mahal (having 953 windows) located?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Jaipur (b) Ajmer
(c) Alwar (d) Sikar

Exp.- Hawa Mahal is located in Jaipur, the capital of Rajasthan. Its unique five-storey structure has 953 small windows called '**Jharokhas**'. '**Palace of Winds**' was built by Maharaja Sawai Pratap Singh in **1799 AD**. Its main architect was Lal Chand Usta. **Ans. (a)**

21. In which of the following year the ruler of Iran, Nadir Shah, sacked and plundered the city of Delhi?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1707 (b) 1728
(c) 1739 (d) 1751

Exp.- Nadir Shah, the ruler of Iran, invaded Delhi in **1739 AD** and plundered the city. He took the famous **Peacock Throne (Takht-e-Taus)** and the **Kohinoor diamond** with him to Iran.

- Nadir Shah defeated the Mughal army in the **Battle of Karnal**. The Mughal ruler at that time was **Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela'**. **Ans. (c)**

22. What was the new capital founded by Sawai Raja Jai Singh of Amber?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 19/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Jaipur (b) Udaipur
(c) Jodhpur (d) Ajmer

Exp.- Sawai Jai Singh II founded the city of Jaipur in **1727**. The map of this city was prepared by the famous architect **Vidyadhar Bhattacharya**, which was based on the grid system.

- Sawai Jai Singh II also built the famous astronomical observatory **Jantar Mantar** in Jaipur. **Ans. (a)**

23. In the eighteenth century, where did the Sikh community gather during Baisakhi and Diwali to take collective decisions called Gurmatas?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 18/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Nagpur (b) Amritsar
(c) Patna Sahib (d) Bhopal

Exp.- The decisions taken in collective meetings were called '**Gurmatta**' (resolutions of the Guru). In the 18th century, Sikh bands (jathas) used to meet at Amritsar on the occasions of Baisakhi and Diwali.

- During this period, the Sikhs introduced the '**Rakhi**' system, which provided protection to cultivators on the payment of a tax of 20% of the produce. **Ans. (b)**

24. Which of the following temples is also known as "Taj Mahal of the South"?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sri Jagannath Puri Temple, Puri
(b) Meenakshi Temple, Madurai
(c) Sri Venkateswara Temple, Tirupati
(d) Chamundeshwari Temple, Mysore

Exp.- The term 'Taj Mahal of the South' is often used for **Bibi Ka Maqbara** (Aurangabad), but the **Meenakshi Temple** located in Madurai, Tamil Nadu, is also associated with the 'Taj Mahal of the South' because of its grandeur and architectural complexity.

- The greatest similarity between these two is that they appear like "**poetry written on stones**", where the stones have been carved in a delicate and beautiful manner. **Ans. (b)**

25. For which architectural element is the Sidi Saiyyed Mosque in Gujarat famous for?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mirror mosaic domes
(b) Lattice windows (jalis)
(c) Spiral towers
(d) Black marble minbarsz

Exp.- The latticed windows (**Jalis**) built by Sidi Saiyyid in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, are an excellent example of **Indo-Islamic architecture**. Specifically, the stone craftsmanship of the '**Tree of Life**' Jali is world-renowned. This Jali is also the logo of IIM Ahmedabad. **Ans. (b)**

26. In which of the following shapes is the famous Sun Temple at Konark designed?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) A lotus flower
(b) A gigantics chariot
(c) A circular stupa
(d) A reclining deity

Exp.- Built in the 13th century (around 1250 CE) by King **Narasimhadeva I** of the Eastern Ganga dynasty, the Konark Sun Temple, designed in the shape of a colossal chariot, is famous across the world for its marvelous architecture and **engineering**. **Ans. (b)**

27. Which Indo-European style combined Gothic, Mughal, and Hindu features during the colonial era?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Indo-Saracenic
(b) Colonial Baroque
(c) Dravidian Revival
(d) Mughal-Gothic

Exp.- During the colonial era, the Indo-Saracenic style combined Gothic (European), Mughal (Islamic), and Hindu (Indian) features. In this, the Victorian Gothic style of Britain (such as high arches and pointed minarets) was blended with **India's domes, chhatris, jalis, and minars**. **Ans. (a)**

28. The Bhakti saint who propagated devotion to Rama in the Awadhi dialect was:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Kabir
(b) Tulsidas
(c) Surdas
(d) Namdev



Exp.- Tulsidas was a Bhakti saint who propagated devotion to Rama in the Awadhi dialect and began composing the '**Ramcharitmanas**' in Ayodhya in **1574 AD (Samvat 1631)**. This text is considered the most outstanding specimen of Awadhi literature. **Ans. (b)**

29. In the context of medieval Islamic taxation, what did Khums refer to?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) A tax on agricultural produce.
- (b) One-fifth of war booty and hidden wealth.
- (c) A levy on trade caravans.
- (d) A land revenue assessed annually.

Exp.- Khums was an Islamic tax under which 1/5 (20%) of the war booty or treasure was given to the state/religious treasury.

☐ In the Delhi Sultanate, Firoz Shah Tughlaq strictly enforced this according to Sharia, whereas other rulers often kept a larger share of it for themselves. **Ans. (b)**

30. Marco Polo, during his return from China, described the pepper trade in which region of India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Konkan
- (b) Bengal
- (c) Malabar
- (d) Odisha

Exp.- The famous Italian traveler **Marco Polo** visited the Malabar Coast (Kerala) of India at the end of the **13th century** and described it as the world's largest spice trading center.

☐ He described that black pepper (**black gold**) was exported in large quantities from here to China and Western countries. **Ans. (c)**

31. Which region did Babur first conquer during his initial campaigns in India?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Panipat
- (b) Lahore
- (c) Sialkot
- (d) Bhira

Exp.- Babar launched his first invasion of India in 1519 CE on the border town of Bhira, which is located in the Punjab province of present-day Pakistan (on the banks of the Jhelum River).

☐ Babar mentions in his autobiography '**Tuzuk-i-Baburi**' (Baburnama) that he considered Bhira as his old ancestral territory and tried to conquer it peacefully. **Ans. (d)**

32. What feature was used on Golconda Fort's gates to protect it during attacks involving war elephants?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Deep moat with water channels
- (b) Electrified spikes
- (c) Steel spikes on doors
- (d) Stone cannon towers

Exp.- Golconda Fort, located in Hyderabad, is a fort of the Qutb Shahi dynasty, originally built by the Kakatiya dynasty in the 12th century. In 1687, it came under the Mughals after an 8-month long siege by Aurangzeb.

☐ At the Fateh Darwaza of Golconda Fort, sharp iron/steel spikes were fixed to prevent attacks by war elephants. This was an unprecedented defensive innovation of Qutb Shahi architecture. **Ans. (c)**

33. Match each ruler listed in Column A with their respective period of reign given in Column B:

Column A: Ruler	Column B: Reign Period
A. Qutbuddin Aybak	1. 1175 – 1192
B. Prithviraj Chauhan	2. 1206 – 1210
C. Alauddin Khalji	3. 1296 – 1316
D. Muhammad Tughluq	4. 1324 – 1351

SSC CGL TIER - I, 16/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) A – 1, B – 2, C – 3, D – 4
- (b) A – 4, B – 1, C – 3, D – 2
- (c) A – 3, B – 1, C – 2, D – 4
- (d) A – 2, B – 1, C – 3, D – 4

Exp.-

Ruler	Period of Reign
(a) Qutbuddin Aybak	2. 1206-1210

(b) Prithviraj Chauhan	1. 1175-1192
(c) Alauddin Khalji	3. 1296-1316
(d) Muhammad Tughluq	4. 1324-1351
Ans. (d)	

34. Consider the following statements about Mughal architecture:

1. Mughal architecture is known for blending Persian, Islamic, Turkish, and Indian styles to create a unique Indo-Islamic aesthetic.
2. Red sandstone and white marble were the two most commonly used materials in Mughal construction.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only 1 is correct
- (b) Only 2 is correct
- (c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

Exp.- Mughal architecture is a unique blend of Persian, Turkish, Islamic, and Indian styles, which is clearly visible in the Taj Mahal and Humayun's Tomb.

☐ Red sandstone (Red Fort, Fatehpur Sikri) and white marble (**Taj Mahal**) were the primary construction materials of Mughal architecture. **Ans. (c)**

35. Which of the following fort was built by Suraj Mal in Bharatpur?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Amer Fort
- (b) Agra Fort
- (c) Lohagarh Fort
- (d) Red Fort

Exp.- Lohagarh Fort was built in the middle of the 18th century by **Maharaja Suraj Mal** (the founder of the Jat kingdom).

☐ **Amer Fort** in Jaipur was built by Man Singh and **Agra Fort** was built by the Mughal Emperor Akbar.

☐ The Red Fort was built by the Mughal Emperor **Shah Jahan** between 1639 and 1648, when he shifted his capital from Agra to Delhi (**Shahjahanabad**). **Ans. (c)**



01

Establishment of British Supremacy

1. Which crop did the British force the peasants of Assam to produce?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Cotton (b) Tea
(c) Wheat (d) Rice

Exp.- The British forced the farmers of Assam to cultivate **tea** on a large scale to meet the growing demand for tea in Europe.

□ Similarly, the British **emphasized** the cultivation of **indigo in Bengal** and **wheat in Punjab**. **Ans. (b)**

2. Given below are assertion and reason, read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion(A): Sir Charles Napier justified the annexation of Sindh on moral and legal grounds.

Reason(R): He described it as a “useful humane piece of rascality.”

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) A is true, but R is false.
(c) A is false, but R is true.
(d) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is not the correct explanation of A.

Exp.- Sir Charles Napier admitted that the annexation of Sindh was morally or legally unjustified; therefore, the assertion (A) is incorrect. However, to justify his actions, he described it mainly as “a very advantageous, useful, and humane piece of rascality.” Therefore, the reason (R) is correct. **Ans. (c)**

3. Given below are assertion and reason, read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion A: British capital accumulation in the 18th century was reinvested in industrial development.

Reason R: The capital was largely controlled by merchants and industrialists instead of the feudal aristocracy.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) A is true, but R is false.
(b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- In the **18th century**, during the **Industrial Revolution in Britain**, accumulated capital was reinvested in **industrial factories and new machines** instead of agriculture and trade. As a result, the **rate of production increased many times**. The main reason for this was that **economic power shifted from the feudal aristocracy to the commercial and industrial classes**, whose primary objective was to **earn profits and reinvest them**. **Ans. (c)**

4. Given below are assertion and reason, read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion: The Treaty of Paris (1763) limited French settlements in India to trading posts only.

Reason: The French could no longer station troops or fortify their factories after the treaty.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is not the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- The **Treaty of Paris (1763)**, signed after the **Seven Years' War**, ended the dream of **French political dominance in India**. Although settlements such as **Pondicherry** and **Chandernagore** were returned to the French under this treaty, strict restrictions were imposed on them. As a result, the French were limited only to **commercial activities in India**, and their **political ambitions** came to an end.

□ According to the terms of the treaty, the **French could neither fortify their settlements nor station troops there**, because of which their position remained limited only to **trading centres**. **Ans. (b)**

5. Given below are the two columns. Column A consists of Events or terms and column B consists of correct descriptions. Match the column A with correct description in Column B

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-03)

Column A	Column B
A. Anglo-Russian rivalry	1. Opened Sindh's rivers and roads to British trade.
B. Subsidiary Treaty 1839	2. Forced on the Amirs of Sindh before annexation.
C. Sir Charles Napier	3. It had commercial value; attracted British interest.
D. River Sindh	4. Led military campaign to annex Sindh; called it a “rascality.”
E. Treaty of 1832	5. Led Britain to expand influence in Afghanistan and Persia

- (a) A – 5, B – 2, C – 4, D – 3, E – 1
(b) A – 1, B – 5, C – 2, D – 4, E – 3
(c) A – 2, B – 4, C – 3, D – 1, E – 5
(d) A – 4, B – 1, C – 5, D – 2, E – 3

Exp.-

Column A (Subject)	Column B (Description)
A. Anglo-Russian Rivalry	5. Helped Britain to increase its influence in Afghanistan and Persia
B. Subsidiary Alliance 1839	2. Imposed on the Amirs of Sindh before the annexation.
C. Sir Charles Napier	4. Led the military campaign to subjugate Sindh; called it “wickedness.”
D. Indus River	3. It had commercial importance; it attracted British interest.
E. Treaty of 1832	1. Opened the rivers and roads of Sindh for British trade

Ans. (a)



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6. The introduction of which one of the following sectors in 1853 significantly altered the fortunes of towns, causing economic activities to shift away from traditional locations?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Railways
- (b) Cotton production
- (c) Silk route
- (d) Develop commerce

Exp.- The introduction of **Railways** in 1853 significantly changed the fortunes of cities in India. The first passenger train in India ran between Bori Bunder (Mumbai) and Thane in 1853, making transport accessible and shifting economic activities from traditional, river-based locations to new rail-linked centers.

Ans. (a)

7. Who introduced the Ryotwari System in India?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Cornwallis
- (b) Thomas Munro
- (c) Warren Hastings
- (d) Robert Clive

Exp.- The **Ryotwari System** was primarily introduced in India by **Thomas Munro** and **Alexander Read**. It was implemented in about 51% of British India, mainly covering the Madras, Bombay, and Assam presidencies.

Ans. (b)

8. Which of the following was the British East India Company's first major victory in India?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Battle of Ambur
- (b) Battle of Wandiwash
- (c) First Anglo-Marathas war
- (d) Battle of Plassey

Exp.- The **Battle of Plassey in 1757** is considered the British East India Company's **first major decisive victory** in India, which established British influence over Bengal. In this battle, the British army led by **Robert Clive** defeated **Sirajuddaulah**, the Nawab of Bengal.

Ans. (d)

9. In which of the following years 'Sindh' was taken over by the East India Company?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1834
- (b) 1843
- (c) 1856
- (d) 1861

Exp.- The British East India Company annexed Sindh into its empire in **1843** during the tenure of Lord Ellenborough. The primary credit for the conquest of Sindh goes to **Charles Napier**, who defeated the Amirs there in the Battle of Miani.

Ans. (b)

10. In which of the year was Satara annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1853
- (b) 1850
- (c) 1854
- (d) 1848

Exp.- Under Lord Dalhousie's **Policy of Annexation (Doctrine of Lapse)**, the **princely state of Satara** was annexed into the British Empire in 1848 AD.

Following Satara, Jaitpur and Sambalpur (1849), Udaipur (1852), Jhansi (1853), and Nagpur (1854) were annexed.

Ans. (d)

11. In which year was the third Anglo Mysore war fought?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1790-92
- (b) 1767-69
- (c) 1763-65
- (d) 1755-57

Exp.- The Third Anglo-Mysore War was fought between 1790 to 1792 AD. This war ended with the **Treaty of Seringapatam** in 1792. Under this treaty, Tipu had to give away half of his kingdom to the British and their allies (the Marathas and the Nizam). During

this war, the Governor-General of India was **Lord Cornwallis**.

Ans. (a)

12. On the bank of which river was the first English factory established?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ganga
- (b) Kaveri
- (c) Mahanadi
- (d) Hugli

Exp.- The first English factory was set up on the banks of the **river Hugli** in **1651**, with the permission of **Shah Shuja**, the son of Shah Jahan and the then **Subedar** (Governor) of Bengal.

Following the establishment of this factory, the English gradually strengthened their **trading hold** in Bengal, which later led to the development of centers like **Cassimbazar** and **Calcutta**.

Ans. (d)

13. The Battle of Buxar took place in which of the following years?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1757
- (b) 1764
- (c) 1773
- (d) 1785

Exp.- The Battle of Buxar was fought on **22 October 1764**. On one side was the British East India Company (under the leadership of Hector Munro) and on the other side was the combined army of **Mir Qasim** (Nawab of Bengal), **Shuja-ud-Daulah** (Nawab of Awadh) and **Shah Alam II** (Mughal Emperor).

The British won, as a result of which the **Treaty of Allahabad** was signed in 1765 and the British obtained the 'Diwani rights' of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha.

Ans. (b)

14. The main purpose of the introduction of the railway network in India by the British was to:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Facilitate the movement of Indian pilgrims across the country.
- (b) Promote tourism and cultural exchange among different regions of India.
- (c) Enhance the efficient transportation of raw materials and finished goods for British economic interests and to facilitate troop movement.
- (d) Connect remote rural areas to urban centers for the benefit of local trade.

Exp.- The introduction of Railways in India (1853) was not driven by the philanthropic motives of the British, but rather by colonial interests – it was used to transport raw materials to ports, open the Indian market for British finished goods, and ensure military control and rapid troop movement after the **Revolt of 1857**.

Ans. (c)

15. What was the primary objective of the Ring-Fencing Policy adopted by the British in India during the 18th century?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) To expand British territory by annexing Indian states.
- (b) To economically exploit coastal trading companies.
- (c) To create buffer states to defend British territories.
- (d) To impose direct rule over all princely territories.

Exp.- The **'Ring-Fence' policy** or the **'Policy of Ring Fence'** was an important strategy for the expansion and security of the British Empire in India. It was first adopted by **Warren Hastings (1765-1813 AD)**.

Following the Ring-Fence policy, the British implemented the **Subsidiary Alliance (Lord Wellesley)** and the **Doctrine of Lapse (Lord Dalhousie)** to establish control over India.

Ans. (c)

16. In which year the Nawab of Awadh was forced to give over half of his territory to the East India Company?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1795
- (b) 1801
- (c) 1810
- (d) 1818

Exp.- In **1801**, the **Nawab of Awadh, Saadat Ali Khan II**, was forced to cede over half of his territory to the **Company** under the terms of **Lord Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance**.

Under this, fertile regions like **Rohilkhand** and the **Doab** passed into **British control**.

Ans. (b)



02

New Autonomous State

1. Who among the following became the Nawab of Bengal after Alivardi Khan?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 22/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mir Jafar
(b) Mir Qasim
(c) Murshid Quli Khan
(d) Sirajuddaulah

Exp.- After **Alivardi Khan**, his grandson **Siraj-ud-daulah** became the Nawab of Bengal. It was during his reign that the famous **Battle of Plassey** took place in **1757**, in which he was defeated by the British. **Ans. (d)**

2. Shujauddaulah was the Nawab of which of the following region?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Amber (b) Awadh
(c) Mysore (d) Hyderabad

Exp.- Shuja-ud-Daula was the Nawab of Awadh and he ruled over Awadh in the 18th century. **Ans. (b)**

3. Which of the following was the capital of the kingdom of Tipu Sultan?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 30/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Erode (b) Seringapatam
(c) Sira (d) Chitradurga

Exp.- **Seringapatam** was the capital of **Tipu Sultan's** state (**Mysore Kingdom**), from where he conducted his administration and military activities. Tipu Sultan died a heroic death in **1799 AD** during the **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War**. **Ans. (b)**

4. In which year did Maharaja Ranjit Singh established his capital at Lahore?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1829 (b) 1821
(c) 1801 (d) 1799

Exp.- **Maharaja Ranjit Singh captured Lahore in 1799 AD. After this, he made Lahore his capital.**

- Following this, on April **1801 AD**, he formally assumed the title of 'Maharaja' and established the **Sikh Empire** in Punjab. **Ans. (d)**

5. Who was in the combined forces that attacked Tipu Sultan in 1792?

- I. The Marathas
II. The Nizam of Hyderabad
III. The East India Company

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I and II
(b) Only II and III
(c) Only I and III
(d) I, II and III

Exp.- During the Third Anglo-Mysore War of **1790 - 1792**, a triple alliance was formed against Tipu Sultan, which included the Marathas, the Nizam of Hyderabad, and the East India Company.

- This war ended with the Treaty of Seringapatam in **1792**, under which Tipu had to surrender half of his kingdom to these three powers and also suffer financial loss as war indemnity. **Ans. (d)**

6. What was the combined army of the Sikh 'Jathas' and 'Misis' called in the eighteenth century?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sangats
(b) Mansabdars
(c) Nihangs
(d) Dal Khalsa

Exp.- In the eighteenth century, the combined army of various Sikh bands (jathas) and misls was called the '**Dal Khalsa**'. It was established in **1748** under the leadership of Nawab Kapur Singh. **Ans. (d)**

7. How many astronomical observatories were constructed by Sawai Jai Singh, the ruler of Amber?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Five (b) Nine
(c) Ten (d) Twelve

Exp.- Sawai Jai Singh II, the ruler of Amber, built **5 astronomical observatories (Jantar Mantar)** in India, which are located in Jaipur, Delhi, Ujjain, Mathura, and Varanasi. He founded the city of Jaipur in 1727 AD and made it his capital. **Ans. (a)**

8. In which year did Tipu Sultan become the ruler of Mysore?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1782 (b) 1788
(c) 1795 (d) 1799

Exp.- Tipu Sultan **became the King of Mysore in 1782 AD**, when his father Haidar Ali passed away. He died a heroic death in 1799 while defending Seringapatam during the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War. **Ans. (a)**

03

British Administrative Structure

Charter Act, 1773

1. Which of the following correctly describes the responsibilities of Madras and Bombay governors after 1773?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) They operated independently of the Bengal Governor-General.
(b) They had to report to the Governor-General on war, peace, and revenue.
(c) They managed trade but not civil administration.
(d) They were answerable only to the Court of Directors in London.

Exp.- Before the Act of 1773, the three British presidencies in India (**Bengal, Madras, and Bombay**) were independent of each other.

However, with the changes made in the **Regulating Act of 1773**, the Governors of Madras and Bombay were made subordinate to the **Governor-General of Bengal**.

- Consequently, it became mandatory for the Governors of **Madras and Bombay** to report to the Governor-General of Bengal on matters of war, peace, and other important political issues (such as **revenue and diplomacy**). **Ans. (b)**

Pitt's India Act, 1784

2. What long-term administrative outcome is attributed to Pitt's India Act?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/10/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) It divided India into military zones.
(b) It gave absolute independence to the East India Company.
(c) It placed the Company's possessions under British Parliament's supremacy.
(d) It dissolved the post of Governor General.

Exp.- The **Pitt's India Act (1784)** distinguished between the **political and commercial** functions of the Company. It established the **Board of Control** in London, ensuring direct control of the British government over the administration. For the first time, the Company's territories were referred to as "**British possessions in India**," thereby affirming the **supremacy of the Parliament**. **Ans. (c)**



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3. The main objective of the "Pitt's India Act" of 1784 was to:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- Transfer all powers of the East India Company to the British Crown.
- Establish a dual system of control over the East India Company's affairs by the British government.
- Grant greater autonomy to the Indian rulers in their internal affairs.
- Introduce the first budget for British India in the British Parliament.

Exp.- The Pitt's India Act of 1784 was introduced to remove the defects of the Regulating Act of 1773. It established a system of double government.

- A **Board of Control** consisting of **6 members** of the British Government was established to control political affairs, and the **Court of Directors** was established to manage the commercial affairs of the Company. **Ans. (b)**

4. How did Pitt's India Act contribute to unifying British administration in India?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- By allowing Governors to act independently.
- By dissolving the Court of Directors.
- By giving the Governor General supreme authority over Presidencies.
- By merging civil and military departments.

Exp.- The Pitt's India Act of 1784 was a significant step toward the centralization of British administration in India, which greatly increased the powers of the Governor-General.

- Under this, the Bombay and Madras Presidencies were made subordinate to the Governor-General of Bengal in matters of war, diplomacy, and revenue, and functions were divided between the Court of Directors and the Board of Control. **Ans. (c)**

Charter Act of 1813

5. What was the primary focus of the 1812 House of Commons Committee before the renewal of the East India Company's Charter in 1813.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- Trade monopoly and foreign policy.
- Land revenue collection in Bengal.
- Judicial and police administration in India.
- Military expenditure in frontier regions.

Exp.- Before the renewal of the Charter Act of 1813, the primary focus of the Select Committee of 1812, appointed by the British Parliament (House of Commons), was to review the state of judicial and police administration in India. **Ans. (c)**

6. Fill in the blank:

The _____ ended the monopoly of the East India Company in trade with India.

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- Charter Act of 1813
- Regulating Act of 1773
- Indian Councils Act of 1861
- Government of India Act of 1935

Exp.- The **Charter Act of 1813** abolished the **East India Company's monopoly** over Indian trade and introduced the policy of 'free trade'. However, the Company's monopoly over the **tea trade** and trade with **China** continued. **Ans. (a)**

Charter Act, 1833

7. Which bill/act provided for the trial of British or European persons by Indians, and sought equality between British and Indian judges?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- Regulating Act of 1773
- Ilbert Bill of 1883
- Pitt's India Act of 1784
- Indian Councils Act of 1892

Exp.- The objective of the Ilbert Bill (1883) was to allow Indian judges to **try British or European citizens**, so that equality could be established in the judicial system.

- The British living in India strongly opposed this, which was called the '**White Mutiny**', because they did not want justice at the hands of any Indian. **Ans. (b)**

8. The "Charter Act of 1833" made the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- Madras
- Bombay
- India
- Bengal Presidency

Exp.- The Charter Act of 1833 centralized the British administration in India by making the Governor-General of Bengal the 'Governor-General of India'.

- By depriving the Governors of Madras and Bombay of their legislative powers, the exclusive authority to make laws for the whole of British India was conferred on the Council of the Governor-General of Bengal. Additionally, it ended the commercial activities of the East India Company entirely, transforming it into a purely administrative body. **Ans. (c)**

9. The Ilbert Bill controversy of 1883 was related to which issue?

SSC PHASE XIII 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- Rights of Indian judges
- Introduction of income tax
- Expansion of railways
- Indianisation of the army

Exp.- The **Ilbert Bill controversy** of 1883 was primarily related to granting Indian judges the authority to try cases involving European citizens. Introduced during the time of **Lord Ripon**, the bill aimed to remove racial discrimination in the judiciary, but it was withdrawn due to intense opposition from the British. **Ans. (a)**

10. Which act made the 'Governor-General of Bengal' as the 'Governor-General of India'?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- Charter Act of 1813
- Charter Act of 1833
- Charter Act of 1853
- Indian Council Act of 1861

Exp.- The **Charter Act of 1833** made the 'Governor-General of Bengal' the '**Governor-General of India**'. This Act completely centralised the administration of British India and removed the legislative powers of the Bombay and Madras Presidencies. **Lord William Bentinck** became the first Governor-General of India. **Ans. (b)**

Indian Councils Act, 1892

11. With reference to the Indian Councils Act, 1892, consider the following statements and choose the correct option:

- It significantly increased the number of official members in the Central Legislative Council.
- It empowered the legislative councils to discuss the budget and address questions to the executive.
- It introduced the principle of direct election for non-official members of provincial legislative councils.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- 1 only
- 2 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 2 and 3 only

Exp.- Indian Councils Act, 1892

The Act did not make any significant increase in the number of official members. Therefore, statement 1 is incorrect.

- It gave the legislative councils the power of discussing the budget and addressing questions to the executive. Therefore, statement 2 is correct.
- It introduced a system of indirect, rather than direct, elections. Therefore, statement 3 is incorrect.
- The principle of 'direct election' in India was introduced for the first time by the Act of **1919**. **Ans. (b)**

12. Fill in the blank:

The Indian Councils Act 1892 for the first time permitted legislative councils to_____.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) discuss the annual budget
- (b) pass criminal laws
- (c) levy provincial taxes
- (d) overrule the Viceroy

Exp.- The **Indian Councils Act 1892** was a significant step in the constitutional history of India. It expanded the powers and functions of the Legislative Councils. For the first time, the Councils were given the right to discuss the **annual budget**. However, the right to vote on the budget was not granted.

- Members of the Council were given the right to ask questions to the **Executive** on matters of public interest.
- Regarding the introduction of **indirect elections**, a limited and indirect process of nominating members was started on the recommendation of bodies such as district boards, universities, and municipalities. **Ans. (a)**

Indian Government Act, 1919

13. The "Rowlatt Acts" of 1919 faced intense opposition from Indian nationalists for undermining fundamental legal principles.

What was the most objectionable aspect of these Acts?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) They imposed heavy taxes on Indian businesses and traders.
- (b) They mandated the compulsory registration of all Indian citizens.
- (c) They allowed the government to detain individuals without trial based on suspicion of revolutionary activities.
- (d) They granted greater powers to local self-governing bodies.

Exp.- In the "**Rowlatt Acts**" of 1919, also known as the "**Black Law**," the government was empowered to detain individuals without trial on the basis of suspicion of revolutionary activities. It allowed for imprisonment for up to two years without trial, a lack of judicial review, and confidentiality regarding the reasons for arrest. These were the most objectionable aspects of these acts. **Ans. (c)**

14. Which system, introduced by the Government of India Act of 1919, classified provincial subjects into "reserved" and "transferred" categories?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Dyarchy
- (b) Federation
- (c) Bicameralism
- (d) Responsible Government

Exp.- Under the **Government of India Act 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms)**, the system of **Dyarchy** was introduced. Under this system, the subjects of provincial governments were divided into two categories: **Reserved Subjects and Transferred Subjects**.

- **Reserved Subjects** included important departments such as **law and order, finance, land revenue, and police**.
- **Transferred Subjects** included subjects like **education, health, local self-government, and agriculture**. **Ans. (a)**

15. Which act introduced the system of dyarchy (dual government) in the provinces of British India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) The Indian Councils Act of 1861.
- (b) The Morley-Minto Reforms of 1909.
- (c) The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919.
- (d) The Government of India Act of 1935.

Exp.- The Government of India Act 1919 introduced **Dyarchy** at the provincial level, in which administrative subjects were divided into '**Reserved**' and '**Transferred**'.

- The **Reserved** subjects were administered by the Governor through his executive council, while the **Transferred** subjects were handed over to the elected Indian ministers. **Ans. (c)**

16. Which act was passed to grant limited self-governance to Indians for the first time?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Indian Councils Act. 1892
- (b) Government of India Act 1858
- (c) Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms 1919
- (d) Regulating Act 1773

Exp.- The **Indian Councils Act of 1892** was the first step towards administrative participation and limited self-rule by expanding the Legislative Councils. It increased the number of non-official members and allowed them to discuss the budget.

- Later, the **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (Government of India Act, 1919)** introduced **Dyarchy** in the provinces, dividing subjects into '**Transferred**' (under Indian ministers) and '**Reserved**' (under British officials). (The Commission considered the answer to be C.) **Ans. (c)**

Other Acts

17. In which year Indian Arms Act was passed by British Government?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 24/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1878
- (b) 1897
- (c) 1901
- (d) 1907

Exp.- The Indian Arms Act was passed by the British Government in the year 1878 AD. This Act was passed during the tenure of Lord Lytton, which was introduced to prevent any other rebellion like the one in 1857, and was strongly opposed by nationalist leaders. **Ans. (a)**

18. In which of the following years the East India Company introduced the Permanent Settlement?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1765
- (b) 1775
- (c) 1793
- (d) 1801

Exp.- The Permanent Settlement was introduced in Bengal, Bihar and Odisha by **Lord Cornwallis in 1793 AD**.

It is also called the **Sunset Law** because if the zamindars did not pay the revenue by the sunset of a fixed date, their zamindari would be auctioned off. **Ans. (c)**

19. Which of the following pairs of revenue system- person who devised it is correct?

- I. Mahalwari settlement- Holt Mackenzie
- II. Ryotwari system-Alexander Read and Thomas Munro

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Exp.- The Mahalwari Settlement was devised by **Holt Mackenzie in 1822**. In this, the unit of revenue was considered the 'Mahal' (village).

- **Ryotwari System** It was started by Alexander **Read** and later extended and implemented in the Madras and Bombay Presidencies by **Thomas Munro**. **Ans. (c)**

20. The policies of Lord Curzon as Viceroy of India (1899-1905) are often viewed as a mix of progressive reforms and measures aimed at consolidating British control. Which of the following best exemplifies a policy that was primarily intended to strengthen British administration and strategic interests?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) The establishment of the Imperial Department of Agriculture to promote agricultural research and education.
- (b) The reorganization of the police and the establishment of the Criminal Investigation Department (CID).
- (c) The introduction of reforms in the education system, including the Universities Act of 1904.
- (d) The preservation of ancient monuments and the establishment of the Archaeological Survey of India.



Exp.- Lord Curzon appointed a Police Commission in 1902 under the chairmanship of Sir Andrew Fraser, on whose recommendations the CID was established. The purpose of the CID was to strengthen the intelligence system, keep a watch on revolutionary activities, and control the rising Indian nationalism.

Ans. (b)

21. Fill in the blank: The Factory Act 1881 primarily regulated ____.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Working hours of women and children.
- (b) Industrial pollution and working conditions.
- (c) Night shifts hours for men only.
- (d) Minimum wage for women and children.

Exp.- Under the first Indian Factory Act, 1881 (during the tenure of Lord Ripon), the employment of children below 7 years of age was prohibited, and a limit of 9 hours per day was fixed for children aged 7–12 years.

- Following this, the amended Factory Act, 1891 made a weekly holiday compulsory for all workers and limited the working hours for women (11 hours) and children aged 9–14 years (7 hours).

Ans. (a)

22. Read the following statements:

Statement I: The Act of 1793 followed the tradition of personal rule without bringing in any legal reforms.

Statement II: Judges were assigned to interpret laws rather than depend on the ruler's personal judgment.

Which of the above statements is/are true?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 18/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Only 1 is true
- (b) Only 2 is true
- (c) Both Statement 1 and 2 are true
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2 is true

Exp.- The reforms of 1793 laid the foundation of the 'Rule of Law' in India in place of 'Personal Rule'. Where previously decisions were based on the whims or discretion of the ruler, the Cornwallis Code provided a written legal framework. Its most important aspect was the separation of powers, under which the judiciary was made independent of the administration and was given the power only to interpret the law and dispense justice on its basis.

Ans. (b)

23. The introduction of the "Ryotwari Settlement" in the Madras and Bombay Presidencies differed significantly from the "Permanent Settlement" in Bengal. Which of the following was a key distinguishing feature of the Ryotwari system?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Land revenue was fixed permanently, ensuring stability for the government and zamindars.
- (b) The ownership rights of the land were vested in the hands of large estate holders.
- (c) Land revenue was periodically assessed and revised based on the productivity of the soil.
- (d) Village communities were collectively responsible for the payment of land revenue.

Exp.- The Ryotwari Settlement, implemented in the Madras and Bombay Presidencies, involved a direct survey of the land every 20-30 years, and revenue was determined based on the fertility of the soil. This was different from the Permanent Settlement prevalent in Bengal, where the land revenue was fixed permanently.

Ans. (c)

24. The "Simon Commission" of 1927 was intended to review the working of the Government of India Act of 1919. Why was it met with widespread protests and boycotts by Indian nationalist leaders?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) It recommended the immediate granting of complete independence to India, which was deemed insufficient by some.
- (b) It proposed the complete dismantling of the existing legislative councils.
- (c) It did not include any Indian members in its composition, leading to accusations of being an imposition on India's future without Indian representation.
- (d) It advocated for the strengthening of the system of separate electorates.

Exp.- The 'Simon Commission' of 1927 was constituted to review the Government of India Act of 1919 and to suggest future constitutional reforms. However, as all seven members were British, Indians considered it an insult to their self-respect and against the right to self-governance.

- This led to allegations that it was being imposed on India's future without any Indian representation.

Ans. (c)

25. The Ilbert Bill controversy of 1883-84 was related to:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) The imposition of new taxes on agricultural produce.
- (b) The issue of allowing Indian judges to try European offenders in criminal cases.
- (c) The introduction of English as the medium of instruction in all schools.
- (d) The demarcation of boundaries between British India and princely states.

Exp.- This Ilbert Bill (1883) was introduced during the tenure of Viceroy Lord Ripon, which aimed to end judicial discrimination by giving Indian magistrates the right to try cases involving European accused. Due to fierce opposition by the British (White Mutiny), it finally had to be amended.

Ans. (b)

26. The Government of India Act 1935 proposed which major reform?

SSC PHASE XIII 31/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Abolition of the Zamindari system.
- (b) Establishment of federal government.
- (c) Introduction of separate electorates.
- (d) Full independence for India.

Exp.- The most significant provision of the Government of India Act, 1935, was the proposal to establish an All-India Federation. This Act abolished Diarchy in the provinces and introduced Provincial Autonomy.

Ans. (b)

27. Which act introduced separate electorates for Hindus and Muslims in British India?

SSC PHASE XIII 29/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Indian Councils Act 1892
- (b) Government of India Act 1935
- (c) Morley-Minto Reforms 1909
- (d) Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms 1919

Exp.- The Morley-Minto Reforms are formally known as the Indian Councils Act, 1909. Under this Act, a system of separate electorates was provided for Muslims. Its objective was stated to be political representation, but in practice, it institutionalised communal politics.

Ans. (c)



04

Major Rebellion

Major Tribal and Peasant Rebellions

1. Tana Bhagat led a unique tribal movement in the early 20th century, emphasizing reforms and non-violence against the British and local landlords among the Oraon community in which modern-day state?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Chhattisgarh
(b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Jharkhand
(d) West Bengal

Exp.- The **Tana Bhagat Movement** was started in 1914 under the leadership of Jatra Oraon in the Gumla district of present-day Jharkhand. This movement was known for its adherence to non-violent and Gandhian principles, in which the Oraon community emphasized social reforms and the boycott of British taxes.

Ans. (c)

2. Rani Chennamma was an early 19th-century queen who led an armed rebellion against the Britishers. She hailed from which princely state in Karnataka?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/10/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mysore (b) Kittur
(c) Kodagu (d) Belgaum

Exp.- Rani Chennamma was the Queen of Kittur (Karnataka), who led an armed rebellion in 1824 against the Doctrine of Lapse of the East India Company. When the British refused to recognize her adopted heir, Shivalingappa, she chose to fight and defeated the British Collector, John Thackeray, in the initial battle.

Ans. (b)

3. After the indigo revolution in Bengal, where did the planters shift their operations?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 20/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Bihar (b) Maharashtra
(c) Karnataka (d) Andhra Pradesh

Exp.- After the Indigo Revolt of 1859-60, indigo production declined in Bengal, due to which the planters shifted their investment towards Bihar.

- In 1917, Gandhiji started his first Satyagraha in Champaran, Bihar, in protest against the exploitation of peasants by the planters.

Ans. (a)

4. U Tirot Sing was a tribal chief who led a fierce resistance against the British attempts to build roads through his territory in which region?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Mizoram Hills
(b) Naga Hills
(c) Khasi Hills
(d) Lushai Hills

Exp.- U Tirot Sing was a great tribal chief of the Khasi Hills in Meghalaya and a freedom fighter. He led the **Anglo-Khasi Rebellion in 1829** in opposition to the construction of a strategic road through the Khasi Hills to connect the Brahmaputra Valley with Sylhet (now in Bangladesh).

Ans. (c)

5. Which of the following statements best highlights the significance of Birsa Munda's Ulgulan Movement in the context of tribal resistance during British colonial rule?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) It was primarily a violent movement to reclaim forests and convert missionaries.
(b) It led to the establishment of a separate Munda Raj under the British Crown.
(c) It demanded the restoration of tribal land rights and challenged the dikus.
(d) It was confined to religious reforms and had little impact on colonial administration.

Exp.- The objective of Birsa Munda's **Ulgulan movement** against the exploitation by the British zamindari system, moneylenders, and missionaries in Chotanagpur, Jharkhand during 1895-1900 was to demand the restoration of tribal land rights and to challenge the dikus (outsider exploiters).

Ans. (c)

6. Alluri Sitarama Raju led the Rampa Rebellion in the 1920s, mobilizing tribal communities against British rule. He primarily operated in which modern-day Indian state?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Odisha
(b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Andhra Pradesh
(d) Chhattisgarh

Exp.- Alluri Sitarama Raju led the Rampa Rebellion in the Eastern Ghats (Visakhapatnam and Godavari districts) of the then Madras Presidency, which is currently part of the state of Andhra Pradesh.

- He mobilized the tribals against the 'Madras Forest Act' of 1882, which had restricted their traditional 'Podu' (shifting cultivation) and forest rights.

Ans. (c)

7. Identify the tribal leader who led the Kol Revolt (1831-32) in Chotanagpur against British exploitation.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Budhu Bhagat mobilized tribal peasantry in Chotanagpur during the Kol uprising.
(b) Raghunath Mahato initiated a farmers' revolt against forced taxation.

- (c) Raghoji Bhangre led uprisings in Maharashtra's hilly terrain against colonial forces.

- (d) Tantiya Tope fought alongside Rani Laxmibai during the 1857 Rebellion.

Exp.- Budhu Bhagat was one of the most prominent leaders of the Kol Rebellion, who led guerrilla warfare against the British army and was martyred while fighting the British in 1832.

- This rebellion primarily broke out in the Chhotanagpur region against the encroachment of outsiders (dikus) on the land of the tribals and the exploitative British revenue policies.

Ans. (a)

8. Read the following statements and mark the correct option:

Assertion (A): Alluri Sitarama Raju led the Rampa Rebellion against the British.

Reason (R): He protested against the forest laws that restricted tribal access to resources.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true, but R is false
(d) A is false, but R is true

Exp.- Alluri Sitarama Raju led the Rampa Rebellion in the Gudum Hills of Andhra Pradesh during 1922-24, the primary cause of which was the oppressive policies of the Madras Forest Act (1882).

- These laws deprived the Adivasis of their rights to practise podu (jhum) cultivation and collect forest produce, in protest against which they adopted guerilla warfare.

Ans. (a)

9. Which of the following best describes the role and personality traits of Shaheed Kanhu and Sidhu Murmu during the Santhal Rebellion of 1855?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Visionary tribal leaders who united the Santhal community to resist exploitation with courage and strategic acumen.
(b) Passive intermediaries who negotiated peace treaties between the British and Santhals without resorting to conflict.
(c) Religious preachers who inspired rebellion solely through spiritual teachings without active participation in battles.
(d) Local zamindars who switched allegiance from British rulers to lead a revolt for personal gains.



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Exp.- Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu led the **Santhal Rebellion (Hul)** of **1855**. They organized approximately **60,000 Santhals** to launch an armed revolt against the exploitation by the British and the Zamindars, and attributed this to the command of 'Thakur Ji'. **Ans. (a)**

10. Which tribal leader from Jharkhand led the 'Ulgulan' (Great Rebellion) movement against British exploitation of tribal lands?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sidhu Murmu (b) Kanhu Murmu
(c) Birsa Munda (d) Tilka Manjhi

Exp.- Birsa Munda led the **Ulgulan** (Great Tumult) in **1899-1900** against British rule and the 'dikus', which was in opposition to the destruction of the **Khuntkatti system** and the zamindari system. He started the **Birsait sect** and was worshipped by his followers as '**Dharti Aba**' (Father of the Earth).

- The center of the movement was the **Khunti** region, and after his death (1900), the **Chotanagpur Tenancy Act, 1908** was passed, which protected tribal land. **Ans. (c)**

11. Who among the following was the key leader of the Khongjom War (1891) against British annexation of Manipur?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Tikendrajit Singh commanded the Manipuri army and was later executed.
(b) Rani Gaidinliu led resistance against the British in Naga regions post-1930s.
(c) U Kiang Nangbah led uprisings in Jaintia Hills against colonial intrusion.
(d) Veer Surendra Sai resisted the British in Sambalpur for over four decades.

Exp.- In the Anglo-Manipuri (Khongjom) War of 1891, Yuvraj Tikendrajit Singh led the Manipuri army and gave a tough challenge to the British.

- After the war, Manipur was occupied by the British, and on 13 August 1891, he was publicly hanged on charges of murder and rebellion. **Ans. (a)**

Revolt of 1857

12. Which legendary martyr's attack on British officers in 1857 is considered the first major incident of the Sepoy Mutiny?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji
(b) Mangal Pandey
(c) Mahatma Gandhi
(d) Surendranath Bandyopadhyay

Exp.- Mangal Pandey's attack on British officers in **1857** is considered the first major incident of the **Sepoy Mutiny**. In **March 1857**, at the **Barrackpore cantonment** (Bengal), **Mangal Pandey** attacked his British officers in protest against the use of **greased cartridges**. He was a sepoy of the **34th Bengal Native Infantry**. **Ans. (b)**

13. The revolt of 1857 was started by the sepoys from which of the following places?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Lucknow (b) Bengal
(c) Meerut (d) Madras

Exp.- The Revolt of 1857 was first started by the sepoys in **Meerut** in **May 1857**, after which it spread to Delhi and other regions.

- The issue of greased cartridges became the immediate cause, against which **Mangal Pandey** first raised his voice in Barrackpore (Bengal), but the collective revolt began from Meerut. **Ans. (c)**

14. Peer Ali Khan was a prominent figure in the 1857 Revolt who organized rebels and challenged British rule in which major city of Bihar?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Gaya (b) Patna
(c) Bhagalpur (d) Muzaffarpur

Exp.- Peer Ali Khan was a **bookseller** in Patna, who led the rebellion against British rule in Patna on **3 July, 1857** and killed the opium agent Dr. Lyell.

- He was arrested on charges of rebellion and was publicly hanged on **7 July, 1857** by the Commissioner of Patna, **William Tayler**. **Ans. (b)**

15. Tantia Tope was the general of whom among the following?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Nana Saheb
(b) Begum Hazrat Mahal
(c) Bahadur Shah Zafar
(d) Bajirao II

Exp.- Tantia Tope was the loyal general and military advisor to the Maratha Peshwa Nana Saheb. He primarily led the revolt in **Kanpur** and **Gwalior**. Tantia Tope was famous for his guerrilla warfare tactics. **Ans. (a)**

16. At which of the following places Nana Saheb gathered the armed forces and expelled the British garrison from the city?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Delhi (b) Nagpur
(c) Meerut (d) Kanpur

Exp.- During the Revolt of 1857, Nana Saheb led the rebels in **Kanpur**. He declared himself as the Peshwa, being the adopted son of **Peshwa Bajirao II**, and forced the British garrison to leave the city with his army. **Ans. (d)**

17. Rani Lakshmibai was defeated and killed in _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 12/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) June 1858 (b) September 1860
(c) January 1861 (d) March 1863

Exp.- In June **1858**, Rani Lakshmibai was martyred while fighting against the British army near Kota-ki-Serai in Gwalior. The British contingent that defeated her was commanded by **General Hugh Rose**. **Ans. (a)**

18. Bhima Nayak, a prominent tribal leader during the 1857 rebellion, is known for which of the following contributions?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Leading tribal uprisings in the Satpura region of Madhya Pradesh and coordinating guerrilla tactics against the British.
(b) Negotiating a peace treaty between British authorities and rebel leaders in Central India.
(c) Serving as a close aide to Rani Lakshmibai and leading regular army battalions in open warfare.
(d) Establishing a provisional government in Jhansi during the rebellion.

Exp.- During the Revolt of 1857, Bhima Nayak, known as the '**Robin Hood of Nimar**', is remembered for his indomitable courage and for leading the tribal rebellion in the **Satpura region** of Madhya Pradesh, as well as for coordinating **guerrilla strategies** against the British. **Ans. (a)**

19. Read the following statements and mark the correct option:

Assertion (A): Peer Ali Khan was executed during the 1857 Revolt.

Reason (R): He was a British informant who switched sides during the uprising.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- Peer Ali Khan was publicly hanged without trial in **Patna** on 7 July 1857 during the Revolt of 1857.

- **Peer Ali Khan** was a revolutionary leader of Patna, who had attacked Gulzarbagh on **3 July 1857** and killed British officials, including Dr. Lyell. **Ans. (c)**

20. At which of the following places Mangal Pandey was hanged till death for attacking his officers?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Chandigarh (b) Barrackpore
(c) Delhi (d) Lucknow

Exp.- Mangal Pandey was hanged on (**8 April 1857**) in Barrackpore on charges of attacking his British officers.

- On 29 March 1857, Mangal Pandey attacked his British officers (Lieutenant Baugh) in the **Barrackpore Cantonment** of Bengal in protest against the greased cartridges.
□ This sacrifice of Mangal Pandey is considered the first spark of the First War of Independence of 1857. **Ans. (b)**



05

Development of Education & Press

1. Who set up a Dayanand Anglo Vedic school in Lahore?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Lala Lajpat Rai
- (b) Bipin Chandrapal
- (c) Dayanand Saraswati
- (d) Balgangadhar Tilak

Exp.- The Dayanand Anglo-Vedic School in Lahore was established by Lala Lajpat Rai. This school was established on **1 June, 1886.** **Ans. (a)**

2. The "Wood's Despatch" of 1854 recommended several significant changes in the Indian education system. Which of the following was a key recommendation of this despatch?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) The immediate vernacularization of all levels of education.

- (b) The establishment of a comprehensive system of education from the primary to the university level, with English as the medium of instruction at higher levels.
- (c) The complete privatization of the education sector in India.
- (d) The exclusive focus on the training of religious leaders and scholars.

Exp.- The "Wood's Despatch" manifesto, prepared by Charles Wood in 1854, marked the beginning of a systematic educational policy in India. Its main objective was to introduce Indians to Western culture, science, and philosophy so that the Company could obtain trained administrative staff. It aimed at the establishment of a comprehensive system of education from the primary to the university level, with English as the medium of instruction at the higher level. **Ans. (b)**

3. Which education-related document, issued in 1854, laid the foundation for modern education in India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Macaulay's Minute
- (b) Hunter Commission
- (c) Wood's Despatch
- (d) Indian Education Act

Exp.- This document, prepared by Sir Charles Wood in 1854, is known as the 'Magna Carta of Indian Education', which recommended a systematic structure of local languages at the primary level and English education at the higher level.

- Based on its recommendations, universities were established in **Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras** in 1857 on the model of London University. **Ans. (c)**

06

Religious & Social Reform Movements

1. Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid tribute to Mahatma Jyotiba Phule on his birth anniversary. Phule is best known for his contributions to which of the following?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Agriculture and commerce
- (b) Industry and infrastructure
- (c) Military and diplomacy
- (d) Social Reform and Anti-Caste Movement

Exp.- Mahatma Jyotirao Phule was a great **social reformer, thinker, and writer of 19th century India.** He is mainly known for his **struggle against the caste system, promotion of women's education,** and his revolutionary work for the upliftment of the oppressed classes.

- In **1873**, he established the **Satyashodhak Samaj** to provide human rights to the oppressed classes and to free them from religious and social slavery, and in 1873 he wrote the famous book '**Gulamgiri**'. **Ans. (d)**

2. How did the Bombay and Madras governments respond to the proposal of the 1839 Draft Act on slavery?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both supported the Act without changes.
- (b) Bombay supported it, Madras rejected it.
- (c) Bombay saw no need for a law; Madras questioned its expediency.
- (d) Both governments demanded full enforcement of the Act.

Exp.- In 1839, when the Central Government of British India proposed a **draft act** to regulate or abolish the **practice of slavery**, the reactions of the **Bombay Presidency and Madras Presidency** were quite skeptical and protective. The Bombay Government denied the need for any new law, while the Madras Government expressed serious doubts about its utility. **Ans. (c)**

3. Why did the British Parliament and Company authorities initially avoid abolishing Sati in India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) They supported the practice as part of Indian tradition.
- (b) They feared religious backlash and wanted local judgment.
- (c) They lacked legal authority to pass social legislation.
- (d) They believed only Hindu priests should make such decisions.

Exp.- Initially, British officials refrained from interfering in the Sati practice because they feared public discontent and military rebellion due to meddling in socio-religious matters.

- Eventually, inspired by the persistent efforts of social reformers like Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Lord William Bentinck declared the Sati practice illegal in 1829. **Ans. (b)**

4. Who introduced the law that abolished the practice of Sati in British India in 1829?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Dalhousie
- (b) Lord Curzon
- (c) Lord William Bentinck
- (d) Lord Canning

Exp.- On 4 December 1829, Governor-General Lord William Bentinck passed the Bengal Sati Regulation (**Regulation XVII**), declaring the practice of Sati illegal and punishable in British India. Raja Rammohan Roy played a decisive role in this reform. **Ans. (c)**

5. The Age of Consent Act 1891 raised the minimum marital age for girls from:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 10 to 11 years (b) 10 to 12 years
- (c) 10 to 13 years (d) 10 to 14 years

Exp.- The Age of Consent Act (1891) was a significant social reform in British India, which was passed during the tenure of Lord Lansdowne (1888 to 1894 CE).

- Through this Act, the minimum age of marriage and consent for girls was increased from 10 years to 12 years.
- Social reformer Behramji Malabari played a significant role in getting the Age of Consent Act passed. **Ans. (b)**

6. How did Raja Rammohan Roy contribute to the movement against the practice of Sati in early 19th-century Bengal?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/09/2025 (Shift-03)



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- (a) He organized armed protests in Bengal villages.
- (b) He issued government ordinances against orthodox leaders.
- (c) He campaigned using newspapers and engaged in debates.
- (d) He formed alliances with British Christian missionaries.

Exp.- Raja Rammohan Roy campaigned against the practice of Sati in Bengal using newspapers and participated in debates. He wrote articles against the Sati system in his journal Sambad Kaumudi and argued by providing scriptural evidence.

- He built public opinion from 1818 onwards, as a result of which Lord Bentinck banned the practice of Sati in 1829. **Ans. (c)**

7. Read the following statements and mark the correct option:

Assertion (A): Rani Gaidinliu continued the Heraka movement after the death of Jadonang

Reason (R): She aimed to convert the movement into a mass literacy campaign among Nagas.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (c) A is true, but R is false.
- (d) A is false, but R is true.

Exp.- Rani Gaidinliu carried forward the Heraka movement after the death of her guru, Jadonang. This movement was associated with religious reform, social unity, and anti-British resistance.

- The objective of the Heraka movement was **not to conduct a literacy campaign**, but to revive traditional Naga religious-cultural values, promote social reform, and oppose colonial rule. **Ans. (c)**

07

Struggle for Swaraj

Indian National Congress

1. Who was the first woman to be the president of the Indian National Congress?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Kasturba Gandhi
- (b) Kamala Nehru
- (c) Annie Besant
- (d) Sarojini Naidu

Exp.- The first woman president of the **Indian National Congress was Annie Besant**. She presided over the **Calcutta (Kolkata) session in the year 1917**. She was a famous British theosophist and was also associated with the Home Rule Movement in India.

- **The first Indian woman president of the Congress was Mrs. Sarojini Naidu**. She presided over the **Kanpur session in the year 1925**. **Ans. (c)**

2. With whose participation did the Anushilan group join forces when the Bengal Congress broke up into two factions after the death of CR Das?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ganesh Ghosh
- (b) Surya Sen
- (c) JM Sengupta
- (d) Subhash Bose

Exp.- After the death of C. R. Das in 1925, the Bengal Congress was divided into two groups. The **Anushilan Samiti** supported the group led by J. M. Sengupta. In contrast, the 'Yugantar' group joined hands with the group of Subhas Chandra Bose, which led to a deep division in the revolutionary politics of Bengal. **Ans. (c)**

3. Who is credited with hoisting the first version of the Indian flag at the International Socialist Congress in Stuttgart, Germany, in 1907?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (b) Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay
- (c) Bhikaji Cama
- (d) Sarojini Naidu

Exp.- On August 22, 1907, **Madam Bhikaji Cama** unfurled the first Indian flag on foreign soil at the **International Socialist Congress** held in Stuttgart, Germany. She is also known as the **'Mother of the Indian Revolution'**. The flag hoisted by her consisted of green, yellow, and red horizontal stripes, with **'Vande Mataram'** inscribed on it. **Ans. (c)**

Partition of Bengal

4. Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Abhinash Bhattacharya and Bhupendranath Dutta were associated with which movement in March 1906?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Swadeshi movement.
- (b) Anti Bengal partition movement.
- (c) Quit India movement.
- (d) Movement against Bengal educational reforms.

Exp.- Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Abhinav Bhattacharya, & Bhupendranath Dutta were major centres of revolutionary activities during the **Swadeshi Movement**, & during this time they started the famous revolutionary newspaper 'Yugantar' in **1906**.

- This group emerged in opposition to the Partition of Bengal (1905), and at the peak of the Swadeshi Movement, they advocated armed resistance against foreign rule and the boycott of foreign goods. **Ans. (a)**

5. The primary reason for the British government's decision to partition Bengal in 1905 was:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) To promote the educational development of the region
- (b) To improve the administrative efficiency of the large province
- (c) To foster greater unity between the Hindu and Muslim populations of Bengal
- (d) To encourage the growth of industrialization in East Bengal

Exp.- The official reason given by the British government for the partition of Bengal in 1905 was that Bengal was an extremely large province, making its division mandatory for better administrative efficiency.

- However, the real objective of the then Viceroy Lord Curzon was to weaken the centre of rapidly growing Indian nationalism in Bengal and to create a rift in Hindu-Muslim unity through the policy of 'divide and rule'. **Ans. (b)**

6. The Partition of Bengal in 1905 was carried out under which Viceroy?

SSC PHASE XIII 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Curzon
- (b) Lord Ripon
- (c) Lord Lytton
- (d) Lord Dalhousie

Exp.- The **Partition of Bengal** was carried out in 1905 during the tenure of Viceroy **Lord Curzon**. The official argument provided by the British was **'administrative convenience'**, but the real objective was to break nationalist unity under the policy of **'divide and rule'**. **Ans. (a)**

Major Revolutionary Organizations

7. The revolutionary Bagha Jatin (Jatindranath Mukherjee) was known for his valiant fight and for inspiring revolutionaries in which Indian state?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Bengal
- (d) Bihar



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Exp.- Jatindranath Mukherjee, who was known as '**Bagha Jatin**', had killed a tiger single-handedly and was a prominent leader of the Yugantar party in Bengal, who led an armed rebellion against British rule, which also included the Indo-German conspiracy, and he was martyred in an encounter with British officers in **1915**. **Ans. (c)**

8. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE about Rash Behari Bose?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) He founded Indian Independence League in Tokyo in 1942.
- (b) He was an important figure in the Ghadar Movement and in the formation of the Azad Hind Fauj.

- (c) He was honoured with the prestigious title 'Order of the rising sun'.
- (d) He was independent India's first Commander-in-Chief of Indian Army.

Exp.- The first Indian Commander-in-Chief of independent India was **Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa**, therefore statement (D) is false.

□ In Japan, Rash Behari Bose founded the **Indian Independence League** in **1942** and played a significant role in the formation of the **Azad Hind Fauj (INA)**, the command of which he later handed over to **Subhash Chandra Bose**. The Japanese government honored Rash Behari Bose with the country's second-highest civilian award, '**Order of the Rising Sun**'. **Ans. (d)**

9. What was the key contribution of Baikuntha Shukla in the Indian freedom struggle?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) He led the Champaran Satyagraha.
- (b) He protested against Simon Commission.
- (c) He assassinated a government approver.
- (d) He founded the HSRA.

Exp.- Baikunth Shukla killed Phanindra Nath Ghosh, who had become a government witness (**approver**) against Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru in the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

□ For this act of revenge, Baikunth Shukla was arrested and was hanged in Gaya Central Jail on 14 May, 1934. **Ans. (c)**

08

Gandhian Movements

Champaran Movement

1. In which of the following years Mahatma Gandhi led the Champaran Movement?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 09/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1913
- (b) 1917
- (c) 1921
- (d) 1923

Exp.- Mahatma Gandhi led the Champaran movement in **1917**. This was Gandhi ji's first **Satyagraha** in India, which was started to liberate the peasants of Bihar from the '**tin-kathia**' system and against the exploitation of indigo planters. **Ans. (b)**

Gandhi-Irwin Pact, Poona Pact

2. The Salt Satyagraha of 1930 was a direct civil disobedience movement against which British policy?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) The imposition of heavy taxes on land revenue.
- (b) The British monopoly on the manufacture and sale of salt.

- (c) The restrictions on the movement and assembly of Indians.
- (d) The introduction of separate electorates for different communities.

Exp.- The Salt Satyagraha of 1930, known as the Dandi March, was against the British government's salt law and its monopoly over the sale of salt.

□ Mahatma Gandhi started it from Sabarmati on 12 March 1930 and broke the salt law upon reaching Dandi on 6 April 1930, which marked the official beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement. **Ans. (b)**

3. Who founded Harijan Sangh and contended that the Shastras did not approve untouchability, and if they did, they should be disregarded?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Rabindranath Tagore
- (b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (c) Jyotiba Phule
- (d) Mahatma Gandhi

Exp.- Following the Poona Pact in 1932, **Mahatma Gandhi** founded the 'All India Anti-Untouchability League' (later **Harijan Sevak Sangh**) for the social upliftment of depressed classes. **Ans. (d)**

4. Why did Mahatma Gandhi call for a campaign against the Rowlatt Act?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) During the non-cooperation movement, thousands of Indians were kept in jail.
- (b) British censorship of press and permitted detention without trial.
- (c) Hundreds of people were killed in the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- (d) Sir Sidney Rowlett was a Britisher.

Exp.- Gandhi called the **Rowlatt Act of 1919** a 'Black Law' because it allowed the government to detain individuals without trial for two years and imposed strict censorship on the press. **Ans. (b)**

09

National Movement

1. Who among the following criticised the Moderates for their "politics of prayer"?
I. Bipin Chandra Pal
II. Bal Gangadhar Tilak
III. Lala Lajpat Rai

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 25/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Only I and II
- (b) Only II and III
- (c) Only I and III
- (d) I, II and III

Exp.- These three **radical nationalists—Bipin Chandra Pal, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, and Lala Lajpat Rai**—criticised the Moderates for their '**politics of prayers**' and advocated the importance of self-reliance and constructive work (active struggle).

□ In this context, Tilak raised the famous slogan, '**Freedom is my birthright and I shall have it!**' **Ans. (d)**

2. Which freedom fighter was also known as 'Badshah Khan' or 'Frontier Gandhi'?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Abdul Ghaffar Khan
- (b) Ashfaqulla Khan
- (c) Zakir Husain Khan
- (d) Hakim Ajmal Khan

Exp.-

□ Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan was known as '**Frontier Gandhi**' (Seemant Gandhi), '**Badshah Khan**' and '**Bacha Khan**' because of his non-violent ideology and devotion to Mahatma Gandhi.

□ In **1929**, he founded an organisation named '**Khudai Khidmatgar**' (Servants of God), which is also known as the '**Red Shirt**' movement. **Ans. (a)**

3. What name was given to Bal Gangadhar Tilak by the British rulers?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-01)



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- (a) The Father of the Indian Unrest
- (b) National Treasure of India
- (c) Iron Man of India
- (d) The Father of Undivided India

Exp.- British journalist Valentine Chirol, in his book 'Indian Unrest', called Tilak the "**Father of Indian Unrest**".

- According to Chirol, a sense of anti-British sentiment spread through Tilak's newspapers (Kesari and Maratha) and ideas, while the people respectfully called him 'Lokmanya'.

Ans. (a)

4. Which of the following slogans was raised by Bal Gangadhar Tilak?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) "Satyamev Jayate"
- (b) "Jai Hind"
- (c) "Give Me Blood, and I Shall Give You Freedom."
- (d) "Freedom is my birthright and I shall have it!"

Exp.- "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it." This slogan was given by Bal Gangadhar Tilak. **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** gave this slogan in **1916** during the 'Home Rule League' movement.

- 'Satyameva Jayate' was popularized by Madan Mohan Malaviya, and the slogans 'Jai Hind' and 'Give me your blood...' were given by Subhash Chandra Bose.

Ans. (d)

5. The "Lahore Resolution" passed by the Muslim League in 1940 demanded:

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Complete integration of all princely states with British India.
- (b) The creation of a separate state for Muslims in the northwestern and eastern parts of India.
- (c) Equal representation for Muslims in all legislative bodies.
- (d) The continuation of a united India with enhanced safeguards for minority rights.

Exp.-

- In 1940, in the Lahore Session of the Muslim League held from 22-24 March 1940 under the chairmanship of Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the 'Lahore Resolution' was passed.
- It demanded the creation of a separate state for Muslims in the northwestern and eastern parts of India. This resolution became the basis of the Pakistan movement.

Ans. (b)

6. Rash Behari Bose was a key figure in forming the Indian Independence League and played a crucial role in the initial organization of which army?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Azad Hind Fauj
- (b) Royal Indian Army
- (c) Gorkha Regiment
- (d) Sikh Light Infantry

Exp.- Rash Behari Bose coordinated between revolutionary activities within India and the armed struggle in Japan. In 1942, he laid the foundation of the Azad Hind Fauj and provided a concrete structure to the Indian independence movement in South-East Asia. On his invitation, Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose arrived in East Asia from Germany in 1943 and took charge of this movement.

Ans. (a)

7. Read the following statements and mark the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A):** Matangini Hazra died while participating in a Salt March in Odisha.

2. **Reason (R):** She was shot by police while holding the national flag during the Quit India Movement.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (c) A is false, but R is true.
- (d) Both A and R are false.

Exp.- During the Quit India Movement in Midnapore, Bengal, Matangini Hazra continued to march forward with the tricolour despite police warnings. Even after being shot repeatedly, she did not allow the flag to fall to the ground and kept chanting 'Vande Mataram' until her last breath.

Ans. (c)

8. The "Indian Independence Act of 1947" outlined the terms for the transfer of power and the creation of independent India and Pakistan. Which of the following was a key provision of this Act regarding the princely states?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) It mandated the immediate integration of all princely states into either India or Pakistan based on geographical contiguity.
- (b) It granted the princely states the freedom to choose whether to join India, Pakistan, or remain independent.
- (c) It stipulated that the British government would continue to exercise paramountcy over the princely states.
- (d) It ensured that the revenue sharing agreements between the princely states and the new dominions would remain unchanged.

Exp.- The most important provision regarding the princely states under the Indian Independence Act 1947 was that the 'paramountcy' of the British Raj was terminated, and they were given the right to choose their own future.

- Because of this provision, complications arose regarding the merger of princely states like Junagadh, Hyderabad, and Jammu-Kashmir at the time of independence.

Ans. (b)

9. Usha Mehta is famously known for which of the following contributions during the Quit India Movement?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Leading armed struggle against British forces.
- (b) Organizing the underground radio to broadcast nationalist messages.
- (c) Being the first woman to be executed by the British for revolutionary activities.
- (d) Leading mass protests in Bombay.

Exp.- During the Quit India Movement (1942), when the major leaders of the movement were arrested, a secret or underground radio station named 'Congress Radio' was started by Usha Mehta.

- Its objective was to broadcast nationalist news, Mahatma Gandhi's messages, and instructions for the protestors across the country, so that the public could be kept informed while avoiding British censorship.

Ans. (b)

10. The Indian Independence Act of 1947 marked the end of British rule but also led to the partition of India.

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) The partition was a universally welcomed decision that led to immediate peace and prosperity in both India and Pakistan.
- (b) While advocated by the Muslim League as the only way to secure Muslim interests, the partition resulted in widespread violence, displacement, and long-lasting socio-political tensions, with arguments against it focusing on the potential for a united India with adequate minority safeguards.
- (c) The British government unilaterally imposed the partition without any significant consultation with Indian leaders or consideration of its consequences.
- (d) The partition was solely driven by economic factors, with both sides seeking control over specific resources and territories.

Exp.- The partition under the **Indian Independence Act, 1947** was not merely a political decision, but it led to the displacement of nearly **1.5 crore people**, severe communal violence, and criticism of the breakdown of unity by leaders like **Frontier Gandhi**; the determination of borders by the **Radcliffe Commission** in just five weeks increased the chaos and resulted in long-term **India-Pakistan tensions** such as the **Kashmir dispute**, **Indus Waters Treaty** and the division of assets.

Ans. (b)

11. In 1916, two major political groups in India came together to present a united front to the British. Which organizations signed this historic agreement, known as the Lucknow Pact?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-01)



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- (a) Indian National Congress and Swaraj Party.
- (b) All-India Muslim League and Khilafat Committee.
- (c) Indian National Congress and Muslim League.
- (d) Hindu Mahasabha and Indian National Congress.

Exp.-

- The historic **Lucknow Pact of 1916** was a historic agreement between the Indian National Congress and the All India Muslim League that created a common political platform against British rule.
- Under this pact, achieved through the special efforts of Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the Congress accepted the Muslim League's demand for a **'separate electorate'**, in exchange for which both parties agreed to demand **'self-government'** from the government.
- Another major achievement of this session was the reunification of the Moderates and Extremists of the Congress, which gave a new organized strength to the Indian independence movement. **Ans. (c)**

12. Rani Gaidinliu was known as a 'Naga spiritual and political leader' who led a fierce armed rebellion against the British in which region of Northeast India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (Naga Hills)
- (b) Meghalaya (Khasi Hills)
- (c) Manipur (Naga Hills)
- (d) Mizoram (Lushai Hills)

Exp.- Rani Gaidinliu led the 'Heraka' movement against British rule in the Tamenglong district (Naga Hills region) of present-day Manipur. At the age of just 13, she, along with her cousin Haipou Jadonang, launched an armed rebellion to drive out the British and establish a 'Naga Raj'. **Ans. (c)**

13. Why is Matangini Hazra remembered in Indian history?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) For writing a book
- (b) For being a queen
- (c) For her bravery in the freedom struggle
- (d) For winning a legal case

Exp.- Matangini Hazra (1870-1942) was a brave revolutionary of the Indian freedom struggle.

- On **29 September, 1942**, while leading a procession in Tamluk during the Quit India Movement, she continued to hold the tricolour high despite being hit by **three bullets** and attained martyrdom while chanting the slogan **"Vande Mataram"**. **Ans. (c)**

14. Who was the prominent leader during the Quit India Movement, remembered for hoisting the Indian flag at the Gowalia Tank Maidan in Mumbai in 1942?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sucheta Kriplani
- (b) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (c) Annie Besant
- (d) Vijayalakshmi Pandit

Exp.- Aruna Asaf Ali is known for hoisting the tricolour at the Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay (Mumbai) during the Quit India Movement of 1942, which symbolised the official beginning of the movement.

- Due to this historic act, she is called the 'Grand Old Lady' of the freedom struggle. **Ans. (b)**

15. Which of the following describes the role of Aruna Asaf Ali in Indian history?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) She was elected as India's first female judge.
- (b) She hoisted the Indian flag during the Quit India Movement.
- (c) She led a military regiment during the 1857 revolt.
- (d) She participated in drafting the Constitution.

Exp.- Aruna Asaf Ali is remembered for her courageous act of hoisting the national flag at the Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay during the **Quit India Movement** of 1942, because of which she came to be known as the **'Grand Old Lady'** of the independence movement. **Ans. (b)**

16. Rani Gaidinliu, a prominent freedom fighter, is best known for her leadership in which movement during British India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Joined the Heraka movement, mobilizing Naga tribes against British missionaries.
- (b) Peasant uprising in Bengal against zamindari oppression.
- (c) Armed revolt in Punjab supporting the Ghadar Party's cause.
- (d) Non-cooperation movement led by Mahatma Gandhi in Andhra Pradesh.

Exp.- Rani Gaidinliu led the Heraka movement in Manipur and Nagaland, which aimed to revive Naga culture and oppose the repressive and conversion policies of the British.

- In honour of her bravery, Jawaharlal Nehru bestowed upon her the title of 'Rani' and called her the **"Daughter of the Hills"**; she was also awarded the **Tamrapatra (1972)** and the **Padma Bhushan (1982)**. **Ans. (a)**

17. The trio of Binoy, Badal, and Dinesh are remembered for their daring armed attack on which building, a symbol of British administration in Calcutta?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Victoria Memorial
- (b) Fort William
- (c) Writers' Building
- (d) Howrah Station

Exp.-

- On 8 December 1930, Benoy Basu, Badal Gupta, and Dinesh Gupta, dressed in European attire, raided the **Writers' Building** in Calcutta and killed the cruel Inspector General of Prisons, **N.S. Simpson**.
- In honour of their heroism, Dalhousie Square was renamed **B.B.D. Bagh (Benoy-Badal-Dinesh Bagh)**. **Ans. (c)**

18. The Simon Commission, appointed in 1927, was boycotted by the Indian National Congress because:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) It recommended the immediate granting of full independence to India.
- (b) It proposed the complete abolition of separate electorates.
- (c) It did not include any Indian members.
- (d) It advocated for the continuation of dyarchy in the province.

Exp.- On November 8, 1927, the Secretary of State for India, Lord Birkenhead, constituted a statutory commission under the chairmanship of **Sir John Simon**. Since all **7 members** were British, it was called the 'White Commission'.

- This **Simon Commission** reached Bombay on February 3, 1928, where people showed black flags, raised slogans of **'Simon Go Back'**, and also organized strikes. **Ans. (c)**

19. Jayaprakash Narayan's concept of Total Revolution included which of the following components?

- 1. Social reforms to eradicate corruption
- 2. Political reforms to decentralize power
- 3. Armed struggle against the government
- 4. Economic reforms focusing on privatization

Which of these are correct?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Exp.-

- Jayaprakash Narayan's **Total Revolution** included social reforms (eradication of corruption) and political reforms (decentralization of power); hence, both statements 1 and 2 are correct.

- He supported a **non-violent movement**, therefore armed struggle and privatization-centered economic reforms were not a part of it. Thus, statements 3 and 4 are incorrect. **Ans. (a)**



20. V. O. Chidambaram Pillai, also known as 'Kappalottiya Thamizhan', was a pioneer of the Swadeshi movement who started which enterprise?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Swadeshi Cotton Mills
(b) Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company
(c) Swadeshi Bank
(d) Swadeshi Textile Mills

Exp.-

- In 1906, **V.O. Chidambaram Pillai** established the **Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company (SSNC)** to challenge the British **monopoly** on shipping.
□ The company operated ships between **Tuticorin and Colombo**. For this reason, he is known as '**Kappalottiya Tamilan**' (the Tamil Helmsman).

- He led the **Swadeshi Movement** and the **boycott of foreign goods** in the **Madras Presidency**. He was a follower of **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** and a prominent member of the **Extremist** faction (Garam Dal) of the Congress.

Ans. (b)

21. Kanaklata Barua, a young female revolutionary, was shot dead by the police while attempting to hoist the Indian national flag during the "Quit India Movement" in which state?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Odisha
(b) West Bengal
(c) Assam
(d) Bihar

Exp.- Kanaklata Barua was a brave freedom fighter from Assam, who is known as '**Birbala**' (Brave Girl).

- During the **Quit India Movement of 1942**, while leading a procession of the '**Mrityu Bahini**' (Death Squad), she went to hoist the tricolor flag at the Gohpur Police Station and was martyred in police firing at the age of 17-18 years.

Ans. (c)

22. Baji Raut, a young boy from Odisha, became a martyr when he was shot by British police for refusing to ferry them across a river to reach freedom fighters. How old was he?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 8 years old (b) 10 years old
(c) 12 years old (d) 15 years old

Exp.- Baji Rout (born 5 October 1926) is considered the youngest martyr of India. In 1938, in Dhenkanal, Odisha, he refused to ferry the British police across the Brahmani River and was martyred in the firing during the Prajamandal movement at the age of only 12 years.

Ans. (c)

10

Governors, Governor-Generals & Viceroy

1. Match the following with the associated policies.

1. Warren Hastings	a. Doctrine of lapse
2. Dalhousie	b. Ring fence policy
3. Wellesley	c. Subsidiary alliance

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1 - b, 2 - a, 3 - c
(b) 1 - c, 2 - a, 3 - b
(c) 1 - a, 2 - b, 3 - c
(d) 1 - a, 2 - c, 3 - b

Exp.-

1. Warren Hastings	b. Ring fence policy
2. Dalhousie	a. Doctrine of lapse
3. Wellesley	c. Subsidiary alliance

Ans. (a)

2. What tragic incident happened in the life of Robert Clive in 1774?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 26/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) He was assassinated.
(b) He committed suicide.
(c) He was exiled to Burma.
(d) He was given death penalty on the charges of corruption.

Exp.- Robert Clive committed suicide in **1774**, which is considered the most tragic event of his life. **Robert Clive** is regarded as the founder of the British Empire in India, who achieved victory in the **Battle of Plassey in 1757**.

Ans. (b)

3. Who among the following was the Governor-General of British India from 1773 to 1785?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Warren Hastings
(b) Lord Wellesley
(c) Lord Dalhousie
(d) Lord Cornwallis

Exp.- Warren Hastings was the first **Governor-General of British India** from 1773 to 1785.

- He abolished the **Dual Government** and established **Diwani (civil) and Faujdari (criminal) courts** in every district. It was during his tenure that the **First Anglo-Maratha War** and the **Second Anglo-Mysore War** took place.

Ans. (a)

4. Which of the following policies were devised by Lord Dalhousie?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 29/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Doctrine of Lapse
(b) Policy of Paramountcy
(c) Subsidiary Alliance
(d) Policy of Non-intervention

Exp.- Lord Dalhousie adopted the **Doctrine of Lapse** to annex Indian princely states into British rule. Under this policy, **Satara (1848)** was the first to be annexed, followed by the annexation of states like **Sambalpur (1849), Jhansi (1853), and Nagpur (1854)**.

Ans. (a)

5. Around which year was Robert Clive appointed the Governor of Bengal?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) 1733 (b) 1752
(c) 1764 (d) 1781

Exp.- Robert Clive served as the Governor of Bengal twice. His first tenure was from **1757-1760**, and he was **appointed** Governor of Bengal again in **1764** to manage the anarchy that arose after the Battle of Buxar (1764).

Ans. (c)

6. Under which of the following governor-General a new policy of "paramountcy" was initiated?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 28/11/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Hastings
(b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Lord Wellesley
(d) Lord Dalhousie

Exp.-

- The policy of "**Paramountcy**" was implemented in an organized and clear form during the time of **Lord Hastings (1813-1823)**.

- Under this policy, the British government claimed that British authority was **paramount** over the Indian states. Its objective was to strengthen British supremacy in India.

Ans. (a)

7. The "Subsidiary Alliance" system, pioneered by Lord Wellesley, had a significant impact on the political map of India. What was a primary consequence for the Indian states that entered into this alliance?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) They gained greater military strength and autonomy in their external relations.
(b) They were effectively brought under British political influence and control, losing their independent foreign policy and often their military capacity.
(c) They experienced rapid economic growth due to British investment and administrative reforms.
(d) They formed a strong unified front against the expansion of British power in India.



Exp.- Under the “**Subsidiary Alliance**” system introduced by Lord Wellesley, the rulers who accepted it had to disband their own military forces and depend on the British army.

- They were required to pay for its maintenance and it was mandatory to station a British Resident in their court. This deprived them of their freedom to conduct an independent foreign policy, and they became dependents of the British Empire.

Ans. (b)

8. The Subsidiary Alliance system had which of the following conditions for the allied Indian rulers?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) They were allowed to maintain their own independent armies.
- (b) They had to keep a British Resident in their court.
- (c) They were free to enter into alliances with other Indian rulers without British consent.
- (d) They were not required to pay any revenue to the British.

Exp.- Under the Subsidiary Alliance, the allied ruler had to maintain a British Resident, disband their own army, and bear the expenses of the British army. This policy of Lord Wellesley strengthened British paramourcy in India and reduced French influence.

Ans. (b)

9. The introduction of the Permanent Settlement in Bengal by Lord Cornwallis in 1793 primarily aimed to:

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Ensure the welfare of the peasant farmers.
- (b) Create a class of loyal zamindars who would ensure regular land revenue collection.
- (c) Promote the cultivation of cash crops like indigo and cotton.
- (d) Abolish the zamindari system altogether.

Exp.- Under the Permanent Settlement, Lord Cornwallis made the zamindars the permanent owners of the land so that the government could receive a fixed and regular revenue.

- Its main political objective was to create a loyal class of zamindars who would support the British rule in case of a rebellion.

Ans. (b)

10. Which of the following pairs (Governor-General – Policy followed) is correctly matched?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 19/09/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Lord Hastings - Anti-expansionist policy
- (b) Marquis of Hastings - Followed fiscal conservatism
- (c) Lord Wellesley-Pursued imperialist conquests
- (d) Henry Dundas - Opposed Charter renewal

Exp.- Lord Wellesley (1798–1805 AD) adopted the policy of the **Subsidiary Alliance** as part of his ‘Imperialist Conquest Campaign’ in India. The **Nizam of Hyderabad** (1798) was the first to accept this alliance.

- The **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War** (1799) and the **Second Anglo-Maratha War** (1803–05) took place during the reign of Lord Wellesley.

Ans. (c)

11. Regarding the Subsidiary Alliance system introduced by Lord Wellesley (1798–1805), which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

SSC CGL TIER-II, 18/01/2026

- (a) If the ruler failed to make payments for the maintenance of the British force, a portion of his territory was ceded as a penalty.
- (b) The Indian ruler was required to disband his own military and maintain a permanent British contingent within his territory.
- (c) The British promised not to interfere in the internal administrative affairs of the allied state.
- (d) The ruler was free to employ any European (French, Portuguese, etc.) as long as they were not in active conflict with the British.

Exp.-

- A major condition of the **Subsidiary Alliance** was that Indian rulers could not employ any other European in their service without the permission of the British.

- This provision was included to completely eliminate **French influence** from the Indian princely states. This alliance was first accepted by the **Nizam of Hyderabad** in 1798.

Ans. (d)

11

Miscellaneous

1. Which feature is not commonly associated with French colonial architecture in India?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Wide verandas
- (b) Tall doors and windows
- (c) Sloped tiled roofs
- (d) Ornate Mughal domes

Exp.- French colonial architecture is primarily known for European classical influences and features adapted to the tropical climate, such as **wide verandas, tall windows, and slanting tiled roofs.**

- Its most vibrant example can be seen in the ‘**French Quarter**’ of Puducherry (Pondicherry). Notably, this style does not include characteristic elements of Mughal architecture, such as ornate domes or arches.

Ans. (d)

2. Once the Time Magazine had mocked Gandhiji’s physical size but to whom do it compare his martyrdom later on?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Albert Einstein
- (b) Martin Luther
- (c) George Orwell
- (d) Abraham Lincoln

Exp.- After Gandhi’s assassination in 1948, Time Magazine which had once mockingly described his physical appearance as “**spindly**” and “**emaciated**” shifted its tone to honor his legacy by comparing his martyrdom to that of **Abraham Lincoln**.

- Both leaders were viewed as “Great Souls” who were killed by fanatics while successfully striving to hold their respective nations together during times of intense internal division.

Ans. (d)

3. Given below are assertion and reason, read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion: British capital accumulation in the 18th century was reinvested in industrial development.

Reason: The capital was largely controlled by merchants and industrialists instead of the feudal aristocracy.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift-01)

- (a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (b) A is false, but R is true.
- (c) A is true, but R is false.

- (d) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

Exp.- In the 18th century, Britain accumulated a large amount of capital through global trade, colonial expansion, and the agricultural revolution. **During the Industrial Revolution, this capital was invested in new technologies, factories, steam engines, and infrastructure, which led to industrial development.** Therefore, the assertion (A) is correct.

- During this period, economic power shifted from the feudal aristocratic class to traders, industrialists, and emerging capitalists, whose aim was to increase production and earn profit. Therefore, capital was **invested in industrial innovations**. In this way, the reason (R) is correct and is the correct explanation of the **assertion (A)**.

Ans. (d)

4. Which of the following best captures the broader geopolitical shift triggered by the decisive defeat of the Nawab of Carnatic’s forces in their confrontation with European powers?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift-01)



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- (a) It revealed systemic vulnerabilities in native military structures, prompting European companies to transition from trade to political hegemony.
- (b) It disillusioned European companies, resulting in a strategic withdrawal from inland military affairs.
- (c) It consolidated indigenous authority, forcing European traders into commercial treaties under local oversight.
- (d) It established a stable dual-administrative system between Indian principalities and foreign chartered companies.

Exp.- In the **Battle of St. Thome (Adyar War) of 1746**, a small French force defeated the large army of the **Nawab of Carnatic, Anwaruddin Khan**. This proved that disciplined military training and modern organisation were superior to the numerical strength of Indian armies.

□ This victory removed the fear of Indian rulers from the minds of the European companies and paved the way for a trading organisation to gradually become the **political and military authority in India**. **Ans. (a)**

5. National Women's Day in India is being celebrated on 13th February in honor of which prominent woman's legacy?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Annie Besant
- (b) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (c) Sarojini Naidu
- (d) Savitribai Phule

Exp.- National Women's Day is celebrated annually in India on February 13 to mark the birth anniversary of **Sarojini Naidu**. She was the first Indian woman President of the Indian National Congress (Kanpur Session, 1925) and the first woman Governor (Uttar Pradesh) of India. **Ans. (c)**

6. Which year marked the completion of Rashtrapati Bhavan?

SSC PHASE XIII 01/08/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1912
- (b) 1921
- (c) 1929
- (d) 1935

Exp.- When the decision to shift the capital of British India from Calcutta to Delhi was taken in **1911**, the plan for Rashtrapati Bhavan was made. The construction of Rashtrapati Bhavan (then 'Viceroy House') began in **1912** and was fully completed in **1929**. Its chief architect was **Edwin Lutyens**. **Ans. (c)**

7. The Victoria Memorial built between 1906 and 1921 is located in _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 30/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Kolkata
- (c) Chennai
- (d) Shimla

Exp.- The Victoria Memorial is located in the city of Kolkata in West Bengal, which was the capital of British India at that time. Its construction took place between **1906** and **1921**. It was built by the then Viceroy Lord Curzon in memory of Queen Victoria. **Ans. (b)**

8. During British rule in India, caste data was regularly collected in decennial censuses from 1881 to _____.

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 21/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) 1921
- (b) 1911
- (c) 1931
- (d) 1901

Exp.- During British rule in India, caste-related data was regularly collected in the decennial census from **1881 to 1931**.

□ After the **1881** census, caste-based data was gathered every 10 years in India. **Ans. (c)**

9. Who was first woman Chief Minister of any state in India?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 15/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (b) Sucheta Kripalani
- (c) Anna Chandy
- (d) Kamala Nehru

Exp.- Sucheta Kripalani was the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh from **1963 to 1967**. She was the first woman to lead any state in India.

□ **Aruna Asaf Ali** was the first Mayor of Delhi, and **Anna Chandi** was the first woman judge in India. **Ans. (b)**

10. Who is the author of the book "Gandhi in Champaran", which describes Mahatma Gandhi's first Satyagraha struggle on Indian soil in 1917?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 14/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Toru Dutt
- (b) Rajendra Prasad
- (c) D. G. Tendulkar
- (d) Kamala Das

Exp.- The author of 'Gandhi in Champaran' is **Dinanath Gopal Tendulkar**. This book depicts the detailed history of the Champaran Satyagraha (1917) and Gandhiji's struggle.

□ Rajendra Prasad has also written books on the Champaran Satyagraha, the prominent ones being '**Satyagraha in Champaran**' and '**Mahatma Gandhi in Champaran**'. **Ans. (c)**

11. Who was the first woman Director-General of the Archaeological Survey of India?

SSC CHSL TIER-I, 13/11/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Kamala Das
- (b) Debala Mitra
- (c) Anna Chandy
- (d) Chitra Ramkrishna

Exp.- Dr. Debala Mitra was the first woman to hold the reins of the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) (**1981-1983**).

□ She made significant contributions to the excavation of Buddhist sites in the Diamond Triangle of Odisha (Ratnagiri, Udayagiri, and Lalitgiri). **Anna Chandy** was the first woman judge of India. **Ans. (b)**

12. Which of the following freedom fighters is also known as "Mother Teresa of Western Odisha"?

SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Parbati Giri
- (b) Rama Devi
- (c) Sarala Devi
- (d) Annapurna Maharana

Exp.- Born in the Sambalpur district of Odisha, Parbati Giri was a great freedom fighter and social reformer, who has been given the title of '**Mother Teresa of Western Odisha**' for her humanitarian work. **Ans. (a)**

13. Who is known as the "Bismarck of India" for his role in integrating princely states?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 14/10/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Subhas Chandra Bose

Exp.- **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** is called the "**Bismarck of India**" because he integrated more than **562 Princely States** after independence to make India a unified nation.

□ This title is given due to the similarity of his role to **Otto von Bismarck**, the unifier of **Germany**. **Ans. (a)**

14. Which significant political move by Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi ensured that Assam remained a part of India and not East Pakistan during the Cabinet Mission Plan's proposal in 1946?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Opposing the grouping of Assam with Bengal.
- (b) Launching the Quit India Movement in Assam.
- (c) Signing the Assam Accord.
- (d) Rejecting the Instrument of Accession.

Exp.- Gopinath Bordoloi opposed the '**grouping**' scheme of the Cabinet Mission and saved Assam from merging with East Pakistan, keeping it a part of India.

□ For this historic contribution, he was called '**Lokpriya**' and was posthumously awarded the **Bharat Ratna**. **Ans. (a)**

15. Which architectural style predominantly defines the churches of Old Goa?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Indo-Saracenic
- (b) Mughal
- (c) Baroque and Manueline
- (d) Gothic Revival

Exp.- The churches of Old Goa, especially the **Basilica of Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral**, display an excellent confluence of Portuguese Baroque and Manueline styles.

□ These styles are famous for their grandeur, elaborate decoration, and intricate carvings, which were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the **16th-17th century**. **Ans. (c)**



16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: British colonial Indian architecture has prominently adopted the utilization of lime mortar as well as extensive foundation platforms

Statement 2: These design methods enabled the incorporation of arches, domes, and large colonnaded verandas in public structures

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Both statements are correct, and Statement 2 correctly explains Statement 1.
- (b) Both statements are correct, but Statement 2 does not correctly explain Statement 1.
- (c) Statement 1 is true, Statement 2 is incorrect.
- (d) Both statements 1 and 2 are incorrect.

Exp.-

- During the British colonial period, lime mortar and strong foundation platforms were extensively used for heavy buildings. Therefore, statement 1 is correct.
- These designs made it possible to construct arches and domes in the Indo-Saracenic style. Therefore, statement 2 is also correct, but it is not the direct reason for statement 1; rather, it is a separate architectural feature. **Ans. (b)**

17. Thakkar Bapa was a dedicated social worker and freedom fighter primarily known for his lifelong efforts towards the upliftment and welfare of which section of Indian society?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Women
- (b) Children
- (c) Tribal (Adivasi) communities
- (d) Industrial workers

Exp.-

- Amritlal Vithaldas Thakkar (**Thakkar Bapa**) dedicated his life to the upliftment of Adivasis and Dalits. He used the term 'Adivasi' for tribal people, established the **Bhil Seva Mandal** in 1922, and made significant contributions as the General Secretary of the **Harijan Sevak Sangh**. **Ans. (c)**

18. The Chapekar Brothers (Damodar, Balkrishna, and Vasudeo) are remembered for assassinating a British official in response to injustices during the plague epidemic in which Indian city?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Pune
- (d) Chennai

Exp.-

- Damodar, Balkrishna, and Vasudev Hari Chapekar assassinated the British Plague Commissioner W.C. Rand and his assistant Lieutenant Ayerst in Pune on **22 June 1897**.

Exp.- Pingali Venkayya is known for his significant contribution in designing the current Indian National Flag (**Tiranga**).

- During the freedom struggle, he presented various designs of the flag, on the basis of which the current form of the **Tiranga** was developed. **Ans. (c)**

19. What is the primary focus of the book India for Indians by Chittaranjan Das?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Advocacy for Indian self-rule during the freedom struggle.
- (b) A detailed history of India's ancient empires.
- (c) A study of India's economic reforms post-independence.
- (d) A biography of Mahatma Gandhi.

Exp.- This book is a compilation of the political speeches and writings of **Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das** from 1917. In this work, he emphasized **Swaraj** and the right of Indians to **self-governance**, making it a major **manifesto** of nationalism.

- In 1923, he co-founded the **Swaraj Party** along with **Motilal Nehru**. His literary contributions include works such as '**India for Indians**', '**Malancha**', and '**Mala**'. **Ans. (a)**

20. Pingali Venkayya is widely credited for his significant contribution to the design of which national symbol of India?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) The National Emblem
- (b) The National Anthem
- (c) The National Flag
- (d) The National Flower

Exp.-

- Pingali Venkayya is known for his significant contribution in designing the current Indian National Flag (**Tiranga**).
- During the freedom struggle, he presented various designs of the flag, on the basis of which the current form of the **Tiranga** was developed. **Ans. (c)**

21. Fill in the blank: During World War I the Defence of India Act 1915 empowered the executive to _____.

SSC CGL TIER-I, 20/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) approve preventive detention
- (b) enforce military recruitment
- (c) create provincial councils
- (d) ban import of foreign rifles

Exp.-

- The Defence of India Act, 1915, gave the British government the power of preventive detention on the basis of suspicion. Its objective was to suppress revolutionary movements like the Ghadar; under this, special tribunals were formed and the right to appeal was limited.

- In continuation of this, the **Rowlatt Act of 1919** was brought, which Indian leaders called the law of "**No Vakil, No Appeal, No Dalil**" (no lawyer, no appeal, no argument). **Ans. (a)**

22. Which of the following is a notable architectural feature of Notre Dame des Anges Church in Puducherry?

SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-02)

- (a) Shikhara with amalaka
- (b) Transparent enclosure with piers
- (c) Minaret with balcony
- (d) Corbelled arch with lattice work

Exp.-

- The **Notre Dame des Anges Church** located in Puducherry is famous for its unique **French** and **Greco-Roman architecture**.
- It is characterized by columns in the **Doric and Corinthian styles**, which give the façade and internal structure of the church a magnificent "**transparent enclosure**" appearance. **Ans. (b)**

23. Which Indian city is known for its abundance of buildings featuring French colonial architecture?

SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) Goa
- (b) Puducherry(Pondicherry)
- (c) Hyderabad
- (d) Kolkata

Exp.- Puducherry (formerly Pondicherry) remained the French headquarters for a long time; therefore, in its White Town area, villas with yellow walls, tall windows, and French-style verandahs can be seen.

- The architecture here is a unique blend of French classical and local Tamil influences, which is known as the 'Franco-Tamil' style. **Ans. (b)**

24. What was the aim behind abolition of intermediaries in land reforms in India?

SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-03)

- (a) To increase the power of zamindars.
- (b) To eliminate government control over agriculture.
- (c) To establish a direct relationship between tenants and the government.
- (d) To encourage landlords to acquire more lands.

Exp.- The abolition of intermediaries (**Zamindari System**) in land reforms was carried out so that a direct relationship could be established between the farmers (**tenants**) and the government, and exploitation could be reduced.

- Major land reforms in India include Zamindari abolition, land ceiling laws, tenancy reforms, land record reforms, and consolidation of holdings (**chakbandi**). **Ans. (c)**

